Below the Abbey

Grid-Movement, Turn-Based RPG

The Instruction Manual

Bickering Goat Studios

BELOW THE ABBEY

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CHAPTER 1

Getting Started

Four heroes, one lantern and a cold stair going down: everything you need to open the game, read the screen and take your first steps.

WELCOME TO THE CRYPTS

Below the Abbey is a role playing game in the old style, made by Bickering Goat Studios. You see the world through the eyes of a party of four. You walk one square at a time, you turn a quarter turn at a time, and the game is turn based: while you are only looking, nothing happens, and when you act, the world answers.

The tale begins in the dungeons under an abbey. Four adventurers have gone down into the crypts, where the Rat King rules the vaults with an army of rats. Your game opens with the line "You wake in the crypts below the abbey. Something is scratching in the dark..." and goes on from there, out of the crypts and into a wide world of forests, towns, deserts and sea.

This chapter is the small print you need before the adventure. It tells you how to start and save the game, what every part of the screen does, how to walk, talk, open doors and chests, what lives in the menu, and how to read the maps. At the back is a page of the first ten minutes, and a keyboard and mouse chart to tear out and pin up.

The first view of a new game: the start crypt, two weapons on the floor and a barrel by the wall.

Outdoors the same screen shows a town street. The gold mark over the old man says he has a quest to give.

What you will need

- A web browser. The game runs in the page; there is nothing to install.
- A mouse and keyboard, or a touch screen, or a game pad. All three work, and you can mix them.
- Sound, if you can: there is music for every place.

STARTING THE GAME

The itch.io page runs Below the Abbey in your browser: use the button on that page to start it. The game is also kept at its Pages address, **deepspace000.github.io/Below-the-Abbey**, and it is the same game. The picture is drawn at a fixed shape (three wide to two high) and grows or shrinks to fit your window, so make the window as large as you like.

Browsers keep a page silent until you have clicked or pressed a key on it, so the music begins with your first click.

The title screen

The title screen offers up to six choices.

Continue. Opens your Autosave, or the Previous run if there is no Autosave.

New game. Takes you to the choosing of your party (below).

Load game. Opens the list of saves.

Go to area. A list of every place in the game. You pick the place, your party level and your gold, and the game drops you there. It has a search box. Use it to visit places again, or to look at a part of the game you have not reached.

Settings. See the chapter's menu section.

Exit to desktop. A browser page cannot close itself, so the game tells you to close the window or tab.

TIP: *on the title screen, pressing any key does the first thing on the list: Continue if you have a game, New game if you have not.*

The title screen of a first visit: no saves yet, so there is no Continue.

Go to area. Each place lists its creatures, potions, gold and items.

CHOOSING YOUR PARTY

New game opens a screen that asks how you want your party. There are three answers.

Ready-made. Aldric the Warrior, Vesna the Thief, Orrin the Mage and Thessaly the Priest.

Random party. Four heroes are dealt for you, and you can look them over before you begin.

Make my own. You make each of the four heroes yourself.

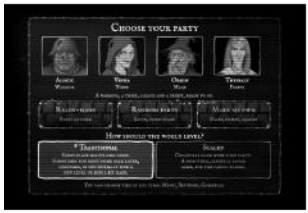
Below those buttons you decide how the world should level. **Traditional** gives every place its own level: sometimes you must come back later, stronger. **Scaled** makes creatures grow with your party, for a smoother and slightly easier game. You are not stuck with the choice: Menu, Settings, Gameplay switches it at any time.

Making a hero

Each hero is made in three steps, and the big OK button moves you on.

1. **Appearance.** Tap a portrait. The arrows at the sides turn the page to more faces.
2. **Occupation.** There are twelve: Warrior, Barbarian, Paladin, Ranger, Archer, Thief, Assassin, Mage, Sorcerer, Priest, Monk and Goat. Each shows a short description and its special power.
3. **Stats.** Spend the free points on Strength, Dexterity and Intelligence with the plus and minus buttons, then type a name (up to twelve letters) or press the dice for a random one.

When all four heroes stand in their slots, START lights up. The Default and Random buttons at the lower left fill the slots for you.



How the party is chosen.

Choosing an occupation.

Spending the free points.

SAVING AND LOADING

Save and Load.

The game saves for you, and you can save by hand as well. Your Autosave is written when you enter a new area, every three minutes of play, and when you leave or hide the browser page. Press F5, or tap the little floppy disk in the top left corner of the view, for a quick save.

The saves are listed under Menu, *Save / Load* (or Load game on the title screen). Each row shows the place, the faces and names of the party, the level, the round, the gold, how many heroes are alive, and the date.

SLOT	WHAT IT IS
Autosave	Written by the game. You can load or erase it, but not save over it.
Quick save	The F5 key and the floppy disk. Also has a Save button.
Slot 1, 2, 3	Yours. Each has Load, Save and Erase.
Previous run	The game you had before you began a new one. Load or erase only.
Older run	The one before that. Load or erase only.

You can save only when the round is over, and not in the middle of a talk or a cut scene. If you press Save too soon the game says “Wait for the round to finish, then save.” Erase asks twice: tap it, then tap “Sure? Tap again”.

Loading a game from inside a game first stores the one you were in as the Previous run, so a mistaken load can be undone. **Import file** takes a save file (.json) and puts it in Slot 3.

WHERE SAVES LIVE: *they are kept in your browser's own storage, on the computer you are using. Another browser or another computer has its own, empty list, and clearing the browser's site data clears the saves.*

THE MAIN SCREEN

Once the game is under way you will spend most of your time on this one screen. Every part of it is a button you can press with the mouse or a finger, and nearly all of them have a key as well. The numbers on the picture match the table.

The main screen, in the street of Thornwick. Numbers are explained in the table below.

NO.	PART	WHAT IT DOES
1	The view	What the party sees. Tap a person, chest or item in it to speak to them, open it or pick it up (if you are close enough).
2	Menu tab	Opens the menu. Key: Esc.
3	Floppy disk	Quick save. Key: F5.
4	Minimap	The ground around you. Tap it for the full map of the level. Key: M or O.
5	Day, time, season	The clock, with the season and weather beneath it.
6	Wait	The party lets a round go by. Key: Z.

7	Camp	Rest, and do the things camp allows. Key: R.
8	Potion	The chosen hero drinks your favourite healing potion. The number is how many you have. Keys: H or P.
9	Party	Four portraits with their bars. Tap one to open that hero's Items page.
10	Attack	The chosen hero strikes with the weapon in hand. Keys: Space or Enter.
11	Power	The hero's special power, with its cost (stamina or mana). Key: X.
12	Hand windows	The off hand and the second weapon. Tap to swap one into the main hand, or to drink it if it is a potion.
13	Arrows	Turn left, forward, turn right; step left, back, step right.
14	Place line	The area, the round number and your gold.
15	Quest mark	A gold **!** over a person means a quest to give. A green **?** means a finished quest to hand in.

The portraits

The portrait with the yellow frame is the hero who will act next. A small badge at its foot gives the hero's level. Beneath each portrait are four bars:

- **Red:** health, with the numbers over it (34/34).
- **Blue:** mana or stamina, the fuel for powers.
- **Thin yellow:** experience towards the next level.
- **Thin brown:** hunger. It turns orange when it gets low.

A portrait dimmed a little means that hero has acted this round. A red cross means a hero has fallen. Little squares at the top left of a portrait are afflictions that hero carries, and a row of them at the top right of the view shows what is afflicting the party (the initials beneath are the heroes it has struck). The Afflictions page, under the menu or on F, explains each one.

Rounds

Every living hero acts once in a round. When one acts, the yellow frame jumps to the next who has not. When all four have acted, creatures take their turn and the round counter in the place line goes up by one. To pass a round without acting, press **Wait**. Choose a different hero at any time by tapping the portrait (this opens the Items page) or by pressing 1 to 4 (this does not).

When no creature is near, walking does not wait for rounds at all: you simply go. When one is near, each step is a round, and the creatures move when you do. If you press a key while the party is busy, the game remembers it and does it as soon as it can.

A black rat ahead in the crypt. The plate at the upper left compares it with your party and says how hard the fight is.

A green mark over Hild the huntress: her quest is done and she is waiting to pay.

MOVING AND TURNING

The party stands in one square, facing north, east, south or west. A step moves you one square the way you face. A turn swings you a quarter of the way round. Walls, closed doors and large objects stop you with a bump; if a creature blocks the way the game says so.

Taking a step or a turn costs a minute of game time.

MOVE	KEYBOARD	MOUSE OR TOUCH
Forward	W ↑	Up arrow button
Back	S ↓	Down arrow button
Step left	A	Left arrow button
Step right	D	Right arrow button
Turn left	Q ←	Curved arrow, upper left
Turn right	E →	Curved arrow, upper right

Keep going. Hold a movement key, or keep a finger on an arrow button, and the party keeps walking until you let go. On a game pad the left stick walks and steps sideways, the D-pad walks and turns, the bumpers turn, and the right stick turns.

Facing north in the start crypt.

A quarter turn to the right: east, and a door.

One step forward and the door is close.

PEOPLE, DOORS, CHESTS AND LOOT

Talking to people

Walk into a person, or tap them, to talk. If you tap from too far away the game says "Too far away. Step closer." A speech box opens with their portrait and their words. Below it are your replies, each with a number. Tap one or press 1 to 4. Space

or Enter hurries the writing along, and Esc ends the talk.

Look for the marks. A gold **!** hangs over anyone who has a quest to give. A green **?** hangs over anyone you can hand a finished quest in to. The same marks show on the minimap and on every area map, so you can find them from afar. When a quest is ready, the line *A quest is ready. Press J.* appears at the foot of the screen.

Hild the huntress pays for her wolves. The numbered lines are your answers.

Doors

A wooden door opens when you walk into it ("You push the door open.") and stays open. A locked door says so: "The door is locked. You need a key." A rusty iron key picked up on the floor will open one; the number of keys you carry is shown at the foot of the screen and on the right. Other doors, in towns and ruins, are shut for other reasons, and the game tells you what the trouble is when you walk into them.

A closed door at the end of the start crypt.

One push, and the way is open.

Picking things up

Things lying on the floor are yours for the taking. Step onto the square, or tap the thing when you are close: "You pick up the Old Dagger." It goes into the party's shared bag. If the bag is full the game says so and leaves it there. Keys go on the key ring instead of into the bag. A torch burning in a wall bracket can be taken too, by tapping it when you are close.

You can also **drag** a thing from the floor straight onto a hero's portrait, or onto the Power or hand windows, to pick it up and put it in that hero's hand at once.

To use what you have found, open the Items page (I). Tap an item, then tap a slot on the hero to equip it there, or press the Equip button, or E. Potions and food are used from the same place. Keys 1 to 4 choose which hero you are dressing.

"You pick up the Old Dagger."

The Items page: a hero's slots on the left, the shared bag in the middle.

Chests, barrels and the rest

Barrels, crates, chests, coffins, carts, vases and the like can be opened. Walk into one, or tap it when you are near. Any gold inside is yours as you open it ("You find 10 gold."), and a window shows the rest. **Your party** is on the left, **Found here** on the right. Tap something to read it, then tap the button to take it, or press **Take all**. You can drag things across as well, and Sort tidies the bag. The same window serves for a merchant's cart, and then the button buys and sells.

A chest in the woods by Thornwick.

Opened: gold at once, then the contents.

THE MENU

Tap the Menu tab or press Esc. A tap anywhere outside the buttons, or Esc again, closes it. The menu is short, because the rest hides in two sub-menus, Settings and More.

Resume. Closes the menu.

Quests (key J). Your open and finished quests, by place. Tap a quest to circle where it is on the map.

Journal / Abilities (key L). A page of cards: see below.

Afflictions (key F). Every sickness, blessing and state, with how it feels, how you catch it and how to cure it.

Level layout (key M or O). The map of the place you are in.

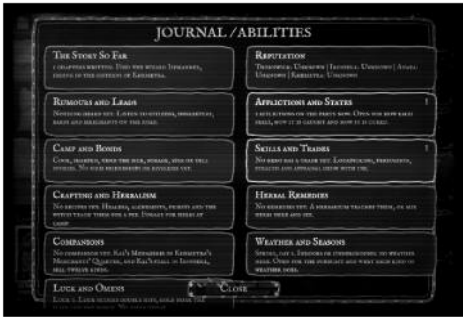
Save / Load. Your slots.

Settings. Sound, Graphics, Gameplay, Controller and Keyboard.

More. Achievements, Stats, Collection, Wandering Monsters, New party and Restart game.

Exit game. Saves your Autosave and returns to the title screen.

The menu. The keys are listed at its foot.



Journal / Abilities: eleven pages, one card each.

Journal / Abilities

Each card opens a page. A small **!** on a card means something new is waiting there. The pages are: *The Story So Far*; *Reputation* in each town; *Rumours and Leads*; *Afflictions and States*; *Camp and Bonds*; *Skills and Trades*; *Crafting and Herbalism*; *Herbal Remedies*; *Companions*; *Weather and Seasons*; and *Luck and Omens*.

Settings

Sound. Combat sounds, Ambient sounds, Music and Footsteps, each from 0 to 100 per cent in steps of ten.

Graphics. Dithering, Scanlines, Colour, Sharpening and Brightness, each with a few settings, and the CRT screen (glow and curved glass), On or Off. Colour is washed out by default, to look aged.

Gameplay. Switches between the Traditional and Scaled worlds and tells you the level of the place you are in.

Controller. A picture of the pad and what each button does.

Keyboard (key ? or F1). Every shortcut on one page.

More

Achievements. A list of every dungeon and every building, grouped by region, so you can see which you have visited.

Stats. Gold earned and spent, steps taken, days passed, places visited, quests, and a tally of monsters slain.

Collection (key U). Five logbooks to fill: Jewel Hunter, Butterfly Catching, Herb Collecting, Treasure and Shrine Logbook.

Wandering Monsters. Strange creatures that walk the levels without warning. The page is a list of question marks until you meet each one, and its About them button tells what is known of them.

New party. Back to choosing a party. The old run is kept as the Previous run if it was a real one.

Restart game. Saves an autosave and returns to the title screen.

Achievements: places and buildings visited.

Wandering Monsters, none met yet.

The Items, Character, Spells and Powers pages

The row of four tabs along the foot of the Items page opens the pages of a hero. They have keys too: I Items (the bag), C Character sheet, B Spell book, K Powers. On any of them the number keys choose the hero. The Character sheet gives level, experience, health, stamina, strength, dexterity, intelligence, armour, damage, hit chance and gold. The Powers page lists each hero's powers and has a Use button for each.

The Character sheet.

Powers: the party on the left, a hero's list of powers in the middle.

MAPS AND QUEST MARKS

The small window at the top right is the **minimap**: the squares you have seen, a gold arrow for the party, red dots for creatures near and in sight, and the quest marks. Squares you have not seen stay dark.

> ***Watch your minimap for a ?***
>
> Hidden caves and wild dungeons lie off the roads, behind the trees. When your party looks towards one, a **?** appears at the edge of the minimap and on the area maps. Follow the mark. It goes away once you have been inside.

Tap it, or press M or O, for the **level layout**: a parchment map of the whole place you are in. Drag the map to move it. The mouse wheel, or two fingers pinching, zooms it; the + and − buttons do the same, **Fit** shows the whole map and **You** centres it on the party. The legend marks quests, shops and doors, people, and gates or exits.

The **World map** button opens the map of the lands, with every region, its name and the levels of its places. It can be dragged and zoomed too, and **Level map** takes you back. Esc closes whichever you are on.

The illuminated map of Thornwick, with its key.

The world map: the western lands with the Hollow Lands, and the far chart beyond. Open it from the level map with the World map button.

The marks, once more

A gold **!** is a quest waiting to be given. A green **?** is a quest ready to be handed in. They hang over the person in the 3D view, and the same marks are on the minimap and every area map. Never a gold question mark: gold is for new, green is for done.

TIME, HUNGER AND REST

Beneath the minimap runs the clock: *Day 1 08:00*, and under it the season and the weather. A new game starts at eight in the morning of day one, in spring. Each step, turn and round costs a minute. A night's rest costs eight hours. There are four seasons, Spring, Summer, Autumn and Winter, each thirty days long. The sky follows the clock, so out of doors the light fades towards evening and the nights are dark.

Every hero has a hunger bar, the thin brown line under the portrait, from full (100) down to nothing. It sinks as time passes, and food fills it. A hero below a quarter is "hungry", and at nothing is starving and loses health as the minutes go by. The Items page shows the exact figure for the chosen hero.

Press **Camp** (or R) to rest. You cannot rest with enemies close by. Camp opens a page of choices: resting the night heals everyone (a starving hero heals only to half) and restores mana and stamina. A fallen hero gets up again at half health. The same page offers cooking, mending the gear, tending the sick, tales round the fire, sparring and foraging. Full details of food, camp and bonds are in Chapter 2.

Thornwick at dusk (18:48).

The same street at 23:00.

THE FIRST TEN MINUTES

"You wake in the crypts below the abbey. Something is scratching in the dark..."

1. **Choose a party.** If you are new, take the Ready-made party and the Traditional world, and press start.

2. **Look about.** You are in the start crypt, and a few weapons and a potion lie on its floor. Step onto each to collect it.
3. **Dress the party.** Press I. Choose a hero with 1 to 4, tap an item, then tap a slot to put it on. Do the same for each hero. Press I again to close.
4. **Open the door.** Walk into the door to the east. Beyond it is the armoury, where a shield, a jerkin and a lantern wait to be picked up. Keep an eye on the minimap; it fills in as you go.
5. **Meet the rats.** Sooner or later a rat comes into view. When a creature comes into view a plate shows its name, level and how hard a fight it will be. Press **Attack** for the hero in the yellow frame, then the next hero, and so on. Use **Power** when you want a stronger blow and have the stamina.
6. **Mind the health bars.** Press **Potion** to heal the chosen hero. When the fight is over, **Camp** will mend everyone.
7. **Search.** Open barrels and coffins, and pick up every key.
8. **Save.** Press F5 before anything that frightens you.
9. **Climb out.** Take the stairs up, and when you reach a town, talk to everyone. Follow the gold marks, and open the quest log with J.

KEY REFERENCE

Every main action has a key. The Keyboard page in Settings (or ? or F1) lists them all.

KEY	WHAT IT DOES
W ↑	Forward
S ↓	Back
A	Step left
D	Step right
Q ←	Turn left
E →	Turn right
Space Enter	Attack
X	Special attack or spell
H P	Drink a healing potion
Z	Wait a turn
R	Rest and camp
1–4	Choose a hero
I	Items (the bag)
C	Character sheet

KEY	WHAT IT DOES
B	Spell book
K	Powers
J	Quests
L	Journal / Abilities
F	Afflictions
U	Collection
M O	Map of this level
T	Teleport stones
Esc	Menu, or close a screen
G	Dig with a shovel
N	Catch a butterfly
F5	Quick save
? F1	The Keyboard page

KEYBOARD AND MOUSE QUICK REFERENCE

A two page spread to pin up beside the screen.

Walking

W ↑	Forward
S ↓	Back
A D	Step left, step right
Q ← E →	Turn left, turn right

Fighting

Space Enter	Attack
X	Power or spell
H P	Potion
Z	Wait
R	Camp
1–4	Choose hero

Pages

I C B K	Items, Character, Spells, Powers
J L F U	Quests, Journal, Afflictions, Collection
M O	Level map
T	Teleport stones
Esc	Menu / close
F5	Quick save
? F1	Keyboard page

Out and about

G	Dig with a shovel
N	Catch a butterfly

In the bag

E	Equip or use
U	Unequip
S	Sort
Y	Herbal Remedies

The game's own Keyboard Shortcuts page (Settings, Keyboard).

Mouse and touch

Tap an arrow	Step or turn. Hold it to keep going.
Tap a person	Talk (step close first).
Tap a chest, barrel, crate	Open it.
Tap an item on the floor	Pick it up.
Tap a wall torch	Take it.
Drag a floor item to a portrait	Pick up and equip.
Tap a portrait	That hero's Items page.
Tap Wait, Camp, Potion	As the keys Z, R, H.
Tap the minimap	Level map.
Tap the Menu tab	Menu.
Tap the floppy disk	Quick save.
Wheel, or drag a list	Scroll the bag, quest log, lists.
Wheel, or pinch, on a map	Zoom. Drag to move.

Game pad

Left stick	Walk, step sideways	A	Attack, talk, use
D-pad	Forward, back, turn	B	Wait a round
Bumpers	Turn left, turn right	X	Special attack
Triggers	Previous, next hero	Y	Inventory
Right stick	Turn	Start	Menu
Back	Map	Stick presses	Left: potion. Right: rest.

HINT: *in menus, talks and shops the D-pad jumps between buttons, the left stick moves a pointer, A presses and B goes back.*

CHAPTER 2

Your Party and Combat

Four heroes go down into the dark. This is how they fight, how they fall, and how they get up again.

YOUR PARTY

You never play a lone adventurer in Below the Abbey. You steer a party of four, and the party lives or dies together. Their faces stand in a row along the bottom of the screen. Under each face are four thin bars: **health** in red, **stamina or mana** in blue, **experience** in yellow and **hunger** in brown. The small badge in the corner of a face is the hero's level, and the health bar carries the numbers, such as 34/34.

The first two portraits are your **front line** and the last two are your **back line**. When an enemy chooses whom to strike, a hero in the front line is three times as likely to be picked as one in the back. Keep your frail spell casters and healers at the back, as the ready-made party does.

Tap a portrait to choose which hero acts (in the pack screen you may also press 1 to 4). A darkened face means the hero has already acted this round. A face crossed with a red cross means the hero has fallen.

Aldric
Warrior

Vesna
Thief

Orrin
Mage

Thessaly
Priest

The ready-made party: a warrior, a thief, a mage and a priest, ready to go.

Making your own

On a new game you choose **Ready-made** (the four above), **Random party** (look, then start) or **Make my own**. Making your own means, for each hero, choosing a face from seventy portraits, a name, one of twelve occupations, and then spreading **3 free stat points** over Strength, Dexterity and Intelligence. The same screen asks how the world should level: see Party Level and the World.

THE TWELVE OCCUPATIONS

Every hero has one occupation. It sets their starting health, whether they run on **stamina** or **mana**, their three stats, their basic chance to hit, and what they gain at each level. These are the real level 1 numbers, before any gear.

CLASS	HEALTH	POOL	STR	DEX	INT	HIT	EACH LEVEL
Warrior	34	10 Stamina	14	8	4	85%	+6 health, +1 stamina, +1 STR, and +1 DEX every second level
Barbarian	40	8 Stamina	16	7	3	80%	+7 health, +1 stamina, +1 STR, and +1 DEX every second level

Paladin	32	10 Mana	13	7	8	85%	+5 health, +1 mana, +1 STR, and +1 INT every second level
Ranger	26	10 Stamina	10	13	7	88%	+4 health, +1 stamina, +1 DEX, and +1 STR every second level
Archer	22	12 Stamina	8	15	6	90%	+3 health, +1 stamina, +1 DEX, and +1 STR every second level
Thief	24	12 Stamina	8	14	6	92%	+4 health, +1 stamina, +1 DEX, and +1 STR every second level
Assassin	22	12 Stamina	9	14	7	90%	+3 health, +1 stamina, +1 DEX, and +1 INT every second level
Mage	16	14 Mana	4	8	14	80%	+3 health, +2 mana, +1 INT, and +1 DEX every second level
Sorcerer	18	16 Mana	5	7	15	78%	+3 health, +2 mana, +1 INT, and +1 DEX every second level
Priest	26	12 Mana	10	8	10	85%	+5 health, +2 mana, +1 INT, and +1 STR every second level
Monk	28	10 Stamina	11	12	8	90%	+5 health, +1 stamina, +1 DEX, and +1 STR every second level
Goat	30	8 Stamina	12	10	5	82%	+6 health, +1 stamina, +1 STR, and +1 DEX every second level

Stamina and mana work the same way: both pay for powers and both come back at the same rate. The names only tell you what kind of effort the power costs. Warriors, Barbarians, Rangers, Archers, Thieves, Assassins, Monks and the Goat use stamina. Paladins, Mages, Sorcerers and Priests use mana.

STRENGTH, DEXTERITY, INTELLIGENCE

Each hero has three stats. Every one of them has a plain job in the rules.

STRENGTH

Adds **1 to weapon damage for every 4 points above 8**. Heavy weapons and armour demand it: the Rusty Sword and the Iron Helm want STR 8, the Hand Axe wants 10. The party's **combined Strength** also sets how much you can carry: **20 kg plus 1.6 kg for every point** of combined Strength, and 36 pack slots plus half a slot per point. Go over the limit and the party is overloaded: it walks at half speed and every hero loses 10 points of hit chance.

DEXTERITY

Adds **0.6% to hit chance for every point above 8** (and takes it away below 8). Bows ask for it (the Short Bow wants DEX 8). It is the first stat of the Ranger, Archer, Thief, Assassin and Monk.

INTELLIGENCE

Adds **1 spell damage for every 3 points above 10**, and adds 1 to every heal for each 3 points above 8. A staff wants INT 6.

HEALTH

When it reaches nothing, the hero falls. Rings and armour can add to it, and so can some powers.

ARMOUR

Armour does not soak up damage. Instead every point of armour takes **3%** off an enemy's chance to hit that hero.

LEVELS AND EXPERIENCE

Heroes earn experience (XP) from every creature the party kills. Each living hero receives the **full** amount: it is not divided among the four. A hero who has fallen earns nothing, so keep everyone on their feet.

A creature is worth its base XP times its own level, but one far below the party is worth less: **6% less for every level** the party average stands above it, never dropping below 30% of the full reward. The fat rewards are in the creatures that stand at or above your level.

The XP needed for the next level is **15 x L x (L + 1)**, where L is the hero's current level. The bar restarts at zero each level.

When a hero levels up, a gold banner lists exactly what rose. They gain the health and stamina or mana shown in the table above, **+1 to their first stat** every level and **+1 to their second** every second level. They are healed by one and a half times their health gain, and their mana or stamina is refilled. Any new power is announced on the banner too.

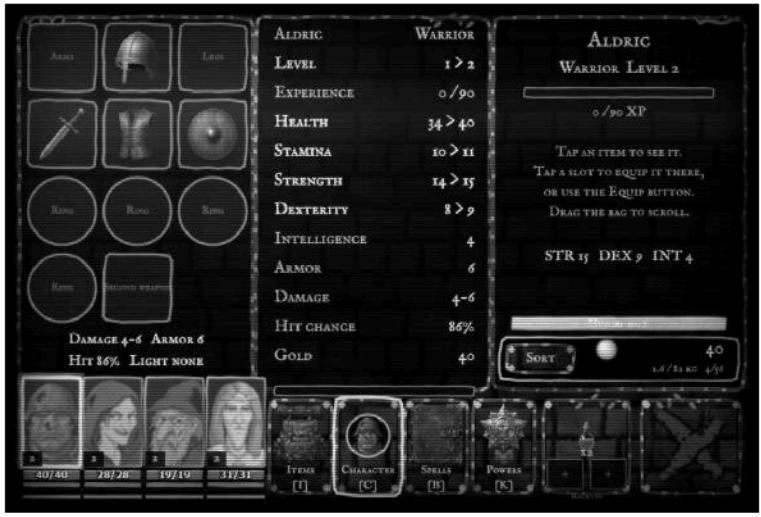
TO REACH LEVEL	XP NEEDED	TO REACH LEVEL	XP NEEDED
2	30	7	840
3	90	8	1080
4	180	9	1350
5	300	10	1650
6	450	11	1980

Each figure is the XP for that one level, counted from the last.

Two heroes have just earned a level. The banner shows each stat that rose and by how much, and the message line repeats the news.

THE CHARACTER SHEET

Open the pack screen with I and tap the face tab, or press C. The sheet lists the chosen hero's level, experience (with the XP still to go), health, stamina or mana, the three stats, armour, damage range, hit chance and the party's gold. The paper doll to the left shows what the hero wears and wields. The four tabs along the bottom are **Items** I, **Character** C, **Spells** B and **Powers** K. Tap another face to read another hero.



Aldric's sheet just after his first level. Stamina 10 to 11, Strength 14 to 15 and Dexterity 8 to 9 are shown in gold because they rose.

POWERS AND ABILITIES

Every occupation owns nine powers, and each one is waiting on a level. They come at levels **1, 10, 20, 30, 40, 50, 60, 70 and 80**. The first is the hero's **special** and is there from the start. Some of the others are **passive**: always on, nothing to press. The rest are **active**: they cost stamina or mana and are used on demand. The last, at level 80, is a passive capstone.

Press K in the pack screen for the **Powers** page. The left-hand list shows the whole party and what each hero has set. The middle list shows every power of the chosen hero, locked ones greyed with the level they open at. Tap one to read it. For an active power you may choose **Set as special**, which puts it on the special button beside Attack, or **Use now**.

The **special button** shows the power's name and cost. A hero without enough stamina or mana cannot use it. Every hero regains **1 point of stamina or mana at the end of each round**, and a full rest refills the pool.

The Powers page. Aldric is level 30, so Power Strike, Iron Skin, Cleave and Battle Cry are open. Cleave is selected: two swings that never miss, 5 stamina.

The Spells page of the mage: Firebolt, Frost Shard and Light.

Scrolls: the Mage and Sorcerer

The Mage and the Sorcerer do not have a fixed first power. Their special is **Spell**: it casts whichever spell scroll is active in the Spells tab (B). The Sorcerer adds +2 to the damage. Spell scrolls go into the four spell slots, and only these two occupations can use them. The Mage begins with the Firebolt scroll.

Firebolt

4 mana, range 3	6 to 10 damage, plus 1 for every 3 points of INT above 10, plus the magic of a staff, plus +2 for a Sorcerer.

Frost Shard

3 mana, range 3	4 to 7 damage (same bonuses) and the target is frozen stiff for its next turn.

Light
2 mana — Conjures a glowing orb: the party sees much further for 40 rounds.

A staff such as the Gnarled Staff adds 2 to the power of spells. The Mage, like everyone, also swings a weapon with the Attack button when mana runs dry.

THE POWERS OF EACH OCCUPATION

These lists are taken straight from the game. In each, the label at the left gives the level the power opens at and what it costs. “Critical hit” means a blow that lands for 1.5 times damage (see How Combat Works). Where a power says “weapon damage”, it means the hero's normal damage roll with the weapon in hand.

Warrior

Power Strike
Lv 1, 4 stam. — A crushing blow: double weapon damage plus 2.

Iron Skin
Lv 10, passive — Armor +2.

Cleave
Lv 20, 5 stam. — Two heavy swings that never miss, each at 1.2 times weapon damage.

Battle Cry
Lv 30, 6 stam. — The whole party deals 25% more damage for 8 rounds.

Veteran
Lv 40, passive — Max health +15 and +5% to hit.

Shield Wall
Lv 50, 6 stam. — The whole party gains +4 armor for 8 rounds.

Executioner
Lv 60, passive — +10% chance of a critical hit.

Titan's Fury
Lv 70, 10 stam. — Four times weapon damage plus 4.

Warlord
Lv 80, passive — Max health +30, all damage +10%.

Thief

Twin Stab
Lv 1, 3 stam. — Two attacks that never miss: double weapon damage in total.

Nimble
Lv 10, passive — Enemies miss 8% more often.

Smoke Bomb
Lv 20, 4 stam. Every enemy within 3 tiles is stunned for a turn.

Lucky
Lv 30, passive Enemies drop 30% more gold.

Flurry
Lv 40, 5 stam. Three attacks that never miss, each at full weapon damage.

Shadow Step
Lv 50, passive +10% chance of a critical hit and enemies miss 5% more often.

Death Mark
Lv 60, 6 stam. Three and a half times weapon damage.

Master Thief
Lv 70, passive All damage +20% and 50% more gold.

Ghost
Lv 80, passive Enemies miss 10% more often and +10% chance of a critical hit.

Mage

Spell
Lv 1, spell Casts the active spell chosen in the spell tab.

Arcane Mind
Lv 10, passive Spell damage +15%.

Mage Armor
Lv 20, 4 mana The whole party gains +3 armor for 8 rounds.

Mana Well
Lv 30, passive Recover 1 mana every 3 rounds.

Fireball
Lv 40, 8 mana Fire hits every enemy within 3 tiles for 14-20.

Spell Mastery
Lv 50, passive Spell damage +25%.

Chain Lightning
Lv 60, 9 mana Lightning hits every enemy within 4 tiles for 12-18.

Meteor
Lv 70, 14 mana A meteor hits every enemy within 4 tiles for 28-40.

Archmage
Lv 80, passive Spell damage +30% and recover 1 mana every 3 rounds.

Priest

Heal
Lv 1, 4 mana Heals the most wounded ally for 8-12, and far more as the priest grows in level.

Faith
Lv 10, passive Healing is 20% stronger.

Blessing
Lv 20, 5 mana — The whole party deals 20% more damage for 8 rounds.

Mend
Lv 30, 7 mana — Heals every living ally for 6-10.

Sanctuary
Lv 40, passive — Armor +3 and max health +8.

Revive
Lv 50, 12 mana — Raises one fallen ally with 40% health.

Greater Heal
Lv 60, 8 mana — Heals the most wounded ally for 24-34.

Divine Intervention
Lv 70, 16 mana — Heals every living ally for 35% of their maximum health.

Saint
Lv 80, passive — Healing is 30% stronger and max health +20.

The other eight occupations

Powers marked (p) are passive. All the others are active, and their cost and effect are on the Powers page in the game. The special at level 1 comes first.

CLASS	POWERS, IN ORDER OF LEVEL (1, 10, 20, 30, 40, 50, 60, 70, 80)
Barbarian	Rage Blow, Thick Hide (p), Bloodlust, Berserker (p), Savage Roar, Unbreakable (p), Whirlwind, Avatar of Ruin, Primal Rage (p)
Paladin	Smite, Blessed Armor (p), Lay on Hands, Undead Bane (p), Divine Shield, Crusader (p), Holy Wrath, Judgment, Aura of Light (p)
Ranger	Aimed Shot, Keen Eyes (p), Pinning Shot, Woodcraft (p), Rapid Fire, Deadeye (p), Hunter's Mark, Arrow Storm, Master of the Wild (p)
Archer	Volley, Steady Aim (p), Piercing Shot, Quick Draw (p), Triple Shot, Eagle Eye (p), Arrow Rain, Perfect Shot, Legendary Marksman (p)
Assassin	Backstab, Poise (p), Vanish, Cold Blood (p), Nerve Strike, Shadowblade (p), Assassinate, Death's Embrace (p), Angel of Death (p)
Sorcerer	Spell, Innate Power (p), Siphon, Wild Magic (p), Frost Nova, Overchannel (p), Lightning Storm, Cataclysm, Living Storm (p)
Monk	Palm Strike, Inner Calm (p), Flurry of Blows, Iron Body (p), Stunning Fist, Ki Mastery (p), Dragon Kick, Perfect Harmony (p), Enlightenment (p)
Goat	Headbutt, Tough Hide (p), Stubborn (p), Charge, Surefooted (p), Scavenger (p), Rampage, Legend of the Mountain, Mountain King (p)

THE WIZARD'S SPELLS

Any hero, of any occupation, can learn more. Two wizards sell spells: **Zahir, the court wizard** in Khemetra, and **Corvin, the hedge wizard** in Ironhill. Each class is offered five spells fitted to its trade, at levels 10, 20, 30, 40 and 50. A hero must have reached the level before the spell can be bought.

SPELL LEVEL	PRICE	COST TO CAST
10	500 gold	6
20	1000 gold	9
30	1500 gold	12
40	2000 gold	15
50	2500 gold	18

A bought spell is memorised by that hero alone, and it joins the end of their Powers page. Mages, Sorcerers and Priests are also offered one extra "grand" spell at level 30: Arcane Lance and Chain Lightning for 2400 gold, Smiting Light for 2200, each costing 16 to cast.

Wizard spells do things that ordinary powers do not: they hold, put to sleep, scare, blind, curse and confuse enemies, set them on fire, turn them into sheep and cows, or send them to the rift. Bosses and the mightiest creatures shrug off the hold, sleep, fear, confuse and polymorph effects (half the time they resist them outright).

CLASS	SPELLS AT LEVELS 10, 20, 30, 40, 50 (AND THE GRAND SPELL)
Warrior	Intimidating Shout, Shield Wall, Hamstring, Battle Standard, Warlord's Challenge
Thief	Pickpocket, Smoke Bomb, Venom Blade, Befuddle, Master Heist
Mage	Hold Person, Polymorph: Sheep, Mirror Images, Disintegrate, Time Stop, Arcane Lance
Priest	Purify, Turn Undead, Sanctuary Ward, Divine Wrath, Resurrection, Smiting Light

Each spell is described in the shop. Two examples: Mage Hold Person freezes the foe ahead for 5 rounds; Priest Resurrection raises every fallen hero at 70% health.

There is no guard stance and no flee button. The only way out of a fight is to win it, or to walk away.

HOW COMBAT WORKS

Combat is turn based. Nothing happens until you act, and nothing moves while you think. The game works in **rounds**, and a round has two halves: first your four heroes, then the enemies.

A round, step by step

1. **Choose a hero** and give them an action. Press Space to Attack, X for the special power, P to drink the favourite potion, or tap the off-hand and second-weapon windows beside the special button to use what they hold.
2. **Each living hero acts once.** When a hero has acted, their face darkens and the next hero who can still act is chosen. You may act in any order by tapping a face.
3. As soon as the last hero has acted, **every enemy takes its turn**, one after another.

4. Then the round ends: every hero recovers 1 stamina or mana, timed powers and buffs count down one round, and a new round begins.

Every step you take is a round too, worth one minute on the party clock, and enemies near you take their turn after it. Turning on the spot costs a minute but gives them no turn. Press Z or tap **Wait** to pass the whole round without acting: every hero skips, and the enemies move. The game has no separate guard stance and no flee button. To avoid a fight, back away and shut a door, or simply walk out of the creature's sight.

A rat has bitten Aldric for 7. His face is washed red, a number floats up from it, his health reads 13/34, and the message line names the biter. On the foe's plate the verdict reads Deadly because this rat is level 8.

Reading the blows

Every blow leaves a mark you can read. A **gold number** pops up over a foe that is hit. A **red number** floats up from the portrait of a hero who is hurt, and the portrait is washed red for a moment before it fades. A **green plus number** marks a heal. The Attack and special buttons flash a little picture of the blow: a slash, a thud, an arrow, a burst of magic or a holy cross. And the message line at the foot of the view always spells it out, with names and numbers.

Who can be hit, and from where

Your heroes strike the creature **straight ahead**. A sword, axe, mace, dagger or fist reaches 1 tile. A bow reaches further: the Short Bow shoots up to **3 tiles**, and the Nymph's Bow up to 5. A bow hits the first enemy in line within its reach, even one standing next to you. If nothing is in reach, the game says so and the turn is not spent.

Enemies, however, can attack from any side. Messages tell you when a blow comes **from the side** or **from behind**.

Move to face the foe that matters, and mind your back in a corridor.

Hit chance, damage and critical hits

Hit chance. A hero's chance to hit is: the occupation's base (see the table), plus the weapon's own bonus (a Dagger +4%, a Hand Axe -5%, a bare fist -10%), plus 0.6% for each point of DEX above 8, plus rings and passives. It is never below **20%** or above **97%**. Against flying creatures such as bats, subtract 20 points. An overloaded party loses 10. You can read your number on the character sheet.

The special powers of most occupations **never miss**: Power Strike, Twin Stab and the like do not roll to hit at all.

Damage. A weapon has a damage range, such as 3 to 5 for the Rusty Sword. The game rolls inside the range, then adds the Strength bonus (1 per 4 STR above 8) and any ring bonus. A bare fist does 1 to 2 (the Monk 3 to 5 and the Goat 2 to 5). Special powers multiply the roll: Power Strike is double plus 2, the Barbarian's Rage Blow two and a half times.

Critical hits. Every weapon has a small chance of a critical hit, worked out from its price: 1% for the cheapest, rising to a ceiling of 30% for the finest, plus whatever the weapon, rings and passive powers add. A critical hit does **1.5 times** damage, and the message line says *(critical! x1.5)*. A priest's heal can crit too: about one heal in eight is a critical heal, 75% stronger.

A critical hit: a burst on the foe and the words CRITICAL 1.5x damage.

A miss. The message line simply says that Vesna misses.

Bows and spells

A hero with a bow in hand shoots instead of swinging, at any foe up to the bow's reach, with a small bonus to hit (the Short Bow +2%). The Ranger and Archer's powers are all about the bow: Aimed Shot never misses and reaches 3 tiles, Volley fires two arrows that never miss up to 4 tiles. Archers and rangers can therefore hurt a foe before it reaches the party.

A spell is cast the same way, from the special button: Firebolt and Frost Shard reach 3 tiles and, like a bow, hit the first enemy in line. A spell has no hit roll. If no foe is in its path, the cast is cancelled and nothing is spent.

Orrin's Firebolt, cast at a foe 2 tiles away. A fire orb bursts on the rat and the number 9 floats up. The message says Firebolt hits for 9.

Thessaly's Heal. A holy cross glows, Aldric is healed for 9, and a green number floats over his portrait.

Healing in a fight

The Priest's **Heal** (4 mana) restores 8 to 12 health to the **most wounded** living ally, plus 1 for each 3 points of INT above 8, plus a bonus that grows with the priest's level. Heal fails with a message if everyone is already healthy. Healing potions are an action too: the **Potion** button on the right drinks the potion shown on it (your favourite if you have chosen one, otherwise the best) on the chosen hero (the Healing Potion restores 30 health, the Strong one 90 from level 20, and bigger ones come later). Drinking uses the hero's turn.

THE ENEMY'S TURN

Most creatures start **unaware**. Some patrol, some stand still. A creature notices the party if you come within about 6 tiles and it can see you or reach you quickly, or the moment it is hurt or missed. Once **alert**, it walks straight at you by the shortest way, one tile at a time.

Fast creatures (bats and wolves among them) get **two moves** in a turn. Bats flutter about at random about one move in three. Archers and bounty hunters shoot from 2 tiles away. A frozen or stunned creature loses its next turn. The Barbarian's Savage Roar, the Thief's Smoke Bomb and a Sorcerer's Frost Nova can do this to several at once.

When a creature reaches the tile next to you, it **attacks**. It chooses one living hero. A hero in the front line is three times as likely to be picked as one in the back.

The creature's chance to hit is its own accuracy, less **3% for each point of the hero's armour**, less any dodge bonus, never under 10% or over 95%. A hit does damage inside its range and the hero's portrait washes red.

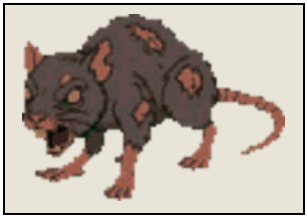
What the creatures are made of

A creature has a level, and its level sets its strength: **health grows by 45% of the base for each level above 1**, and **damage by 30%** (and the result is then halved). Its XP grows in step. Here are the real numbers for a few of the creatures of the first crypts and roads. The accuracy is the creature's own, before your armour is counted.

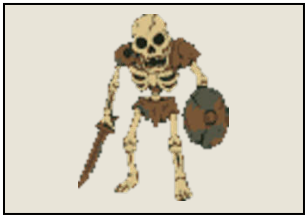
CREATURE	ACCURACY	LEVEL 1	LEVEL 3	LEVEL 5	LEVEL 10

Black Rat	70%	50 HP, hits 2-4 40 XP	95 HP, hits 2-6 120 XP	140 HP, hits 3-8 200 XP	253 HP, hits 6-13 400 XP
Cave Bat	62%	40 HP, hits 1-3 32 XP	76 HP, hits 2-4 96 XP	112 HP, hits 2-6 160 XP	202 HP, hits 4-9 320 XP
Skeleton	72%	80 HP, hits 3-6 80 XP	152 HP, hits 5-10 240 XP	224 HP, hits 7-13 400 XP	404 HP, hits 11-22 800 XP
Grey Wolf	72%	36 HP, hits 2-3 40 XP	68 HP, hits 2-5 120 XP	101 HP, hits 3-7 200 XP	182 HP, hits 6-11 400 XP
Bandit	72%	44 HP, hits 2-4 60 XP	84 HP, hits 2-6 180 XP	123 HP, hits 3-8 300 XP	222 HP, hits 6-13 600 XP
Bandit Archer	66%	32 HP, hits 2-3 50 XP	61 HP, hits 2-5 150 XP	90 HP, hits 3-7 250 XP	162 HP, hits 6-11 500 XP
Rat King	80%	224 HP, hits 5-8 500 XP	426 HP, hits 7-12 1500 XP	627 HP, hits 10-17 2500 XP	1131 HP, hits 17-28 5000 XP

Rat King: the boss of the first crypt, always level 3 there. The Cave Bat and Grey Wolf move twice per turn; the Bandit Archer shoots from 2 tiles.



Black Rat



Skeleton

The Rat King

Read the foe before you swing

Whenever a creature stands in line ahead, up to 4 tiles away, its **plate** appears at the top of the view. It shows the creature's name and level, and a tall red bar at the left holds its health as a number. The small panel beneath compares the foe with your party: **level** for each, **health** for each, and a gauge that gives the fight a verdict of **Trivial, Easy, Fair fight, Hard** or **Deadly**, with a guess of how many rounds the party needs to win. A creature one level above the party is never rated worse than Hard; only a creature two levels above or more is ever Deadly.

Mercy

A beaten bandit may beg. When a bandit is down to about a fifth of his health, there is a fair chance he throws down his weapon. If you let him be, after three rounds he thanks you, hands over a little gold and runs, and may tell you a rumour. Strike a man who has surrendered and the game remembers it: your honour and luck fall, and word spreads in the nearest town.

AFFLICTIONS AND STATUS EFFECTS

Damp crypts, cold nights, wolves, snakes and bad pies all leave their mark. An **affliction** belongs to one hero (a few strike the whole party) and appears as a tiny picture in the corner of their face. Most take a few points off Strength, Dexterity or Intelligence until they are cured, and the stat is given back the moment they end. A stat cannot be lowered below 1. The same affliction is not put on a hero twice: a second dose only renews the first.

Poison, bleeding and a few others **drain health every round** for a set number of rounds. They can cripple, but they cannot kill: a hero's health never drops below 1 from an affliction. A few conditions are good ones and show with a green frame.

Open **Menu** and the **Afflictions and States** page to read about every one. It tells you how it feels, how you catch it and how it is cured. The list marks each affliction that is on a hero now, or that you have met before.

A party in trouble. The four little pictures over the first faces are afflictions. Aldric is nearly dead (6/160), Vesna's hunger bar is low, and Thessaly lies fallen under the red cross.

How the party catches things

A creature's hit can pass something on. These are the real odds:

STRUCK BY	MAY CATCH (CHANCE PER HIT THAT LANDS)
Black Rat, Rat King	Fever 12%
Cave Bat	Fever 6%
Wolf	Bleeding 20%, Flea-bitten 4%
Bandit, Bandit Archer	Bleeding 10%
Bounty hunter, hitman, guard, vulture	Bleeding 8%
Skeleton	Grave Rot 12%
Ghost, spectre, wraith	Haunted 30%, Shaken 15%
Scorpion	Venom-stung 35%
Cobra	Venom-stung 40%
Spider, viper, asp	Poisoned 35%
Mummy	Cursed 10%

Some places do it too: the cold crypts and tombs breed Grave Rot and Tomb Dust, damp caves bring Fever, and a witch's hut can lay a curse. In the open desert the sun, thirst, night cold and sandstorms bring Sunstroke, Dehydration, Frostbite and Sand-blindness. About 40 hours without a night's rest leaves the whole party **Exhausted**.

	AFFLICTION AND EFFECT	CAUGHT FROM	CURE
	Poisoned loses 2 health every round for 40 rounds	Spider bites, poisoned darts and tainted blades.	An antidote from a potion seller, or a healer. It also fades by itself after a while.
	Bleeding loses 1 health every round for 60 rounds	Wolf bites and bandit blades.	Rest, a cleansing salve, or a healer.
	Venom-stung -3 DEX, loses 1 health every round for 25 rounds	Scorpion stings and cobra fangs.	An antidote from a potion seller, or a healer.
	Fever -3 STR	Foul water in the cisterns, the bites of rats and bats.	Rest three times. A cleansing salve from a potion seller will shorten it.
	Grave Rot -3 STR	Skeletons and the damp of ancient crypts.	Resting does not help. A cleansing salve, or a healer.
	Tomb Dust -1 STR, -1 DEX	Breathing the air of sealed tombs and pyramids.	A long soak in a bathhouse clears the chest.
	Haunted -3 INT	The touch of ghosts and spectres.	A priest at a church, holy water, or laying the restless dead to rest (the Haunted Cellar quest).

	Shaken -2 INT, -1 DEX	Dark and sinister houses, ghosts, and terrible bosses.	Rest twice, or pray at a church.
	Cursed -3 DEX, whole party	Opening cursed treasure, disturbing tombs, and the touch of the pharaoh's dead.	Visit a church or a temple. The Church of Light in Khemetra will lift it.
	Sleepless -2 INT	Nights in haunted or sinister places.	A cup of sleeping tea, a healer, or a prayer at a church. It also wears off after two days.
	Exhausted -2 STR, -2 DEX, whole party	Going about forty hours without a night's rest.	Rest. One good night puts it right.
	Poorly -2 STR, -2 DEX	A night in the temple cells of Khemetra.	It passes after three days, or after three rests. A healer can cure it for a fee.
	Frostbitten -2 DEX	Spending the cold hours of the night out in the open desert.	Rest in a warm place. One rest is enough.
	Sunstroke -2 STR, -2 INT	Marching through the open dunes at midday.	Rest in the shade, or wash in a bathhouse.
	Dehydrated -2 STR	Crossing the open desert without a drink.	Reach the city: its fountains, inns and baths have water. Resting also helps.
	Sand-blinded -2 DEX	Sandstorms in the open desert.	Wash your eyes in a bathhouse, or rest a night.
	Flea-bitten -1 DEX, -1 INT	Filthy houses and the crowded lanes of the Beggars' Quarter.	A good scrub in a bathhouse.
	Food Poisoning -3 STR, loses 1 health every round for 10 rounds	Old or spoiled food.	Rest, or an antidote.
	Hangover -2 INT, -1 DEX	Strong ale at an inn.	Rest.

HEALERS: *a potion seller sells an Antidote (for poison, venom and food poisoning) and a Cleansing Salve (wounds, fever, grave rot). Churches lift curses and hauntings, bathhouses wash away sand, dust and fleas, and the camp action Tend the sick gives a chance to ease the rest.*

Good states wear a green frame: *Well Rested* (+1 STR, +1 DEX, a day, from a proper night at an inn), *Well Fed* (+2 STR, a day, from a hot meal or a camp stew), *Blessed* (+1 to all three stats for the whole party, two days, from visiting a church or temple) and *Masked* (twelve hours). *Warned by the Watch* is a mark from the city guard for walking into houses; it fades in two days.

The Afflictions and States page, open on Poisoned (Menu, then Afflictions).

RESTING AND CAMPING

Press R or tap **Camp**. You cannot rest with enemies close by. The Camp page offers **Rest the night**, which takes **8 hours** of game time, and a handful of other things to do by the fire.

A night's rest **heals every hero to full health**, refills stamina and mana, cures whatever a night cures (see the table), and **raises any fallen hero** with half their health. It also costs food: eight hours take about a third of a full hunger bar. If a hero is starving, they heal only to half, so eat first.

Sleeping out in the wild is not safe. Each night in camp away from the towns carries about a **14% chance** that thieves take 5 to 13% of your gold, and about **8%** that bandits raid the camp. A scout among you, a cat, a dog or a duck, or good luck, lowers the odds.

A bed at an inn costs a little gold (15 to 25 in the inns of the north). An inn night does everything a camp night does, tops every hero's hunger up to at least 70, and grants **Well Rested** and **Well Fed**. There is a one in eight chance of a hangover afterwards.

Around the fire

The Camp page also lists activities. **Each hero gets one choice a day** (resting is for all and uses none). Tap a face to choose who acts.

Cook a hearty meal

1 hour, 2 food — Two food items make a stew for the party: **Well Fed** (+2 Strength) for a day, and hunger filled by 40 for everyone (more with a cook's skill).

Sharpen and mend

30 minutes — The whole party deals 6% more damage for the next 400 rounds (a smith does it better).

Tend the sick
2 hours — Each affliction a healer can ease has a 35% chance of cure (a healer improves it). Others are brought a step closer to ending.

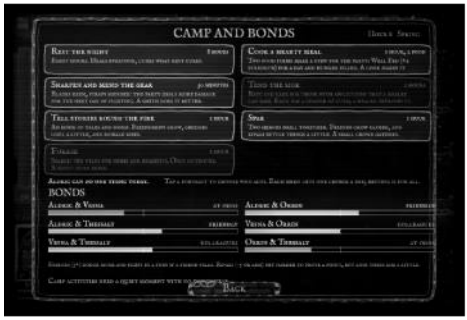
Tell stories
1 hour — Friendships grow, grudges cool, luck rises a little.

Spar
1 hour — Two heroes drill and grow closer, and the whole party earns 8 XP.

Forage
1 hour — Outdoors only. Herbs and reagents, and in the desert water.

Friends and rivals

Under the camp list, the page shows how each pair of heroes feels about each other. **Friends** (bond of 5 or more) dodge a little more, and if a friend falls they fight on in a fury: **+30% damage for 10 rounds**. **Rivals** (bond of -5 or less) hit 3% harder to prove a point, but lose 1% of their aim.



The Camp and Bonds page. The activities are at the top; the bonds between your four heroes, in bars, below.

The pack: potions, bread, cheese and an apple.

HUNGER AND FOOD

Each hero has a hunger bar from 100 down to 0. It empties at a steady rate of **25 points every 6 hours**, so a full bar lasts a whole day of game time. Walking, fighting and resting all pass the clock.

Below 25 the bar turns orange and the game says that the hero is **hungry**. At 0 the hero is **starving**: they lose 1 health every 20 minutes (never the last point), and a night's rest heals them only to half. Eating fixes all of it. Some powers slow the hunger: the Ranger's Woodcraft by 25%, the Monk's Inner Calm and the Goat's Tough Hide by 30%, the Goat's Scavenger by 50%.

Food also heals. Eat from the pack: choose the hero, the food and use it. When a hero is both unhurt and nearly full, the game tells you they are not hungry or hurt.

FOOD	KIND	HEALTH	HUNGER FILLED
Apple, Hazelnuts	Snack	6	40

Hard Cheese, Mug of Ale	Snack	8	40
Loaf of Bread, Salt Herring	Meal	16	70
Smoked Sausage	Meal	18	70
Bowl of Pottage	Meal	20	70
Meat Pie	Big meal	32	100
Roast Mutton	Big meal	36	100

BEWARE: *a mug of ale carries a one in four chance of a hangover, and herring, sausage, pottage, pie and roast each carry a one in fourteen chance of food poisoning.*

WHEN A HERO FALLS

When a hero's health reaches 0, they **fall**. Their face is dimmed and crossed with a red cross, and the message line says so. They cannot act, cannot be chosen by enemies and earn no experience. The rest of the party fights on. Falling is not final, and there are four ways back.

- **Rest.** Any night, in camp or at an inn, raises every fallen hero with half their maximum health.
- **The Priest's Revive** (a level 50 power, 12 mana) raises one fallen ally at 40% health.
- **Resurrection**, the Priest's level 50 wizard spell, raises every fallen hero at 70% and heals the living by half.
- **Friends** do not forget: a friend of the fallen fights on in a fury for 10 rounds.

If **all four** heroes fall, the game ends with *The Party Has Fallen*. The screen shows creatures slain, rounds fought, survivors, gold and the level of each hero. You may load your most recent save or return to the menu. Save before a boss.

PARTY LEVEL AND THE WORLD

Every creature has a level, and level drives everything in the table above. The game offers two ways to set the levels, chosen when you start and changeable at any time under **Menu, Settings, Gameplay**.

Traditional (the default)

Every place has its own level, and the levels climb from place to place as the story leads you on. The world map shows each place's level. If a place is too hard, come back later, stronger. The great creatures stand a few levels above their place. The first crypt climbs from level 1 at the start to 2 in the middle and 3 near the Rat King, in either mode.

Scaled

Creatures grow with your party, for a smoother and slightly easier game. If your party outgrows a creature by more than 5 levels, it is raised to between 2 and 5 levels below you, once. Great creatures always stand a fixed number of levels above the party.

A mixed crowd

In either mode creatures in one place are not all at one level. About **two in five** stand at the place's full level, about 35% stand 1 to 3 below, and a quarter stand 4 to 7 below, so each fight is a mix of tough and easy foes, and the weak ones die fast. Bosses and the great creatures are never lowered.

The party's own level

When the game needs a single number for your party, it takes the **average level of the living heroes**. That is the level the foe's plate compares against, the level that cuts XP for weak creatures, and the level the Scaled world follows. A fallen hero does not count.

CHAPTER 3

Gear, Trade and Herbs

What to carry, what to wear, what to buy and what to boil: the whole business of a well kept party.

A party is only as good as its pack. The old abbey road is long, the creatures at the end of it are patient, and a sword that is two grades too light will not forgive you. This chapter tells you how to read an item, where each thing goes, how much your heroes can carry before they slow to a crawl, and how to turn gold into gear and back again.

It also covers the quieter arts: the trades that make a hero better at shopping, mending or brewing, the herbs that grow along the road, and the little roll of lock picks that opens the doors of other people's houses. Every weapon, armour piece and ring in the game is listed in the **Appendix**, sorted by colour. This chapter explains the rules behind those lists.

THE INVENTORY SCREEN

Press [I] at any time on the road to open the party's bag. Press [I] or [Esc] to close it again. Keys [1] to [4] choose which hero you are looking at. The screen has three panels and a bottom bar, and the picture below shows all of them.

The inventory screen. Left: the hero's equipment. Middle: the party's bag. Right: the hero card, with gold, weight and the Herbal Remedies button.

Left panel: the hero

Equipment — Eleven slots laid out like a paper doll: arms, helm and legs on the top row; main hand, chest and off hand below them; four rings; and the second weapon. Under them the game adds up the hero's **Damage**, **Armor**, **Hit** chance and **Light**.

Middle panel: the bag

The bag — Three columns of squares that scroll. One bag is shared by all four heroes. A small number in a corner is a stack, such as seven healing potions.

Right panel: the card

The card — With nothing chosen it shows the hero's name, class, level and experience. Tap an item and it becomes the item's card: its numbers, its requirements, its story and its price, with **Equip** and **Discard** buttons.

Gold, weight, Sort

The purse — The coin shows how much gold the party holds (gold weighs nothing). Under it are the weight carried against the weight allowed, and the bag squares used against the squares you have. **Sort** tidies the bag into weapons, shields, helms, body armour and so on. The key is S.

The bottom bar

Tabs — Four tabs: **Items** I, **Character** C, **Spells** B and **Powers** K. Beside them is the frequent-use potion, with two small backup slots, and the red cross that closes the screen.

The Character tab: level, health, stamina, the three stats, armour, damage and hit chance.

The Spells tab of a mage: four spell slots, each filled from a scroll.

EQUIPMENT SLOTS

To equip something, tap it in the bag and press **Equip** (or press E). To take something off, tap the slot and press **Unequip** (U). You can also tap the item and then the slot you want. If the slot is full, the old item goes back into the bag, and if the bag has no room it stays where it was.

SLOT	WHAT FITS
Main hand	A weapon, a light, or a potion.
Off hand	A shield, a weapon, a light or a potion.
Second weapon	A weapon or a potion, kept ready to swap.
Head, Chest, Arms, Legs	The matching piece of armour, one of each.
Rings (four)	Any ring. Four rings at once.
Spell slots (four)	Spell scrolls. Mages and Sorcerers only.

Armour adds up: the helm, chest, arms, legs, shield and any ring that gives armour all count towards the hero's **Armor** number.

On the game screen, two small windows sit beside the special attack button. They

show the off hand and the second weapon. Tap one and it swaps places with the main hand at once, so an archer can change to a dagger when a creature closes in. A potion kept in either window is drunk with a single tap, and the next one from the bag takes its place.

HINT: *A hero who cannot use an item will tell you why. "Aldric needs STR 22 to use the Executioner's Blade" means exactly what it says. Train, level up, or put on a ring of strength.*

READING AN ITEM

Every item has a card. Read it from the top:

An item card for a Red tier sword. The right-hand panel is the whole story.

- **The name and its kind** in brackets: SWORD, CHEST, RING, SPELL.
- **The numbers.** *Damage* is the range of a normal blow. *Armor* is how much it turns aside. *Hit* is a bonus or penalty to your chance of landing a blow. A bow also shows its *Range* in squares, a staff its *Spell power*, a potion what it *Heals*, a food what it *Fills*.
- **Special lines** such as "10% to double damage" or "Items weigh 15% less".
- **Weight** in kilograms.
- **Requirements**: STR, DEX or INT in green if the hero has enough, in red if not. The line of story at the foot often ends "Needs level 20", and that counts too.
- **Price**, the amount the item is worth. In a shop this changes to what you pay and what you would be paid (see Shops and Trade).

A note on "double damage". The card says "10% to double damage". In the game's rules a lucky blow of this kind lands half as hard again as a normal one. The card name is old; the rule is the one you will see in the combat log.

WEIGHT AND THE PACK

The pack is limited in two ways at once: by the **number of squares** and by **weight**. Both grow with the party's strength, because strong hands carry more. Add up the Strength of every living hero. The bag gets:

- **36 squares**, plus **half** of that total;
- **20 kg**, plus **1.6 kg** for every point of that total.

So a party with a combined Strength of 100 has 86 squares and 180 kg. Rings of the Pack Mule, the Porter and the Great Haul add more. A donkey adds 12 squares and 30 kg; a llama adds 10 squares and 20 kg (see the Companions page of the Journal).

Each item's weight is on its card, and the party total sits under your gold. When the

load goes over the limit the number turns orange, a message appears, and the party is **overloaded**: it walks at **half speed** and fights worse (the chance to hit falls by ten points). Drop something, sell something, or put on a ring that helps. The moment the load falls under the limit the party speeds up again. A chest or shop will also refuse to hand you more than you can carry.

KIND	USUAL WEIGHT
Ring	0.1 kg
Herb, gem, butterfly	0.1 kg
Scroll	0.2 kg
Food, drink	0.4 kg
Potion	0.5 kg
Lantern, torch	1 kg
Weapon	1 to 8 kg, by damage
Armour piece	1.5 to 6 kg, plus half its armour value

Weight is the quiet enemy. Four heroes, forty swords, and not one step further.

THE COLOURS OF GEAR

Gear is graded by colour, and the Appendix follows the same grades. The colour is set by what the piece costs: a weapon's price is the guide, and armour pieces are scaled for their slot, since a pair of leggings is worth less than a breastplate of the same grade. Rings have a scale of their own.

White
Basic — Plain starting kit. Weapons cost 12 to 30 gold.

Green
A bit stronger — The first real improvements. Weapons around 120 to 260 gold.

Blue
Stronger — Better again, and usually with an effect of its own: bleeding, cleaving, a ward, a regrowing wound. Weapons 400 to 900.

Red
Next level — The grade for the middle of the game. Weapons 1,500 to 2,400.

Purple
Powerful — Heavy steel with a strong effect. Weapons 2,600 to 5,300.

Orange
The best — The finest pieces in the game: the four Kraken harpoons, the four boss weapons, the abbot's armour, and most pieces of the highest armour sets. Weapons 6,500 and more.

Higher grades are not simply bigger numbers. A Blue axe that cleaves may serve you better than a Red sword with nothing but damage, and a White lantern is worth more than most things in a Purple chest when the lights go out. Read the card.

WHITE *Basic*

GREEN *A bit stronger*

BLUE *Stronger, usually with an effect*

RED *Next level*

PURPLE *Powerful*

ORANGE *The best*

A few painted icons from each grade, White to Orange. The Appendix shows every piece.

WEAPONS AND WHAT THEY DO

Six kinds of weapon are carried in the game.

Dagger
Light, quick — Easy to hit with. Needs Dexterity.

Sword
The all-rounder — Balanced. Needs Strength.

Axe
Heavy — Hits hard, but is harder to land (a Hit penalty). Needs Strength.

Mace
Crusher — Heavy, a little hard to land, and the favourite for stunning. Needs Strength.

Bow
Ranged — Shoots at a target up to 3 to 6 squares ahead, depending on the bow. Needs Dexterity.

Staff
For casters — Hits for little but adds "Spell power" to every spell cast. Needs Intelligence.

The finer weapons carry an **effect**. The card gives it in words, and the table below explains what each one really does in a fight. A chance is rolled on every hit.

EFFECT	WHAT IT DOES
Bleed	A chance to leave the foe bleeding for a few rounds. The Serrated Cutlass: a quarter of its hits make a foe bleed for 5 each round, for 3 rounds. Bleeding grows a little as the hero levels up.
Cleave	Every hit also cuts the foe standing directly behind the first, for 60% of the damage. Swords and axes only.
Pierce	The bow's cleave. The arrow passes through and strikes the foe behind, for 80% of the damage.
Stun	A chance to knock the foe senseless: it loses its next turn. A Vanguard Claymore does this one hit in five.
Exposed (Vuln)	A chance to crack the foe's guard. For a few rounds it takes **half again** as much damage from everyone. The Spiked Maul cracks the guard three hits in ten, for 3 rounds.
Execute	A finishing blow. Against a foe below a set share of its health, damage is multiplied: the Executioner's Blade deals two and a half times damage to a foe under 30%. The Headsman's Axe deals triple under 25%.
Double shot	Bows only. A chance that a second arrow follows the first, with a full second roll of damage. The Elven Bow does it one shot in four.
Shock	A chance to throw every foe within two squares to the ground, so they lose their turn. The Doom Hammer's one in five.
Daze	A chance to leave the foe reeling, chilled for a round.

Boss slayer	Some of the greatest weapons add extra damage against bosses only (the Crownbreaker adds a half).

A smith's stock, with the Cleaving Greatsword chosen. Names, damage and what you pay are all on the card.

An armoury. The shop is the right-hand panel; your own bag stays on the left.

The Kraken harpoons

Four orange harpoons, the Ember, the Verdigris, the Silver and the Beacon, were forged for one creature only. Each does enormous damage to the Kraken (3,000 to 4,400 a hit) and next to nothing to anything else. They cannot be bought, and every hero needs one in hand. When the Kraken is dead they crumble away.

SPOILER

The Great Harpoon that the chandler Pell makes from wreck-oak is a good weapon, not a Kraken gun: damage 26 to 36, needs Strength 16.

ARMOUR, SETS AND SHIELDS

Armour comes in four body slots and the shield. Besides its **Armor** number, a good piece has a **passive** effect that is always on while it is worn. The game words them plainly:

Dodge Enemies miss	Enemies miss you a given percentage more often.
Regeneration Wounds close	You recover a little health every few rounds.
Thorns Strikers burn	Every enemy that strikes you takes a few points of damage.
Ward Blows lighter	Every blow that lands on you is a set number of points lighter.

Life drain Heals you	You heal a share of the melee damage you deal.
Second wind Once a fight	Once in thirty rounds, when below a quarter health, you heal a share of your maximum.
Power, Double Damage	All damage rises by a percentage, or you get extra double hits.
Mana flow Casters	Mana comes back faster.

Shields

A shield lives in the off hand and counts as armour. The Banded Round Shield and Kite Shield make enemies miss (4% and 6% more); the Spiked Shield and the Bulwark of Ages add thorns; the Dragon Shield does both. A shield means the hero is not carrying a second weapon or a lantern in that hand, so choose.

The Ten Great Sets

Ten full sets of armour, one for every ten levels from 10 to 100, each with a helm, a chest piece, arms and legs. Every piece has an effect of its own, and a hero who wears **all four pieces of one set** wakes the **set bonus**. Each piece says "Set: ...", and what all four give, on its card. Armouries sell the sets up to ten levels above your party, and chests give pieces from the best sets your party has reached.

LEVEL	SET	BONUS FOR ALL FOUR PIECES
10	**Boarhide** (Hunter)	Blows 2 lighter. Attackers take 3.
20	**Ironscale** (Warden)	Blows 4 lighter. Wounds close steadily.
30	**Rimeforged** (Sentinel)	Second wind (30%). Mana returns faster.
40	**Emberplate** (Champion)	Attackers take 8. All damage +8%.
50	**Sunsteel** (Paladin)	Second wind (40%). Strong regeneration.
60	**Voidglass** (Reaver)	Heals 8% of melee damage dealt. +6% double hits.
70	**Stormwrought** (Tempest)	Enemies miss 8% more. Mana returns much faster.
80	**Wyrmbone** (Slayer)	Blows 8 lighter. Attackers take 12.
90	**Starforged** (Seer)	Mana returns quickly. Second wind (40%).
100	**Godforged** (Exemplar)	Second wind (50%). Damage +10%. Blows 8 lighter.

HINT: *Mixing sets is allowed and often wise, since every piece has its own good effect. You only lose the bonus, never the pieces. A half-finished set still counts for its Armor.*

SPOILER

There is one more set, with a different story. Wake every one of the twenty stone teleporters along the Pilgrim's Path, and the abbot's armour arrives in your backpack with 1,000 gold: a mitre, a chasuble of plate, cuffs and greaves. Any class may wear it, and it carries a set bonus of its own.

RINGS

A hero wears up to four rings, and a ring costs little weight (0.1 kg). Rings are priced dearly in the shops, but they are the most flexible gear in the book. The kinds are:

- **Stats.** Strength (Ox, Titan), Dexterity (Fox, Wind), Intelligence (Owl, Sage), all three (Champion).
- **Health and mana.** Vigor, Bear, Oak; Well, Moon.
- **Fighting.** Warding and Bulwark add armour; Might and Lion add damage; Keen Eye and Hawk add to hit; Duellist adds double hits.
- **Carrying.** The Pack Mule adds 8 squares and 15 kg; the Porter adds 20 kg; the Great Haul adds 16 squares and 30 kg; the Featherweight makes everything the party carries weigh 15% less.
- **Trade.** The Craftsman adds one rank to the wearer's trade, and the Master Hand adds two (see Trades and Skills).

Stat rings change the hero while worn, so a ring of strength can lift a hero over a requirement. Take it off and the requirement bites again.

LIGHTS

Lights are held in a hand slot. A **Torch** (3 gold) gives light; a **Brass Lantern** (45 gold) gives a much wider, steadier light. Both are sold in most general stores. A torch or lantern in the bag will also burn down a dead, twisted tree that blocks the path: the torch is used up, the lantern is kept. The panel on the left of the inventory reads "Light none" until a hero holds one. Mages can also cast a Light spell from a scroll.

POTIONS, FOOD AND DRINK

The **Potion** button on the road (also H or P) drinks the party's frequent-use potion. In the inventory, drag a potion on to the large potion slot to make it the frequent-use potion, and on to the two small **Backups** beside it. When the frequent-use potion runs out, the first backup still in the bag takes its place.

Healing

POTION	HEALS	GOLD
Healing Potion	30	25
Healing Draught	60	60

Strong Healing Potion	90	75
Greater Healing Draught	120	140
Very Strong Healing Potion	210	180
Superior Healing Draught	220	320
Elixir of Life	400	700
Ultra Healing Potion	450	420
Supreme, Mythic, Divine	900, 1,800, 3,500	900 to 3,600

The Strong potion is first seen at level 20, the Very Strong at 40, the Ultra at 50, the Supreme at 65, the Mythic at 100 and the Divine at 140.

Mana and stamina

DRAUGHT	RESTORES	GOLD
Mana Draught	20	70
Greater Mana Draught	45	170
Superior Mana Draught	80	380

Brews of battle (25 rounds each)

BREW	EFFECT
Potion of Might	+25% damage
Potion of Swiftness	Foes miss 15% more
Potion of Iron Skin	+5 armour
Potion of the Keen Eye	+12% to hit

Cures

Antidote
35 gold — Cures poison, venom and food poisoning.

Cleansing Salve
40 gold — Closes wounds; clears fever and grave rot.

Holy Water
60 gold — Lifts haunting and curses, from the whole party.

Sleeping Tea
30 gold — Brings the first good sleep in days.

Potions of Red, Blue, Green and Yellow (30 gold) change nothing but the drinker's colour, for four days. They are very popular with goats.

Food and drink

Each hero has a hunger bar at the foot of the card in the inventory (**Hunger 100%**). It falls as the hours pass. Below a quarter the hero is **Hungry**, and at nothing, **Starving**. Eat by choosing the food and pressing **Use** (or E). Food also restores a little health.

FILLS	WHAT	GOLD
20	Cool Water (also heals 10)	2
40 to 45	Apple, Hard Cheese, Hazelnuts, Mug of Ale, Dates	2 to 5
70	Loaf of Bread, Salt Herring, Smoked Sausage, Bowl of Pottage	4 to 7
100	Meat Pie, Roast Mutton (both heal 32 to 36)	14 to 18

HINT: *Water is the cheapest thing in any shop and the most missed thing in the desert. Buy it before you leave town.*

QUEST ITEMS AND CURIOS

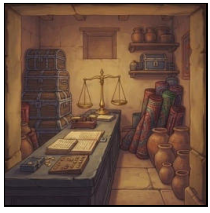
Some things are not for wearing. **Quest items** are given or found for a particular job: firewood for an innkeeper, a letter, an urn, a parcel, planks of wreck-oak. They are marked *Quest item* on the card, they weigh almost nothing, and the quest log (J) says whom they are for.

The road also gives you things to collect for their own sake: herbs, gems dug up with a shovel (G) and butterflies caught in a Butterfly Cage (N). Each weighs only 0.1 kg and is kept in the bag until you hand it in, sell it, or use it, and the Collection (U) keeps a record of them. Herbs are the most useful of these, and have their own section below.

SHOPS AND TRADE

Merchants, smiths, armourers, potion sellers, scroll sellers and bakers stand behind their counters in every town, and travelling carts and caravans stop on the roads. Walk up and talk to one, choose **Trade** or **Browse the wares**, and the shop window opens.

The window has your party on the left (blue edge) and the shop on the right (gold edge). The price of each shop item is printed on its square. Tap an item to read its card.



A merchant's strongroom, from the game.

❦ **Buy:** tap an item in the shop and press **Buy**. You pay at once and the item goes into the bag. If the bag is full, or too heavy, the shop keeps it.

❦ **Sell:** tap an item in your own bag and press **Sell**.

❦ **Sort** tidies your own bag. The coin shows what you have left.

A shop pays **40 per cent** of an item's price. That is for a stranger in a neutral town. Gold flows both ways, and many things move the figures:

- **Reputation.** Each town keeps its own opinion of your party. A town that likes you charges up to 22% less and pays you up to 12% more. A town that dislikes you charges more, and a town that has come to hate you will not serve you at all ("We do not serve your sort here").

- **Honour.** A party of good name (honour 40 or more) pays 5% less and sells for 5% more. A party of bad name pays 10% more and is paid 8% less.
- **Persuasion** lowers prices by 1% per level (best 10%); **Appraisal** raises what you are paid by 1.5% per level (best 15%).
- **The Merchant trade**: 1% either way for every rank.

A general store. The Brass Lantern is chosen: the Buy button shows the price.

Selling. The Serrated Cutlass is chosen from the bag, and the Sell button shows what you would be paid.

What the shops keep. A general store has food, water, torches, a lantern or two and lock picks, with a few plain weapons and armour. Smiths and armourers carry the better steel, and their stock grows as the party's level does. Potion sellers stock cures, healing and the brews of battle; scroll sellers stock the three scrolls and a few rings. The herbwife and the apothecary also teach the herbal arts (see below). Stock is finite: when the last of something is bought its square goes empty, and a shop with nothing left reads "Sold out".

Travelling carts keep food, water, torches, cures and the odd bargain. Desert caravans only have water and food.

HINT: *Prices are shown on the shop's squares as the price of the item, before reputation. Check what you will really pay on the card in the middle. Sell the things you no longer wear, and keep the gold for the next smith.*

TRADES AND SKILLS

Open the Journal (L) and choose **Skills and Trades**. The page has two parts.

Skills (the whole party)

Four skills grow by use, up to level 10, and a hero of the matching class adds two more levels while he or she is in the party.

SKILL	HELPED BY	WHAT IT DOES
Lockpicking	Thief, Assassin	Opens locked doors and shuttered houses.

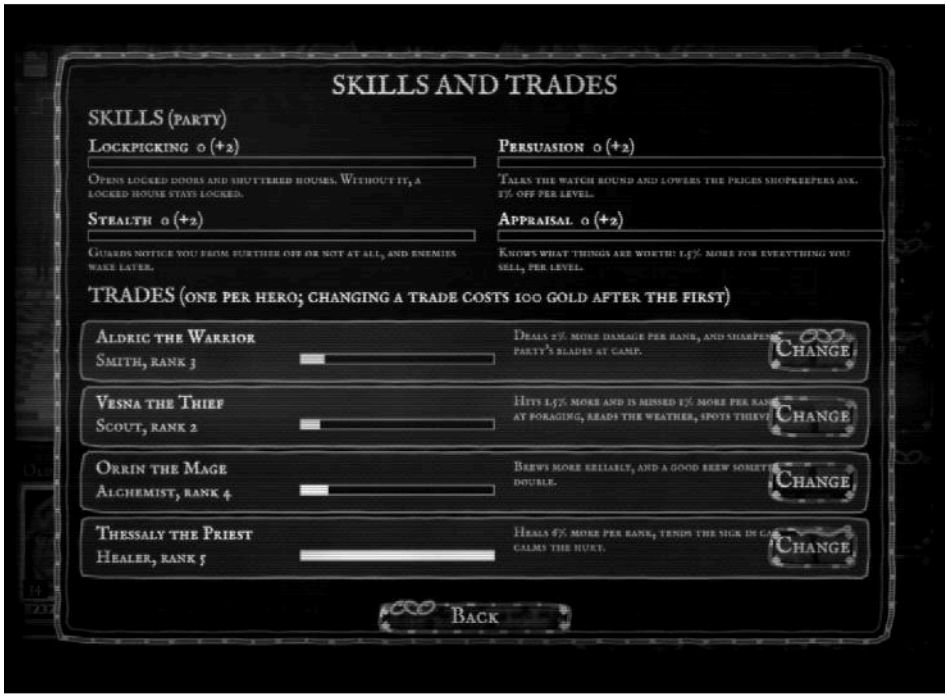
Persuasion	Paladin, Priest, Goat, Barbarian	Talks the watch round; shop prices fall 1% a level.
Stealth	Thief, Assassin, Ranger, Archer	Guards notice you later; enemies wake later.
Appraisal	Mage, Sorcerer, Monk, Warrior	You are paid 1.5% more a level when you sell.

Trades (one for each hero)

Each hero can follow one trade. A trade has five **ranks**. A hero begins at rank 1 and reaches the next with 10, 30, 70 and 140 experience in the trade. A ring of the Craftsman or the Master Hand adds ranks on top, to as many as seven.

TRADE	EACH RANK GIVES
Healer	Heals 6% more. Tends the sick at camp.
Smith	2% more damage. Sharpens blades at camp.
Scout	1.5% better to hit, 1% harder to hit. Better at foraging.
Cook	Hunger falls 8% slower. Hearty camp meals.
Alchemist	Brews more reliably, and sometimes makes double.
Merchant	Pays 1% less, sells for 1% more.

Trades grow when the hero does the work: cooking, sharpening, nursing, foraging or brewing at camp (R) each earn 2, and handing in a quest that suits the trade earns 12.



Skills and Trades: the four party skills above, and one trade for each hero below, with a bar for the progress to the next rank.

The Change Trade rule

The first time a hero takes up a trade, it costs nothing: press **Take up**. Afterwards the button reads **Change**, and every change costs **100 gold**. The game asks you first ("Change trade? It costs 100 gold"). Be warned: **Change** does not offer a list. It moves the hero on to the *next* trade in this order: Healer, Smith, Scout, Cook, Alchemist, Merchant, and back to Healer. If you pass the trade you want, you pay again. The experience a hero has in a trade is kept, and it is still there if the hero ever returns to it.

HERBALISM AND THE HERBAL REMEDIES PAGE

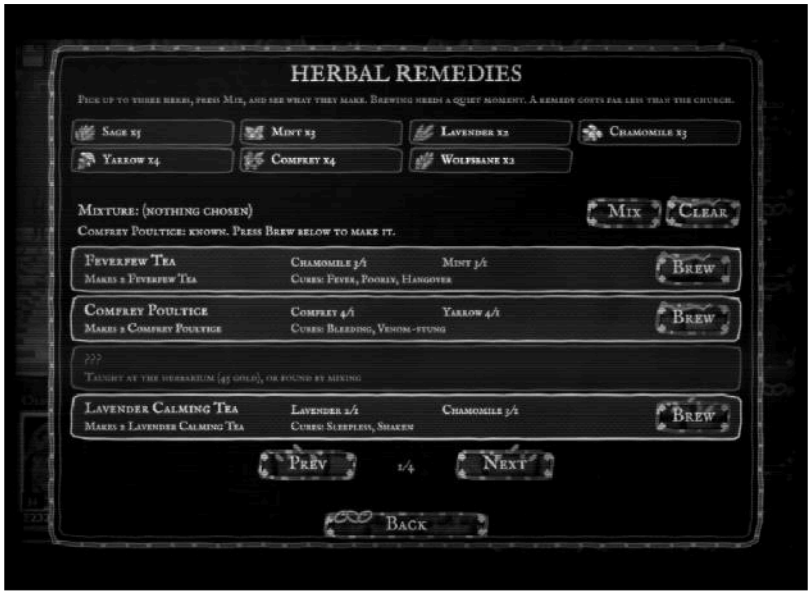
Herbs lie in the open lands: walk over one and it goes into your bag. There are twenty-eight kinds, the rarer ones growing only in wilder, higher-level lands, and a herbalist can turn them into sixteen remedies that cure what a church would charge a great deal to cure. Herbalism is a skill of the whole party and needs no trade.

Learning it. A herbarium teaches the art. Most towns have one: the herbwife, the apothecary, the healers and the potion sellers. The first lesson costs nothing and teaches the skill and three simple remedies (Feverfew Tea, Comfrey Poultice and Lavender Calming Tea). The others cost 35 to 150 gold each, or you can find them by experiment.

The page. Once the party knows herbalism, the inventory grows a **Herbal Remedies** button on the hero card, whenever no item is chosen. Press it, or press Y in the inventory, and the Herbal Remedies page of the journal opens. It lists the herbs in your bag and the remedies you know.

- **Mix.** Pick up to three herbs and press **Mix**. If they make something, you learn the recipe at once. If not, the page says "Nothing good comes of that mixture" and nothing is used.
- **Brew.** Press **Brew** beside a known remedy. You need the herbs in the bag and a quiet moment. Brewing takes half an hour and is done at camp, away from foes. It succeeds four times in five, a little oftener for an alchemist; a failure wastes half the herbs.

Most remedies cure afflictions (see the Afflictions page, key F). Brewed remedies are cheap, a good reason to keep a herb or two in the pack.



The Herbal Remedies page: your herbs on top, the Mix button, and the known remedies with their cures and a Brew button.

REMEDY	HERBS	CURES OR HEALS
Feverfew Tea	Chamomile, Mint	Fever, Poorly, Hangover
Comfrey Poultice	Comfrey, Yarrow	Bleeding, Venom-stung
Wolfsbane Tonic	Wolfsbane, Sage	Poisoned, Venom-stung, Food Poisoning
Lavender Calming Tea	Lavender, Chamomile	Sleepless, Shaken
Thyme Steam Balm	Thyme, Mint, Nettle	Tomb Dust, Grave Rot, Poorly
Marigold Healing Tonic	Marigold, Yarrow, Comfrey	Heals 120 health
Ghostcap Eyewash	Ghostcap, Dandelion	Sand-blinded
Bloodmoss Salve	Bloodmoss, Comfrey	Bleeding, Grave Rot, Flea-bitten
Frostbloom Cooling Tonic	Frostbloom, Mint	Sunstroke, Dehydrated
Emberroot Warming Draught	Emberroot, Rosemary	Frostbitten
Sunleaf Vigour Tonic	Sunleaf, Marigold	Exhausted (whole party)
Moonpetal Ward Tincture	Moonpetal, Lavender	Haunted, Cursed (whole party)
Dreamthistle Draught	Dreamthistle, Chamomile	Sleepless, Exhausted, Hangover (whole party)
Dragon's Tongue Cleanser	Dragon's Tongue, Nettle	Poisoned, Food Poisoning, Tomb Dust, Fever (whole party)

Silverleaf Healing Elixir	Silverleaf, Sunleaf, Yarrow	Heals 300 health
Mandrake Restorative	Mandrake, Bloodmoss, Sage	Heals 500 health to every hero

Other recipes are taught by healers, alchemists, priests, the witch and swordsmiths for 30 to 100 gold each, and are brewed the same way at camp: Antidote, Cleansing Salve, Sleeping Tea, Holy Water, Healing and Mana Draughts, Potion of Swiftness and Potion of Iron Skin. Look at the **Crafting and Herbalism** page of the Journal.

SCROLLS AND SPELLS FROM SCROLLS

Mages and Sorcerers do not learn spells in schools. They read them from scrolls. A scroll is an item like any other: buy it, put it in one of the hero's four **spell slots** (on the Spells tab, B) and the spell is ready. The slot marked **Active** is the one the hero will cast. No other class can use a spell scroll: the game says so if you try.

Scroll: Firebolt
60 gold — A bolt of fire. 4 mana. Damage 6 to 10. Reaches 3 tiles.

Scroll: Frost Shard
80 gold — Ice that also freezes the target for a turn. 3 mana. Damage 4 to 7. Reaches 3 tiles.

Scroll: Light
50 gold — A glowing orb lights the way for 40 rounds. 2 mana.

A staff adds its Spell power to every spell, and the mana draughts refill the well. A mage who has no scroll in a slot has nothing to cast, so a few spare scrolls are cheap insurance. The scrolls are sold at the scroll sellers, such as the Silver Quill and the House of Seven Scrolls in Khemetra, and at the witch's shelf.

KEYS AND LOCK PICKS

Keys. In the old dungeons a rusty iron key opens one locked door: the HUD shows **KEY** while you hold one, and the key is used up. A golden key opens a tomb door that no iron key will.

Lock picks. About one house door in three, in any town or village, is locked. A locked door needs a real set of **Lock Picks**: a small roll of wrenches and hooks, 25 gold, sold by every trader. The door tells you your chance before you try. The chance rises with your Lockpicking skill and a little with your luck, and is never below 8% or above 95%.

- Success: the door opens, but one time in four the pick is bent beyond use.
- Failure: the pick snaps and is used up. A neighbour may hear the noise.
- Breaking in costs a little Honour, and a neighbour who sees you will think worse of your party. The town's opinion of you counts at the shop counter, so pick your doors with care.

A hero with no lock picks cannot open a locked house at all. A Thief or Assassin in the party adds two levels of skill. **Buy a few.**

Everything you could ever carry is listed in the **Appendix**.

CHAPTER 4

The History of the Land

Rats in the crypt, wolves in the wood, a ledger, a warrant and a sea with something in the middle of it: how your four heroes came to be where they are.

How to read this chapter

This chapter is a history book for the lands of the game, in the manner of the old "Story" chapters in the boxes of the games we grew up with. It is written in layers.

- **The Tale So Far** and **The Lands You Will Walk** tell you only what you learn in your first hour. They are safe for everyone.
- After the warning page, every section is marked **SPOILER**. It tells the whole story of the journey, including who betrays whom, and it names the places the game saves for the end. If you are new, stop at the warning and come back when you have played.
- The game keeps the same story for you in the journal, on the page called **The Story So Far**. This chapter is that text with the people and the places put around it.

THE TALE SO FAR

The tale begins in the dungeons under the Abbey. Four adventurers went down into the crypts to kill the Rat King, who ruled the vaults with an army of rats. They fought through the halls and the bones, found the Rat King in his lair, and killed him. Then they climbed out of the crypt into the daylight.

That is where you take the party. You are not told who the four are or who sent them. They are simply the people who went down, and came up again.

The Abbey above was empty and silent, and an old dark forest crowded against its gate. There is nobody to ask what happened to the brothers. The first thing that does happen is the road: on the trail through the woods the party is set upon by wolves.

They kill them, but it is not a wild hunt. The wolves circle, wait and strike together, and the party works out that somebody sent them. A band of bandits attacks soon after, and that settles it. Someone wanted these four dead before they reached the road.

The crypts below the Abbey, where the tale begins.

The Abbey grounds and the Thornwood, the first daylight.

The road leads to Thornwick, a small timber town behind a log palisade. The streets are almost empty, and people watch from doorways. The party goes to the mayor, Corbin. He tells them that the raids on the road are the work of a bandit chief named Gandrick, who sent the wolves and the bandits against them, and he asks the party to go and kill him.

That is the whole of the opening. What the party finds in Gandrick's wood is for you to discover.

The Rat King, ruler of the vaults.

The wolves hunt as one.

The bandits of the road.

THE LANDS YOU WILL WALK

The world map in the game (open the map screen and press the *World map* button) shows two great pieces of country with a sea between them. In the west lie the **Known Lands**. In the middle lies the **Narrow Sea**, and its islands. In the east lie the **Eastern Lands**, called on the map **The Far Lands**, where the king's city stands. The two shores are joined by a long road in the far north, and by nothing else that is safe.

The Known Lands

The party begins at **The Abbey**, in the **Thornwood**. East of it lies **Thornwick**, the timber town, and beyond it **Gandrick's Wood** and a cave in the hillside. A muddy road runs through the forest to **The Ironhill Tunnel** and out to **Ironhill**, a stone town under a castle, with a burial ground, mines and a moor around it. East of the moor the land climbs to the **Greyfang Pass**.

Beyond the pass lies **Greendale**, a green valley with a white town called **Anaea**. The map calls everything east of the pass "the unknown lands". North of Anaea the country turns to sand: the **Sand Road**, the **Red Dunes**, the **Blue, White, Golden and Violet** deserts, and the golden city of **Khemetra**.

The Narrow Sea

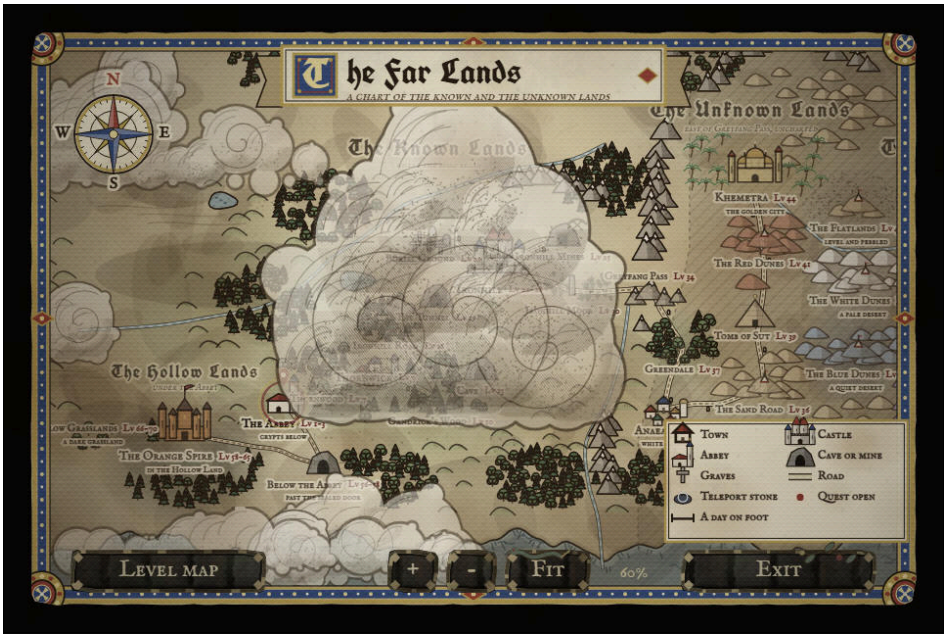
The road ends at the water. At the far end of a tunnel lies the fishing town of **Yarrim**, and out on the sea are four islands: **Saltbarrow**, the **Isle of Bells**, **Cinder Isle** and **Last Light**. Under each island there is a reef, and over the whole of it lies the open sea, a hundred cells of it, which you sail yourself.

The Eastern Lands

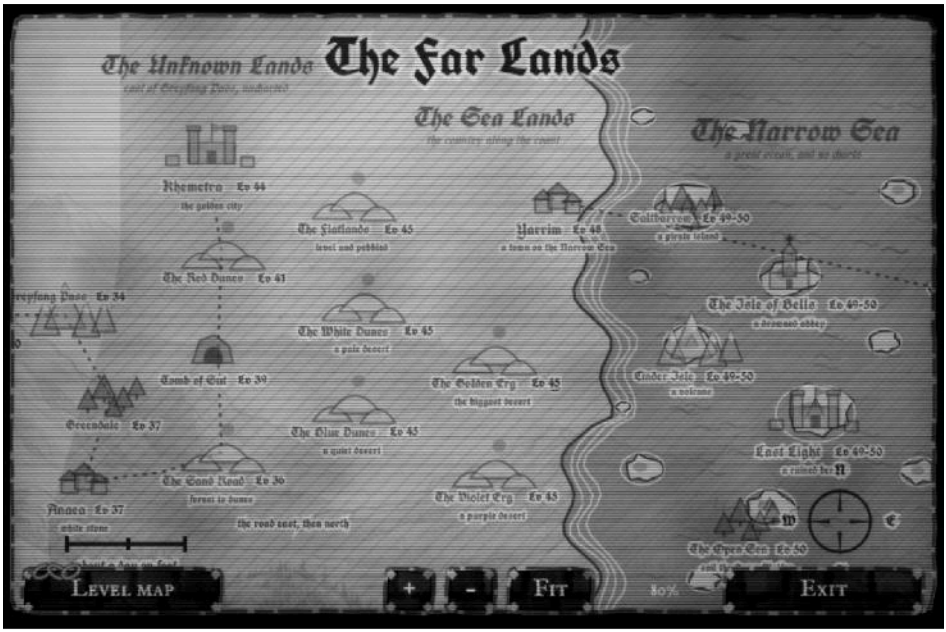
On the far shore stands **Oldhaven**, "the king's city, across the Narrow Sea", with the **Oakwood** behind it. A quiet road called the **Pilgrim's Path** leaves its north

gate and runs the whole way round to a cliff above Yarrim.

THE MAP OF THE KNOWN WORLD



The Far Lands on the in-game world map. Cloud covers the places you have not yet found.



The Narrow Sea: Khemetra and Yarrim on the western shore, the four islands, and the open sea.

HINT: *Drag the map to move it, use the + and - buttons to zoom, and press Fit to centre it on your party.*

STOP HERE IF YOU ARE NEW

Everything after this page is a **spoiler**. It tells the story of the whole journey, from the ledger to the Kraken to the end of the road, and it gives away who is not to be trusted.

Play the game first. Turn the page when you have reached the end of what you can bear not to know.

LEDGERS AND MAYORS

SPOILER

Spoiler: this section tells what happens in Gandrick's wood, in Thornwick and in Ironhill.

East of Thornwick the forest is older and darker. No birds sing. Bones lie along the trail, and black-coated figures move between the trees. The party fights through wolves and bandits and finds the cave in the hillside, where cold air breathes out smelling of wet stone and old death. The dead have been

laid down there for a long time, and now the living guard them.

The party kills Gandrick, and his black raven shrieks once and flies out into the dark. Among his things is a leather ledger: page after page of payments in silver, each marked with the letter C. The last entry reads, "Forty crowns to C. for sending fools. Four more went into the wood today." The C is Corbin. The mayor of Thornwick has been taking a cut from the bandit all along, and sent the party into the wood because he thought four strangers would die like all the rest.

The party goes back and lays the ledger before him. He goes grey, does not reach for the book, and reaches for the sword on his wall instead. He tells them they were meant to die, and that now they will not leave the room. The party fights him in his own hall, and he falls to his knees and drops his sword.

The King's Captain

As Corbin falls, horns sound in the square and soldiers in the king's colours push into the hall. Their captain looks at the mayor, then at the ledger. The raids on that road had been too well planned, he says, and the crown has come to find out who was behind them. They cuff Corbin in iron and lead him away to the king's dungeons. The captain asks one more thing: Ironhill is the next town, and its mayor must hear what happened here, in case he too dealt with Gandrick. The way leads west through a haunted wood and a cave under the hill, and out beneath the stone walls of Ironhill.

Mayor Halbrecht

Mayor Halbrecht already knows what happened: news travels fast, even through the old tunnel. He congratulates the party and asks a favour. Undead, rats and bats have come up out of the old mines east of the castle, and he wants eight of them killed.

The party clears the mines and goes back for its pay. This time Halbrecht listens, and his smile slowly goes away. A man from Thornwick has told him that the party arrived with a ledger nobody but they had seen, and he accuses them of forging it, to ruin the mayor of Thornwick and take his road. "I do not pay forgers." He calls his guards and has the party thrown into the castle dungeons.

Gandrick's Wood.

The streets of Ironhill.

THE DUNGEON, THE WARRANT AND THE PASS

SPOILER
Spoiler: the escape from Ironhill and the flight into Greendale.

Iron cuffs, a long stair, a cold cell, and guards laughing outside the door. The party bribes the jailer, fights out past the guards and faces Halbrecht. As he falls he admits it: he and Corbin split the coin, two mayors on one road, and Gandrick kept every other town poor. He could not let them tell the king.

Captain Rowan comes down with six guards, says he has served the wrong man for six years, and takes the mayor into custody. But he warns the party that Halbrecht sent a rider to the king at dawn, naming them as forgers. By now there is a warrant for all four of them, and the hunters and hitmen who live off warrants are already on the road. The party are fugitives.

Rowan can stop the hunters in town, not on the moor, so he sends the party up the Greyfang Pass, cold and steep, where horses cannot follow. With the hunters at their heels they cross it and leave the known country behind. This is Greendale, which the king never bothered with.

The Greyfang Pass: the last of the country the king knows.

THE GREEN VALLEY AND THE GOLDEN CITY

SPOILER
Spoiler: Anaea, Khemetra, the wizard and the king.

Anaea is a white town with yellow trim in a green valley, and the people in the square are every colour at once: a woman with blue skin and orange hair, a boy green from head to foot. Mayor Marigold has not seen travellers come down the Greyfang road in years. She hears the whole story and says it is a sorry tale and that she believes it, because liars tell it better.

The king has not sent a tax collector or a soldier to Greendale in twenty years, and would not listen to a village mayor. But there is one man he does listen to: the wizard Ishkander, who once saved the king's life.

The road runs north across the Sand Road and the desert to Khemetra, the golden city, four hundred thousand souls of whom not one has heard of them. The grand vizier, Hotep-Ra, will not give the wizard's hiding place to strangers, but he names it for those who recover the royal seal.

Anaea, in the green valley.

Khemetra, the golden city.

The Wizard in the Cistern

Ishkander lives in a study at the end of the cisterns beneath the Potters Market. He knew the warrant was forged the moment he heard the word "forger", and he promises to write to the king, who is away at his summer court. He warns the party that the warrant carries a price, twenty thousand crowns on each head, and that such money buys knives.

The King's Audience

Trumpets sound over Khemetra. King Rahotep is home. He reads Ishkander's letter and the dead bandit's ledger, and knows that the hand that signed the warrant is not King Osric's. It is Lord Corvane, Warden of the western Crown, who has been taking the tolls for himself. The ledger the party carries is only a copy. The master was written in three pages by Corvane's scribe, Isolde, who fled by sea and hid them on the islands of the Narrow Sea.

Then a dying rider falls at the foot of the throne: Corvane's black ship, the Black Heron, lies off Yarrim, and he means to have the party by the new moon. The king orders the Sea Gate unsealed. The warden's key lies in a rusted chest in the cisterns, and with it the grand vizier opens the gate in the east wall of Khemetra, shut for a hundred years.

The king wants the party out of the city by a way the warden's men will not be watching: the sea. The tunnel behind the gate has been sealed for a hundred years, and it is full of the drowned dead. Menkaure the shipwright goes with them, and when it is cleared he calls it a road at last. It leads east, under the cliffs, to the sea.

THE NARROW SEA

SPOILER

Spoiler: Yarrim, the islands, the diving, the Kraken and the crossing.

At the far end of the tunnel lies Yarrim, a small fishing town with gulls over the pier and boats moored in the bay. The harbourmaster, Tamsin Kell, is hiding the **Dawn Walker**, a ship built in secret, from Corvane's men, whose black ship lies off the point.

The Dawn Walker slips her moorings on the evening tide just as the Black Heron turns into the bay. Corvane calls for them to heave to. The party runs for the shallows by the light of the lamp, and by dawn there is only the sea.

The Dawn Walker, built in secret.

The Black Heron, Corvane's ship.

The Three Pages

Saltbarrow	
Island	A pirate island of sand and wrecks. Sable Maeve wants Corvane's marines gone from her shore. The party clears them, and she tells them where Isolde has gone.
The Isle of Bells	
Island	A drowned abbey. Brother Aldous will give up the first page of the ledger only to those who ring all three bells and face the dead who wake.
Cinder Isle	
Island	A black volcano. The ash-priestess Ketra asks for three crystals and the death of the Cinder Guardian. She gives up the second page.
Last Light	
Island	Isolde sits in a hut by a ruined beacon. The third page lies in the altar at the top of the island, and Lord Corvane has followed the party's lamp across half the sea. He does not leave the island.

Below every island there is a reef. Tam Salvor of Yarrim sells diving helms, and the water is full of colour and teeth: coral gardens, drowned abbeys, vents that breathe, and a wreck among the kelp. The party has four minutes of air at a time, and the bubbles at the vents fill the helms again.

On the Isle of Bells Brother Aldous tells of a great spiral shell, a nautilus grown over a thousand years, that broke in four in a storm and sank, one piece beneath each island. The party dives all four underwater dungeons. Aldous lays the pieces on the stone beside the abbey bell, and they close together by themselves with a sound like the sea. The shell becomes the **Nautilus Helm**, pearl-white inside and rose at the lip.

Yarrim, with the Narrow Sea beyond the beach.

The Kraken Guns

With the whole ledger on the chart table, Menkaure shows the party the way to Oldhaven, across the Narrow Sea, and the thing that stands in the middle of it. The **Kraken** is twenty levels above the party, and nothing they carry can hurt it. The old Crown fleet killed it once with four magical harpoons, the **Kraken guns**, which were scattered when the fleet burned.

Ketra, Sable Maeve, Brother Aldous and Isolde each know where one lies: the red cliffs of Redcliff, the wreck on Kelpgate Rock, the standing stones of the Hollow Isle and the wreck under Last Light. They are the Ember Harpoon, the Verdigris Harpoon, the Silver Harpoon and the Beacon Harpoon. Each hero takes one, and they do huge damage to the Kraken and next to none to anything else.

East of the line where the gulls stop, the sea goes black and the Kraken rises, a thousand suckers breaking the surface at once. The four harpoons bite into it as nothing else in the world could, and it sinks. They flare white and fall to ash, as they were meant to. For the first time in a century the way across the Narrow Sea is open, and the harbour boom at Oldhaven can be lifted.

THE EASTERN LANDS

SPOILER

Spoiler: Oldhaven, the court, the six names and the road back to the Abbey.

The Dawn Walker crosses the Narrow Sea and comes at dawn to Oldhaven, the king's city, with the whole master ledger in Isolde's own hand. Here the second part of the story

begins: the western lands, where the road began, lie far behind across the ocean.

At noon the party is brought before King Osric and his court. The ledger is read in open court. It shows that Lord Corvane, Warden of the Narrow Sea, took the tolls in the king's name and had the warrant forged, and that at the foot of the last page he names Chancellor Vance, who keeps the king's seal and gives the orders. Vance draws a sword and falls on the steps of the dais. King Osric tears up the warrant: it carries his seal, but he never signed it, because Vance held the seal and Corvane wrote his name. The ransom on four heads is lifted.

But Vance and Corvane did not work alone. In the margin of the ledger are six more names: six people at the court and in the city who took Corvane's silver or carried Vance's orders. King Osric cannot tell which of his own court he can trust, so he asks the party, who owe the city nothing, to find the six quietly.

Oldhaven, the king's city.

The Orange Spire of the Hollow Land.

The Six Pieces, the Siege and the Oak Crown

Captain Aldwyn matches the six initials to six people at the fair of Saint Brannoch. All six were paid with one piece of a larger thing: a brass cog, a steel pin, a bronze spring, a silver bell, a lens of green glass and a pale dial. The party chooses mercy or justice for each.

Then the Ash Guard seizes the east gate and holds the road beyond it. The city holds out.

Beyond the gate lies an old oak forest with six glades. The woodwardens keep it, under Hale. The Oakwrights plant an oak for every one they cut, under Master Joss. A young woodwarden named Wren tells the party she is King Osric's granddaughter, raised in the Oakwood because the chancellor could not be trusted. At the Great Oak, Ysolt asks three questions, and the party answers honestly.

Home to the Abbey

With Wren crowned, Captain Aldwyn reads Ishkander's sealed letter aloud. The six pieces fit together into the **Orrery of Hours**, a clockwork model of the heavens, which opens a sealed door under the Abbey crypts, where the journey began. A royal cutter takes the party home. In the crypt, near the old stair, stands a slab of black iron with a ring of hollows in the middle. The Orrery ticks, the discs turn, and the door grinds into the wall. A stair goes down into the dark.

Four floors lie below the Abbey: the Sealed Stair, the Drowned Cloister, the Ossuary of Brothers and the Hollow Abbey. At the bottom stands Brother Sevrin, the Abbey's last gardener, who has come down to hide. He tells the party that the Hollow Abbot sits in the great room ahead, and that the stair onward is under his seat.

Below the Abbey is in early access

When the Hollow Abbot is killed, the slab over the stair grinds aside. Beyond it lies the **Hollow Land**, a vast underground dark with a great orange spire of twenty levels, and past the spire the first of the towers beyond. The game says plainly that this is where the road ends for now. You can read the whole of what is written so far in the journal.

THE DEEPEST SECRET

SPOILER
Spoiler: who Vance served. Read this last.

Brother Sevrin tells the party what the Hollow Abbot was guarding. Long ago a court of dead rulers was shut under the Abbey, and the Abbey kept the door. Vance, the chancellor, was never the master of Corvane's silver. He answered to someone in the Hollow Land, and he spent the silver to open the door from outside.

In the hidden rooms of the Orange Spire the party finds three letters from Vance to his lord. Corvane's silver went up to the Hollow Land every quarter. Vance used the king's seal and the king saw nothing. He hid six pieces of the key in six hands, so that only the court's servants would open the door.

At the top of the Orange Spire the wizard tells the party the truth. He shut the court of the Hollow Land under the Abbey long ago, ruled by the first king, whom they call the **Pale Sovereign**, who wanted to rule past his own death. Vance was the Sovereign's hand above, Corvane was Vance's tool, and the silver bought the pieces of the key. The party opened the door themselves, and that is the only reason the court is not loose in the Eastern Lands. The Sovereign waits in the Violet Tower.

THE PILGRIM'S PATH AND SAINT ELEN'S

SPOILER
Spoiler: the quiet places of the Eastern Lands.

A second gate in the north wall of Oldhaven opens on the Pilgrim's Path, a quiet road of ninety-six kilometres that runs north up the peninsula with the sea on one side and an old oak forest on the other, turns west across the mountains and comes south to a high cliff above Yarrim. Nothing happens on it. It goes one way: from Oldhaven to Yarrim. The path ends at the top of a cliff, and a steep goat track leads down to the green slopes north of Yarrim. It can be climbed down but not up again, and a wooden sign at the bottom says so.

Halfway along, in the mountains, a gate cut into the cliff leads into the green grounds of **Saint Elen's Monastery**: a church, a cloister with a fountain, a refectory, a scriptorium, a kitchen, a guest house, an infirmary, herb and flower gardens, an orchard and hives. The brothers are friendly and quiet. In a chest in the old crypts the party finds the plain gold ring of Abbot Aldhelm and brings it back to Abbot Anselm, who puts it where it belongs.

A TIMELINE OF THE TALE

SPOILER
Spoiler: the whole journey in order.

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	WHERE
1	Four adventurers kill the Rat King and climb out	The crypts below the Abbey
2	Wolves, then bandits: someone wants them dead	The Thornwood
3	Corbin sends the party against Gandrick	Thornwick
4	Gandrick killed; the ledger with the letter C	Gandrick's Cave
5	Corbin fights and falls; the king's captain arrests him	Thornwick
6	Halbrecht thanks the party, then accuses it of forgery	Ironhill
7	Escape from the cells; Halbrecht confesses; the warrant	Castle Dungeons
8	Over the pass; Marigold sends the party to Ishkander	Greyfang Pass, Anaea
9	The wizard, the price of twenty thousand crowns, the king's audience	Khemetra
10	The Sea Gate opened; the tunnel cleared	Khemetra to Yarrim
11	The Dawn Walker casts off; the three pages found; Corvane falls	The four islands
12	Four harpoons found; the Kraken slain	The Narrow Sea
13	The court of King Osric; the warrant torn up; Vance falls	Oldhaven
14	The six names; the siege; the heir; the Orrery	Oldhaven and the Oakwood
15	The sealed door; four floors; the Hollow Abbot	Below the Abbey

WHO'S WHO

SPOILER
Spoiler: every figure here has a part in the story above.

Gandrick
Bandit chief of the wood.

Corbin
Mayor of Thornwick, and ***Halbrecht****, Mayor of Ironhill.*

Captain Rowan
Of the Ironhill guard.

Marigold
Mayor of Anaea.

Ishkander
The wizard in the cistern.

Hotep-Ra
Grand vizier of Khemetra.

King Rahotep
Of Khemetra.

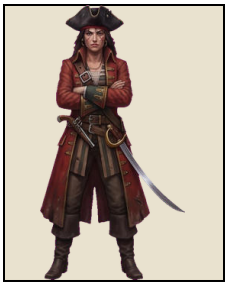
Menkaure
The shipwright.

Tamsin Kell
Harbourmaster of Yarrim.

Orsa
Keeper of the Yarrim Light.

Lord Corvane
Warden of the Crown, master of the Black Heron.

Isolde
Corvane's scribe, who hid the pages.



Sable Maeve
Of Saltbarrow.

Brother Aldous
Of the Isle of Bells.

Ketra
Ash-priestess of Cinder Isle.

King Osric
Of the Eastern Lands.

Chancellor Vance
Keeper of the king's seal.

Captain Aldwyn
Of the gate of Oldhaven.

Abbot Anselm
Of Saint Elen's.

ODD FOLK OF THE ROAD

Strange things walk the levels without warning. The in-game page "About them", in the Wandering Monsters list of the main menu, says that they are not born and do not live anywhere: "the things that were dreamt so hard that they got up and walked out of the sleeper's head and into the world." Fifteen are known. Nine ask a favour and six hunt you. The rarest of the hunters, the Messenger of Death, writes the letters of his name on the walls.

***The Ferryman of Dust**, always late.*

***Mother Mossback**, fond of apples.*

***Aunt Marrow**, who pushes the pram.*

***The Hollow Bride**, still waiting.*

***Sir Wick**, the Candle Knight.*

The Messenger of Death.

NAME	WHAT THEY WANT
The Ferryman of Dust, Mother Mossback, Aunt Marrow, Grubb the Toll Troll, The Hollow Bride, Brother Rattlebones, The Salt Wife, Thistlewick the Alchemist, The Unfinished Man	Each asks you for a favour.
Sir Wick, The Glass Stag, The Weather Hound, The Many-Eyed Ox, The Crown Crab	They hunt you, and you must fight them.
The Messenger of Death	Hunts you with letters: they kill when all five have been read.

A GLOSSARY OF THE LAND

Crowns
Money — The coin of the land. The price on each of the party's heads is twenty thousand crowns.

Dawn Walker
Ship — The ship built in secret at Yarrim, which you take to sea.

Greendale
Country — The green valley beyond the Greyfang Pass. The king never bothered with it.

Kraken guns
Weapon — Four magical harpoons that hurt the Kraken and next to nothing else.

Narrow Sea
Sea
The water between the western and eastern lands, with four islands and a reef under each.

Nautilus Helm
Item
The helm made from the four pieces of the Singing Shell. It heals its wearer every round of a battle, brings mana back faster, and lets them breathe under the sea.

Orrery of Hours
Item
A clockwork model of the heavens made from six pieces. It opens the sealed door under the Abbey.

Pilgrim's Path
Road
A road of ninety-six kilometres from Oldhaven to a cliff above Yarrim.

Scoria
Country
The desert kingdom in the north, whose golden city is Khemetra.

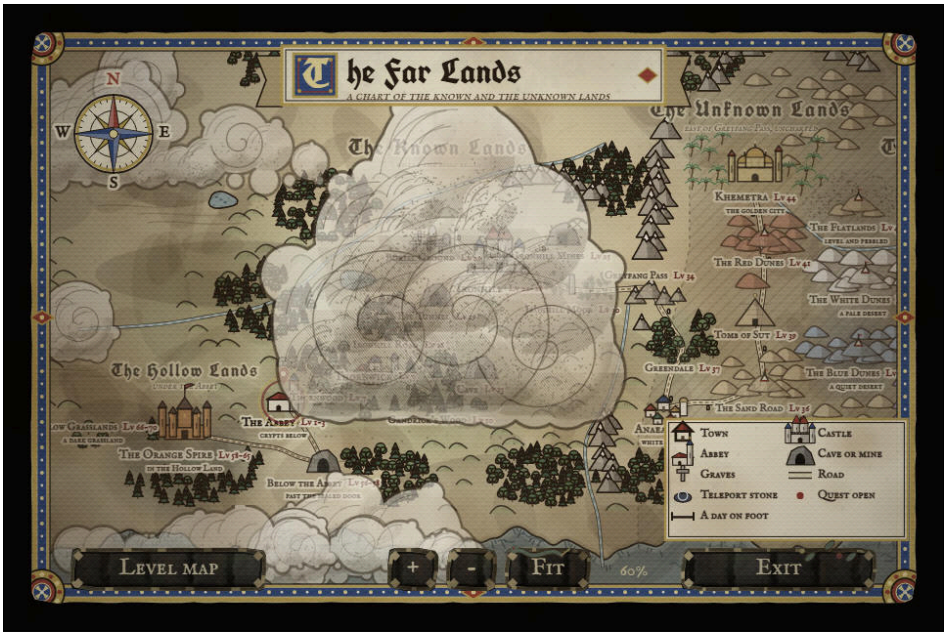
CHAPTER 5

Guide to the Lands: The Home Lands

From the crypt where the road begins to the orange spire in the dark below: a traveller's guide to every town, wood, mine and monastery of the west.

Every journey needs a guidebook, and this is yours. It follows the order of the road: out of the crypts beneath the Abbey, through the Thornwood to Thornwick, east to the iron town of Ironhill, over the Greyfang Pass to green Greendale and white Anaea. After that it turns back to the places a party reaches later: the long Pilgrim's Path, Saint Elen's Monastery, the Oakwood, and the strange country that lies under the Abbey itself.

For each place you will find who lives there, what they sell or ask, which creatures walk the roads, and the level of the place as the world map shows it. The deserts, the sea and the great city of Oldhaven have their own chapters (see their own chapters). Secrets are left for Chapter 8, where they belong.



The world map (open the map and choose World map). The level of each place is printed beside its name.

THE HOME LANDS AT A GLANCE

The levels below are the ones the world map prints when autoscaling is off (Menu, Gameplay). Pencil a tick in the last column as you go. The monastery has no fixed level at all.

PLACE	LEVEL	LIVES THERE	BEEN?
The Abbey and its crypts	1 to 3	Rats, bats, skeletons, the Rat King	☐
The Thornwood	7	Wolves, bandits, skeletons	☐
Thornwick	7	Goats, gossips, a mayor	☐
Gandrick's Wood and Cave	10 and 13	Bandits, archers, Gandrick	☐
Ironhill Road and the Tunnel	16 and 19	Wolves, ghosts, skeletons	☐

Ironhill	22 to 28	Smiths, a wizard, a mayor	☐
Ironhill Mines	25	Rats, bats, skeletons, an overseer	☐
The Burial Ground	29	Ghosts, spectres, skeletons	☐
Ironhill Moor	30	Wolves, bandits, a hermit	☐
Greyfang Pass	34	Hunters, hitmen, wolves	☐
Greendale and Anaea	37	Deer, bees, a colourful people	☐
The Pilgrim's Path	55	Walkers, monks, a few wolves	☐
Saint Elen's Monastery	none	Monks, bees, ghosts in the cellar	☐
The Oakwood	55	Woodwardens, wolves, the Ash Guard	☐
Below the Abbey	56 to 58	Rats, wraiths, the Hollow Abbot	☐
The Hollow Land and the Orange Spire	58 to 65	Goblins, slimes, orcs, dead rulers	☐

Skipping ahead

The title screen has a **Go to area** list that starts a game in any place in this chapter, at any level of gold. It is meant for visiting, not for beating the game in an afternoon.

Reading the level

The level is a rough guide to the creatures you will meet there, with the great creatures standing a few levels above it. If a place is too hard, go somewhere else and come back stronger.

THE ABBEY AND ITS CRYPTS

Here the tale begins. Four adventurers went down into the vaults beneath the Abbey to kill the Rat King, and every game of *Below the Abbey* begins with the same cold stairs. The crypts are low, damp and torchlit, with barrels, shields, old carts and bones lying where they fell.

The crypts: a barred door, a round shield and a rotting cart.

Level: 1 to 3. **Creatures:** Black Rats, Cave Bats and Skeletons, and in the deepest hall the Rat King himself (the game gives him 224 hit points, a good deal for a first fight). **What to find:** the first coins, potions and weapons of your career, in barrels, crates and chests. Open everything, and keep your torches lit.

THE THORNWOOD

You climb out of the crypt into an empty abbey, and an old dark forest crowds against its gate. The grounds are a graveyard with a church, a well and a little shrine, the *Shrine of the*

First Light, where candles burn that nobody lights. Beyond the gate a trail winds through the trees.

Level: 7. **Creatures:** Grey Wolves that hunt in packs, Bandits and Bandit Archers in black coats (look in the branches), and wandering Skeletons. The wolves circle and wait before they strike, so keep your front line tight. **Also here:** the Wolves' Den, a small cave of wolves and little else, and the way on to Thornwick.

The abbey grounds, with the old well.

The woods turn dark and twisted further east.

THORNWICK

Thornwick: the fountain, the sign of the Bickering Goat on the right, and a very quiet street.

A small timber town behind a log palisade, where the streets are almost empty and people watch from doorways. It is the first place to rest, shop, pray and be given jobs, and it has about a dozen of them. The town is level 7 throughout, so everything here is safe to try.

Mind your purse. A boy named Nim will bump into you in the lane and walk off fast, and a man called Rough Jem asks ten gold to walk his street. Both can be talked round if you care to try.

The town sign, west of the green.

The Bickering Goat. Beds are 15 gold.

Aldous, the merchant (Aldous's Store)

Sells — Food, potions, antidotes, salves, torches, and plain weapons and caps and jerkins. Nothing fancy.

Bram, the innkeeper (the Bickering Goat)

Rooms — 15 gold a night. Fallen heroes rise and everyone wakes healed and fed.

Asks — Eight bundles of firewood from the Thornwood.

The priest (Thornwick Chapel)

Offers — A blessing that heals the party once a day, and 50 gold for each fallen hero raised.

Mayor Corbin (the Mayor's House)

Asks — Sends the party after the bandit chief Gandrick, and has jobs for anyone who asks.

Old Maud, Hild the huntress, Rolf the gate warden

Ask — Five lost goats; six dead wolves; five bandits cleared from the road.

Goodwife Edda, Wat the beggar, Nim

Ask — Eight rats; a loaf of bread; three ghosts out of the Empty House.

Old Tam, Goodwife Mabel, Hob, Farmer Will

Ask — Apples, hard cheese, a drink and some herring, from Aldous's shelves.

Ada, the bath keeper (the Bathhouse)

Offers — Hot water, and a cure for the ailments that ordinary rest does not touch.

Underneath: the Well Cellar, where a few bandits wait, and the Empty House, haunted by ghosts.

Folk you will meet in the west, in the game's own paintings: merchant, innkeeper, smith, priest, huntress and a mayor.

GANDRICK'S WOOD AND CAVE

East of Thornwick the forest is older and darker. No birds sing, and bones lie along the trail. **Level:** 10. **Creatures:** Bandits, Bandit Archers, Grey Wolves and Skeletons. The *Woodcutters' Shrine* stands here, a bell on a post hung with ribbons.

Inside Gandrick's Cave.

A little way off the trail is the **Bandit Cache** (level 10), a bandit store-room with a few guards, and in the hillside the **Cave** (level 13) where cold air breathes out of the rock. Skeletons, bandits and archers guard it, and at its heart sits Gandrick, who has 160 hit points and a bad reputation.

IRONHILL ROAD AND THE TUNNEL

The Ironhill Road, where it never stops raining.

The Tunnel: wet, sour air and a sarcophagus.

The witch's hut.

The road (level 16) runs west through a rain-soaked forest. Wolves follow you, and ghosts drift between the trunks. The *Wayfarers' Stone* stands beside the trail, a pillar carved with spirals where travellers scratch their names. A lone **Witch's Hut** stands off the road (level 16): the witch sells salves, antidotes, sleeping tea, holy water, potions, a few scrolls and torches, and wants three ghosts banished.

The Tunnel (level 19) is a cave that climbs through the hill to Ironhill. Eight Skeletons and five Ghosts keep it, and the torches burn low. It is the only way through, so go well rested.

IRONHILL

*Ironhill: stone houses, a cobbled square and a handful of people who want something from you (the gold **!** marks a quest).*

A stone town with a small castle and strong walls, where forge workers come in black and leave pink from the baths. The town is level 22; the castle dungeons beneath it stand at 28. Ironhill has the best shops in the west and eleven jobs for a party with sore feet. Gates lead west to the Tunnel and east to the Moor.

Its mayor, Halbrecht, welcomes the party warmly. What he asks of them, and what follows, belongs to the story and not to a guidebook.

Brannoch's Forge: plain iron and plain prices.

Corvin's Arcana, where spells are sold.

The castle hall; the mayor wears a quest mark.

Brannoch, the smith (Brannoch's Forge)

Sells — Daggers, swords, maces, axes, bows, staves, helms, shields and leather armour, salves and potions.

Asks — Six lumps of iron ore.

Torvald and Grete (Steelhold Blades; Plate and Mail)

Sell — Finer steel and plate, fitted to the level of the fighter.

Corvin, the hedge wizard (Corvin's Arcana)

Sells — Spells.

Ysolt, the alchemist (The Cauldron)

Sells — Potions, tonics and tinctures, and she teaches herbal remedies.

Mara, the innkeeper (the Anvil and Ale)

Rooms 25 gold a night.

Asks Six vermin cleared out.

Dorn, the merchant (Dorn's Store)

Sells Food and plain goods.

Asks A parcel of seed to Farmer Eadric on the moor.

Gunnar (Ironhill Steam Baths); the priest (Ironhill Church)

Offer A bath that cures ailments; a blessing and a raising of the fallen, as at Thornwick.

Kal, the animal trader

Sells Companions: goats, llamas, frogs, ducks, cats, dogs, parrots, snakes, songbirds and one very small skeleton. Take up to three.

Captain Rowan, Wynn, Odo, Hesta, Ysolde, Foreman Bryn

Ask Wolves and bandits on the moor; herbs; the graves put right; a lost pick; a lost boy; the mine overseer.

IRONHILL MINES

East of the castle the old mines run deep, and the dead have come up out of them. **Level:** 25. **Creatures:** Black Rats, Cave Bats, Skeletons and a Mine Overseer who carries a good deal of gold. The air is thick with rock dust, so expect to catch Tomb Dust.

Mayor Halbrecht wants eight of the dead cleared out, and Foreman Bryn would very much like to see the overseer gone.

The mines: torches, a long gallery and a lonely obelisk.

THE BURIAL GROUND

The Gravekeeper's Niche.

Level: 29. A walled graveyard with crosses, gnarled trees and lamps. **Creatures:** Ghosts, Spectres and Skeletons. **Find:** the *Gravekeeper's Niche*, a shrine for those with no grave, with a hundred small stones in its alcove. Odo the gravekeeper pays for the graveyard to be put right.

IRONHILL MOOR

The moor is wet underfoot and midges rise in clouds. **Level:** 30. **Creatures:** Grey Wolves, Bandits and a Bandit Archer. Farmer Eadric and the boy Pip live close to the old well. The

Moor Saint, a pilgrim with a staff in a spired chapel, stands on the heather, and a ring of standing stones hums when it likes you.

Off the moor are two small places. The **Hermit's Cave** (level 30) has a hermit who lets the party rest by his fire once a day. The **Ruined Watchtower** (level 30) is kept by hunters and a bandit.

The moor: ferns, standing stones and a traveller on the track.

GREYFANG PASS

Cold and steep, where horses cannot follow. A cleared trail two squares wide runs through the pass, marked by cairns, and the area map draws it as a dashed red line. **Level:** 34. **Creatures:** Grey Wolves, Cave Bats, Bounty Hunters and Hitmen, who live off warrants. The *Pass Shrine* is a stone arch with a blue rune that glows when the wind turns.

The pass: spiral standing stones and a flagged road.

Off the trail lies the **Old Vault** (level 34), a cold stone vault of Skeletons and Ghosts. Past the east end of the pass is the green valley the story calls Greendale, and the edge of the known lands.

GREENDALE AND ANAEA

Greendale Forest. Deer let you walk right up.

Anaea, where the people are every colour.

The Temple of the Sun.

Greendale (level 37) is a wide green valley of flowers, deer, rabbits and wild hives, and no enemies at all. The *Green Sun* shrine stands in a golden niche where the children leave a bun. Wild honeycomb hangs in the low trees.

Anaea (also 37) is a white town with yellow trim, and its people are every colour at once. The king has not sent a soldier or a tax collector in twenty years, and nobody minds. Mayor Marigold, in the Town Hall, will hear your story. Nothing ever happens in Anaea, apart from a goat in the temple last month.

Odalys, the innkeeper (the Gilded Hen)

Rooms 20 gold a night, and the barley soup is free to anyone who looks tired.

Juno, the baker (the Golden Crust)

Sells — Bread, pies, cheese, apples, pottage and potions.

Fenwick, the merchant (Fenwick's Goods)

Sells — Plain goods and a little of everything.

Marl, Wren and Old Tobin

Ask — Three honeycombs; six bunches of wildflowers; four apples, all from the forest.

Hale, the scribe

Asks — A look into the colours of Anaea.

Sylvie (the Anaea Springs); the priest (Temple of the Sun)

Offer — A soothing bath; a blessing.

THE PILGRIM'S PATH

The Pilgrim's Path begins at a gate in the north wall of Oldhaven, with the sea on one hand and an oak forest on the other.

A quiet road, ninety-six kilometres long, that runs from Oldhaven to a cliff above Yarrim. It goes north up the coast, west over the mountains, south down the far coast and then up a high pass and down the other side. It takes about an hour of walking and it goes one way only. A signpost stands at every kilometre: *To Yarrim, 84 km.* The whole of it is level 55, but the wolves are few.

The path is made for walking, not for fighting. Benches stand beside the road, walkers and pilgrims nod to you, and a small shrine stands beside the road every two kilometres, with bread, an apple and a wedge of cheese left on it by the one before you. Take what you need, and leave something if you can.

"To Yarrim, 84 km."

A pilgrims' shrine, with food left on it.

Rest and prayer on the way

PLACE	KEEPER	WHAT IT OFFERS
The Last Lamp (inn)	Maren	A room for 15 gold, and a fire that never goes out
The Cold Spring Inn	Osk	15 gold, and the best water on the mountain
The Wayfarer's Rest	Hanne	15 gold, and the soup is free
Church of the Long Road	Father Elric	Quiet, and a place to light a lamp
Chapel of the Quiet	Sister Wynn	Nobody speaks here, not even the bell
Saint Aldric's by the Sea	Brother Alder	A sea church on the southern coast

Inside the Last Lamp.

The Church of the Long Road.

A cave door among the birches.

Besides the inns and churches there are single houses along the way, a shepherd, a fisherman, a hermit, a charcoal-burner, a gardener, a beekeeper, and a last householder at the foot of the final climb. They want nothing and will tell you so. Waterfalls and rope bridges cross the streams on a few stretches, and churchyards with crosses and gravestones stand beside the churches.

The woods. The trees beside the path are real woods: narrow trails wind off between the trunks, where squirrels, rabbits and deer go about their business and bees drift over the flowers. Now and then a wolf waits on a trail. Hidden at the back of the trees are twenty small caves, with treasure, gems, wolves, outcasts, and three that shelter someone with a favour to ask. Wild caves and ruins elsewhere have their doors choked with dead trees, which a torch or a lantern will burn away, and a small **?** on the map marks them until you have been inside.

Watch your minimap for a ?

Hidden caves and wild dungeons lie off the roads, behind the trees. When your party looks towards one, a **?** appears at the edge of the minimap and on the area maps. Follow the mark. It goes away once you have been inside.

HINT: *the path keeps a few secrets of its own. See Chapter 8.*

THE MONASTERY GATE

Halfway along the path, as it climbs the mountains, a great stone statue of **Saint Elen** stands at the side of the road, twice the height of a man, with her hands held out toward the mountain. The stone is dark with rain and soft with moss. At her feet someone has cut a line of letters, and a signpost beside her points up a lane to the monastery gate.

The statue, from the game's own art.

Close by, *The Pilgrim's Rest* is a small shrine to a saint with candles, a good place to sit, and one of the sixteen shrines of the land.

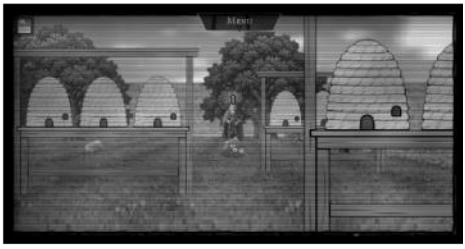
SAINT ELEN'S MONASTERY

Saint Elen's Monastery: a stained glass window of the church, a cross, and a young brother with an errand.

A gate cut into the rock of the pass opens on green grounds and quiet company. The monks are friendly, there is nothing to fear in the daylight, and the monastery has no level on the world map. Below the grounds, a cellar and old crypts have a ghost problem.

The grounds hold a church, a cloister garden with a fountain and benches, a refectory, a scriptorium, a kitchen, a guest house, an infirmary, the herb garden, an orchard, rows of beehives and a bell. Ten quiet quests are given here, with generous rewards.

The cloister garden and its fountain.



The beehives, with Brother Bee-keeper beside them.

Abbot Anselm

Asks — That you meet the brothers, and later, that you find the sixteen old shrines of the land.

Brother Cyprian (the Church of Saint Elen)

Says — The church is open all day. Sit anywhere.

Sister Agnes (the Chapel of the Lamps)

Keeps — The lamps, lit by hand at dusk.

Brother Herbert, the herbalist; Brother Osmund (the Infirmary)

Teach — Herbal remedies, from the herbs of the gardens and the road. Herbert asks for herbs for the infirmary.

Brother Hilarion (the Guest House)

Rooms — Free. A bed, a bowl of soup and a fire, and nobody asks you to pay or to pray.

Brother Cook, Brother Bee-keeper, Sister Wilma

Ask — Eight apples; three honeycombs; six bunches of flowers for the graves.

Brother Cellarer, Brother Scribe, Brother Bellringer

Ask — The cold cellar looked into; a letter carried to the Cold Spring; a bell rung.

The Church of Saint Elen, pews, windows and a hanging crown of candles.

The scriptorium: shelves and lecterns with open books.

The cemetery and the mausoleum. East of the grounds lies the Quiet Cemetery, with Sister Wilma tending the graves among the oaks and a mausoleum at the end of the row. **The cellars and crypts** are another matter. The Monastery Cellars are full of ghosts, with a few rats and a bat, and the Old Crypts beneath hold Ghosts, Spectres, Skeletons and a Weeping Brother. The mausoleum holds a few ghosts of its own.

The monastery also holds the *Old Shrines* quest: Abbot Anselm will give 1,500 gold to a party that has found them all.

The Quiet Cemetery.

The Monastery Cellars.

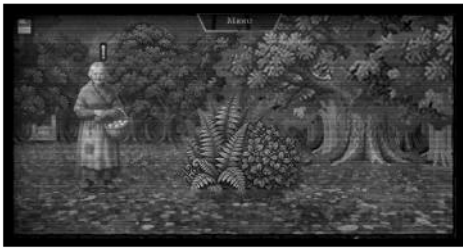
THE OAKWOOD

After the siege of Oldhaven, the king's east gate opens on an old oak forest of six glades, where the woodwardens live and the Oakwrights plant acorns and wait a hundred years. **Level:** 55. **Creatures:** a lot of Grey Wolves, and the Ash Guard.

Folk: Hale, captain of the woodwardens; Master Joss of the Oakwrights; Bramwick, the hedge-wizard; young Wren; and Ysolt,

keeper of the Great Oak. Nine quests are given here, from wolves and acorns to herbs, timber and three questions put by the Great Oak. The *Oakwood Altar*, a mossy altar under a moon canopy, is one of the sixteen shrines.

The woodwardens' camp.



Near the Great Oak.

BELOW THE ABBEY

Under the crypts of the Abbey is a sealed door, and behind it a stair that goes down four floors: **The Sealed Stair**, **The Drowned Cloister**, **The Ossuary of Brothers** and **The Hollow Abbey**. The door opens only late in the game, after the party has crossed the sea to Oldhaven and brought back the Orrery of Hours.

Level: 56 to 58. **Creatures:** Black Rats, Cave Bats, Skeletons, Ghosts, Spectres and, at the bottom, many Wraiths. At the very bottom sits the Hollow Abbot (2,600 hit points, a great creature indeed). **Folk:** Brother Sevrin, who gives the quests of the lower floors.

The Sealed Stair.

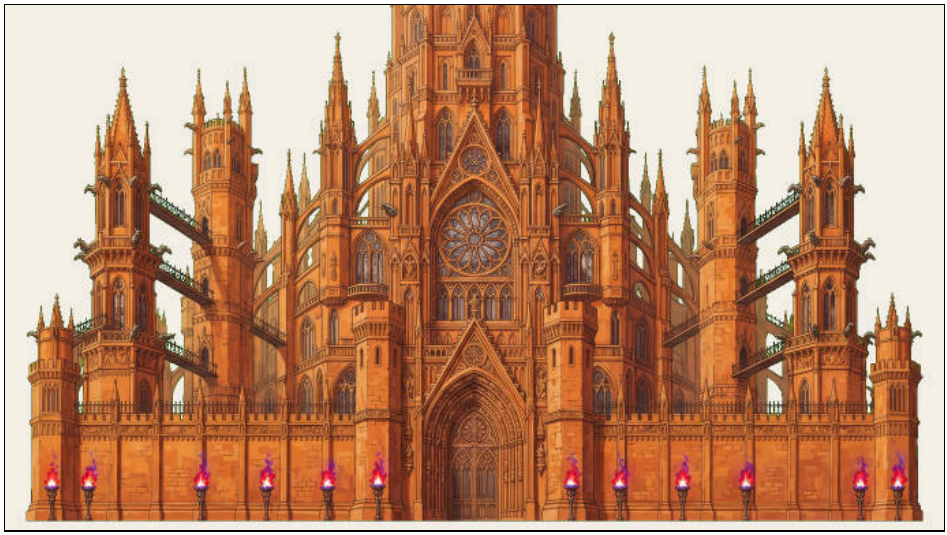
Brother Sevrin, in the Hollow Abbey.

THE HOLLOW LAND AND THE ORANGE SPIRE

The Hollow Land: a lamplit square in the dark, and the orange spire beyond its gate.

Past the Hollow Abbot, the stair comes out on a high ledge in a vast underground dark. Far below, lit by red and purple torches, stands a great orange spire, and stairs lead down to its gate. This is the Hollow Land. A keeper of the stair, a hooded figure, a very old grey friar and a few other lost souls talk of the place, and none of them like it. **Level:** 58.

The **Orange Spire** has twenty levels, each smaller than the one below, with its number carved large on the stone. Each floor is a labyrinth with a mystery room in the middle, and old books lie on lecterns. The spire is level 58 at its foot and level 65 at its crown, and the higher you climb the worse your company gets.



The Orange Spire, in the game's own painting. The torches are never lit by anyone.

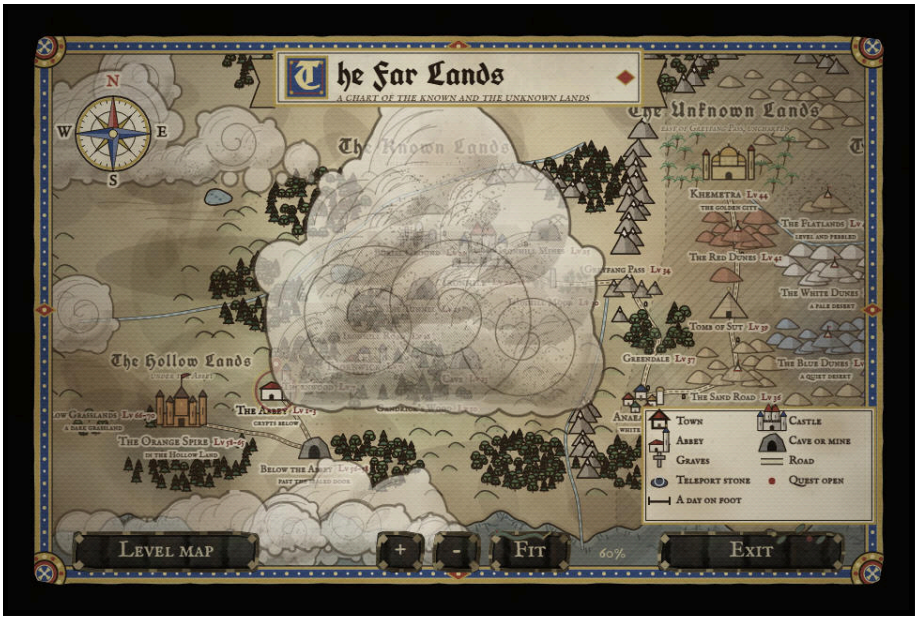
Creatures: Armoured Goblins, Cave Slimes and Orc Brutes first, then Wailing Ghosts and Clawing Hands, Mad Jesters, Chest Mimics, Raving Madmen, Wights, Murdered Peasants, The Butcher, Phantoms, Headless Knights, Banshees, Vampires, Demented Dukes, Werewolves, Skeleton Warlords, Shape Shifters, the Writhing Choir and a Flesh Abomination. On four of the levels (4, 9, 14 and 19) a twisted dead ruler holds the last hall.

At the top a wizard waits with three questions, and the floor below him has been known to give way. The foot of the Violet Tower stands beyond. Here the Hollow Land ends for now, and the game says so on a plaque.

Inside the spire: the first floor.

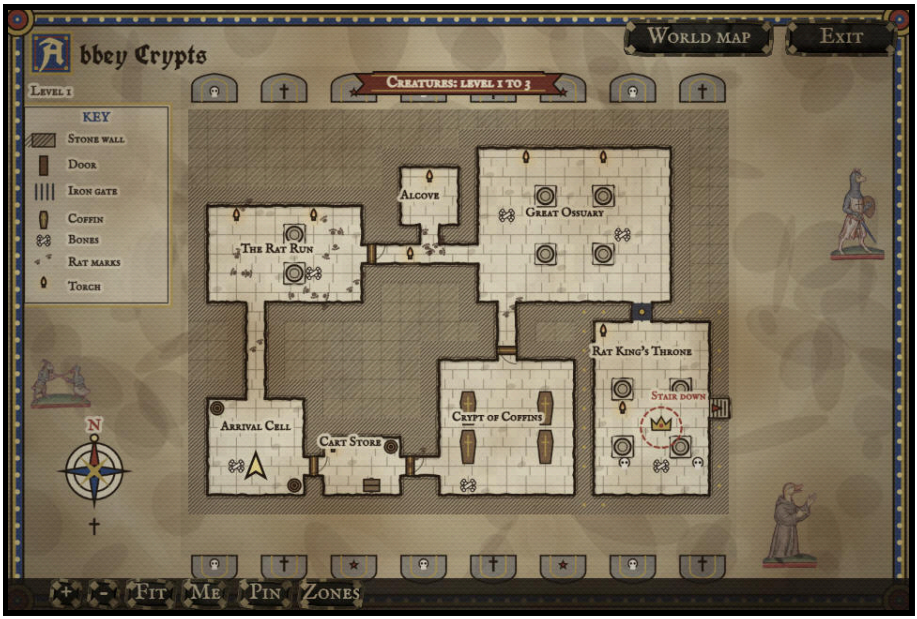
The road leads on, to the desert and the golden city and across the sea to Oldhaven, each in a chapter of its own. For a bad day, a hard fight or an unopened door, turn to Chapter 8.

Atlas of the Home Lands



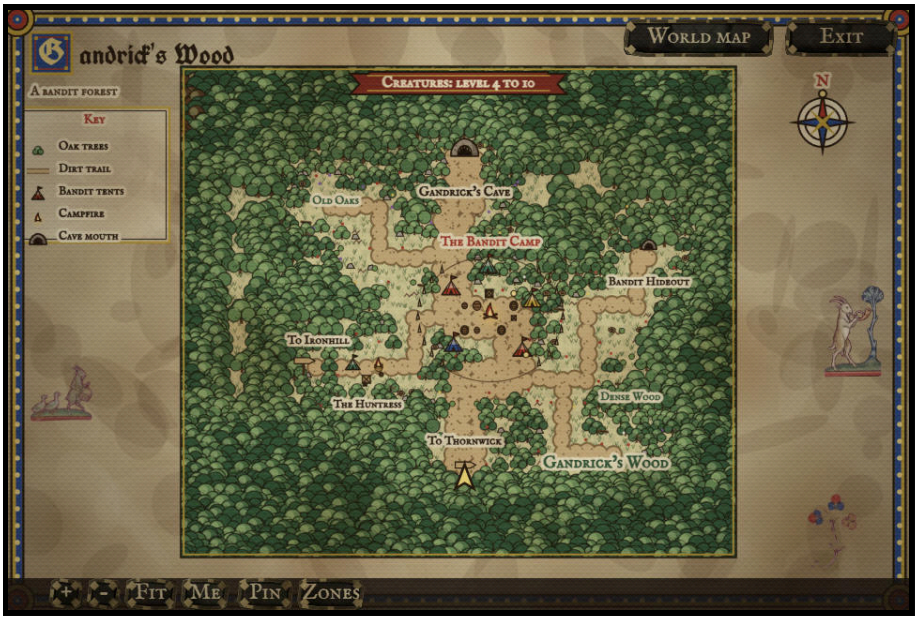
The world map, west.

Thornwick.

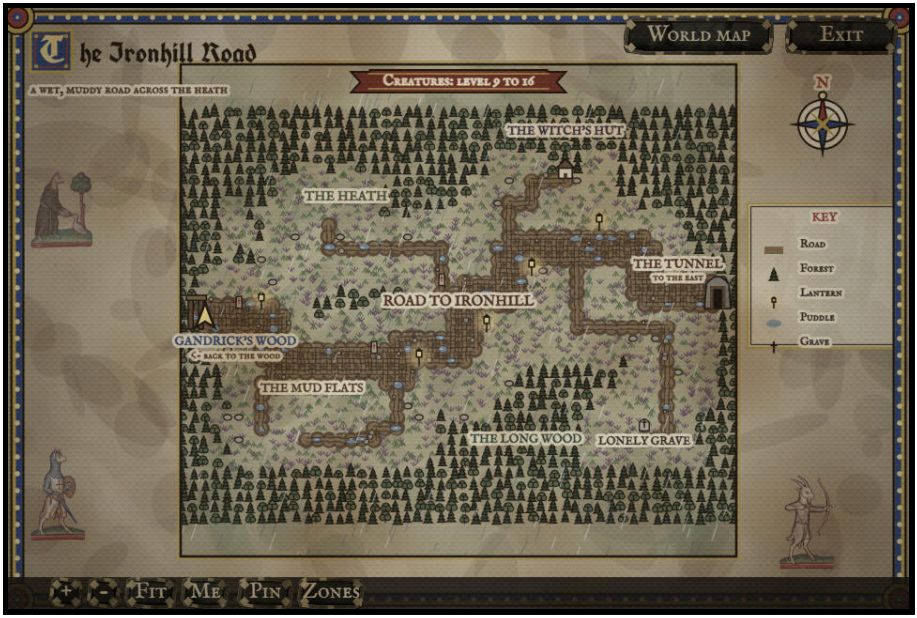


The crypts below the abbey.

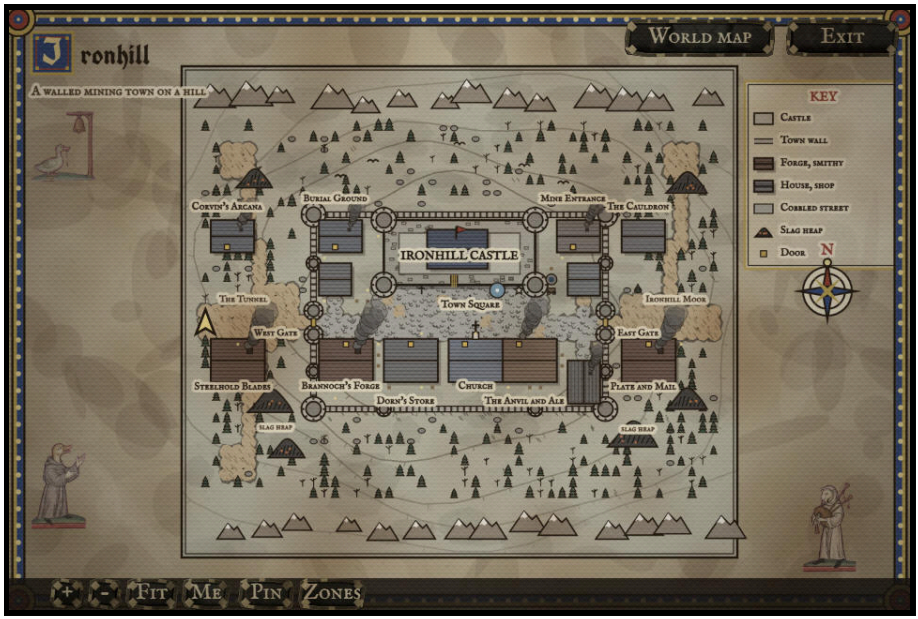
The Thornwood.



Gandrick's Wood.

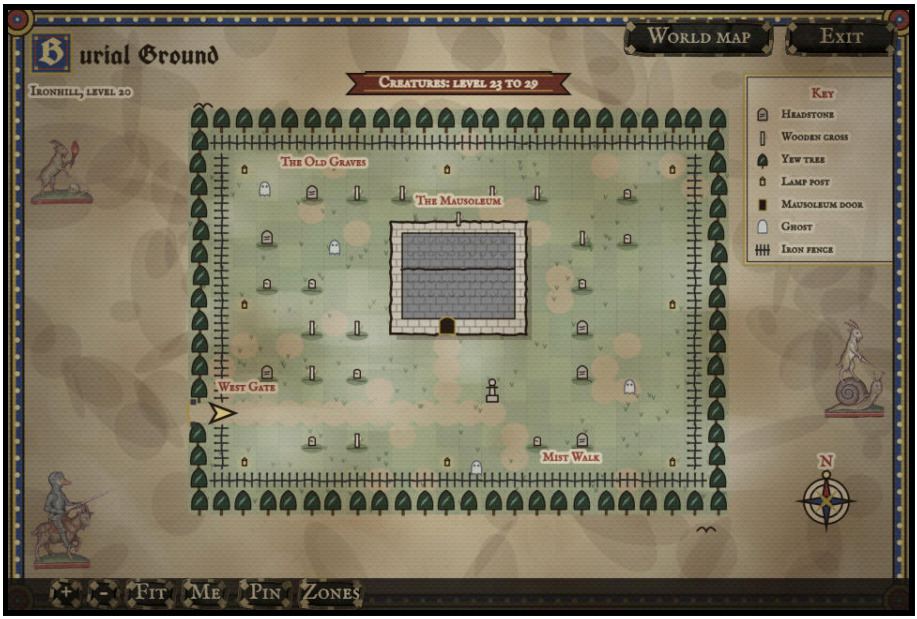


The Ironhill Road.



Ironhill.

Ironhill Moor.



The Burial Ground.

Greyfang Pass.

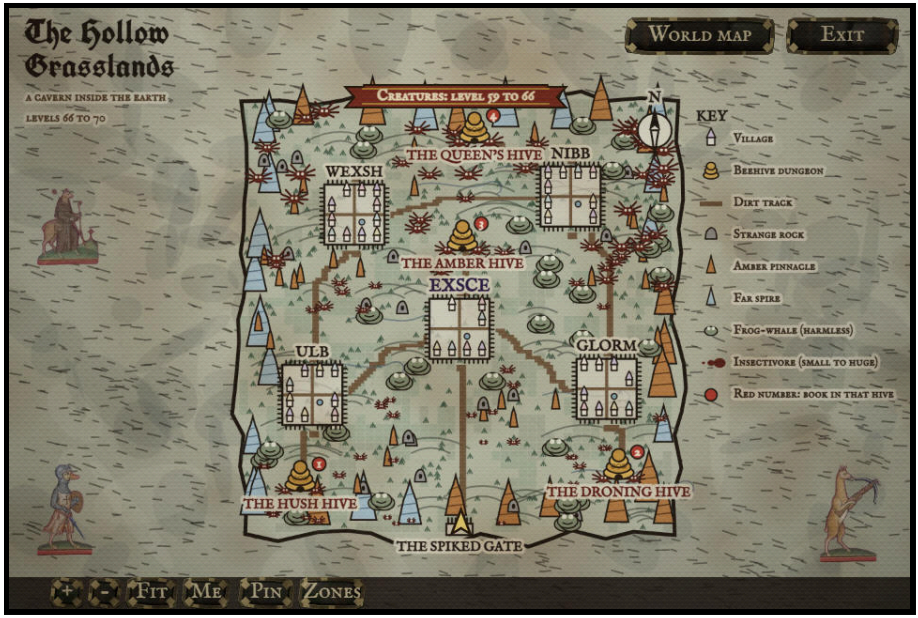
Greendale.

Anaea.

The Pilgrim's Path.

The Monastery Gate.

Saint Elen's Monastery.



The Hollow Grasslands.

The Hollow Land and the Orange Spire.

The Orange Spire, first floor.

CHAPTER 6

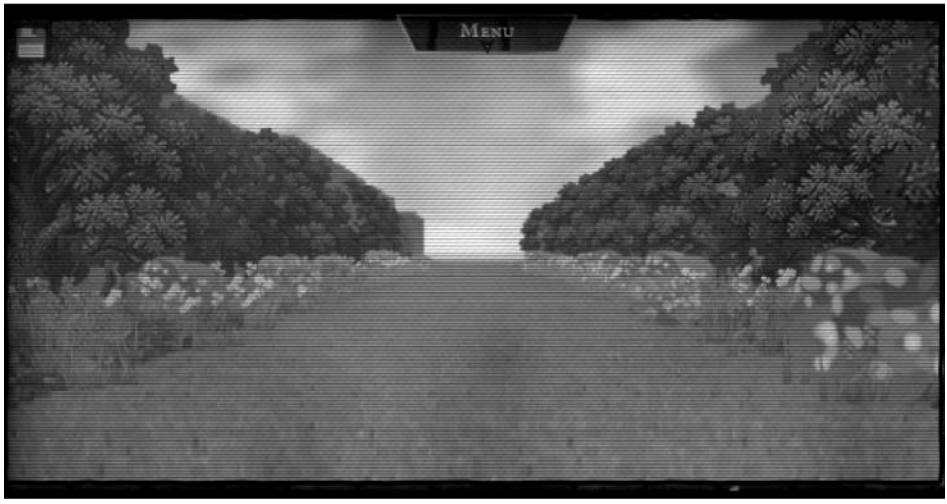
Guide to the Lands: Khemetra and the Desert

Sand roads, golden walls, sleeping sphinxes and a harbour at the end of a tunnel: a traveller's guide to the south and the east.

South of Anaea the green of Greendale thins out, and then it stops. The road you take from the east gate is the oldest in the south: it runs through a narrow forest, turns north between palms, and walks you out into the great sands. Everything in this chapter lies beyond that point. It is a country of long dunes and short tempers, of tombs that were sealed before anyone wrote down their names, and, at the end of it, of Khemetra, the Golden City, where four hundred thousand people have never heard of you.

This guide goes in the order you will most likely travel: the Sand Road and its buried chambers, the Tomb of Sut, the Red Dunes, the far deserts and their pyramid, then the city itself, district by district, and last the little harbour town of Yarrim on the Narrow Sea. Each entry gives you the level of the place (the number shown on the world map when autoscaling is off), who lives there and what they sell or ask, what hunts you, and what is worth finding.

Keep your water full and your torches fuller. The deserts are wide, the creatures are spaced far apart, and a party that wanders into the Red Dunes at level 30 will meet things that were not expecting company.



The Sand Road, a few steps out of Anaea. The forest is thick here. It will not stay that way.

THE LANDS AT A GLANCE

PLACE	LEVEL	YOU REACH IT FROM	WHAT IS THERE
The Sand Road	36	Anaea, east gate	Dunes, five little dungeons, the buried chambers, the way to the tomb
The Buried Chambers	36	Mounds on the Sand Road	Ten small dungeons, each ending in a chest

The Tomb of Sut	39	The cliff at the north of the Sand Road	Four wings, four sun discs, Sut himself
The Red Dunes	41	The door behind Sut	Ten little dungeons, obelisks, the road to Khemetra
Blue Dunes	45	A low cave off the Sand Road	An oasis, ten little dungeons
Golden Erg	45	East of the Blue Dunes	Three oases, seven dungeons, the Golden Pyramid
Violet Erg	45	South of the Golden Erg	Seven dungeons, Cinderback
White Dunes	45	South of the Blue Dunes	Five dungeons, the Wandering Cyclops
The Flatlands	45	East of the White Dunes	Eight dungeons, two oases
Khemetra	44	North of the Red Dunes	A walled city of shops, temples, homes and quests
Palace, Cisterns, Sea Tunnel	43 to 45	Inside the city	The throne room, a maze under the Potters Market, a wizard
Yarrim	48	The Sea Gate Tunnel, east of the city	A fishing town, a lighthouse, a pier

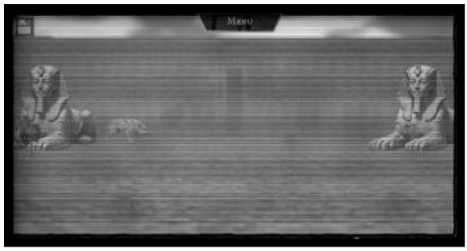
THE SAND ROAD

The road leaves Anaea through a forest that looks, for the first mile, very like Greendale. Then the trees thin, palms take over, the palms give out, and you are walking through a desert of real dunes: the ground rises and falls under your feet, and what lies beyond the next crest is a matter of faith. At the far north of the land stands a cliff, and in the cliff is the door to the Tomb of Sut. Between the road and the cliff, sphinxes lie in pairs on either side of the way.

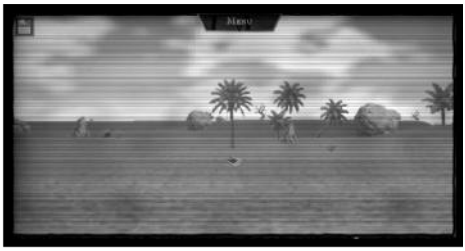
The Sand Road is a fixed place with a fixed level of 36. It is not a gentle place. Desert wolves hunt in packs, scorpions lie under the sand, and carrion vultures turn overhead. The nomads of the road are described in the game as desperate, and they act like it.

Who walks here

Nobody sells anything on the open sand, with one exception. Now and then (about one visit in four) a trading caravan crosses an open desert: one to four camels in a line, a rider or a load on each, and a few nomads on foot behind. They walk their route and stop when you come close. Speak to the caravan trader and you can buy water, dates, bread, cheese and apples. Caravans are found on the Sand Road, the Red Dunes and all five of the far deserts.



Sphinxes flank the way to the north.



A hatch half buried in the sand: one of the little dungeons.

Giant Scorpion
Sand Road, Red Dunes, every desert

Desert Wolf
hunts in packs

Carrion Vulture
circles the open sand

Desperate Nomad
armed and hungry

What to find on the Sand Road

- Eleven mounds (burrows) in the dunes. These lead down to the buried chambers, below.
- Five little dungeons, each with its own way in: a hatch, a small crypt, a ruin with stairs, a mound with a door, a larger crypt.
- Obelisks marching in pairs up the road, and the two sphinxes at the head of it.
- A low cave in the east wall of the road, leading out into the Blue Dunes.

THE BURIED CHAMBERS

The mounds in the dunes are the doors to ten small dungeons, each a handful of chambers joined by corridors, with creatures in the rooms, vases and treasure on the floor, and a chest at the far end holding a piece of magic gear. Each chamber has its own plan, so no two are alike. All ten stand at level 36.

There are five kinds, each used twice. Expect to visit more than one: a good deal of the early kit of the south comes out of these chests.

The dark passages of a little dungeon.

CHAMBER	WHAT LIVES THERE
The Scorpion Nest	Scorpions, and the sting that goes with them. The place is all dry husks and clicking in the dark.
The Mummy Vault	Mummies, who may ambush you.
The Nomads' Hideout	Nomads and desert wolves together.
The Wolf Den	Desert wolves, six of them.
The Sunken Shrine	A mixed company: scorpions, mummies and nomads.

HINT: *The stings and the dust of these places can leave the party afflicted. Carry antidotes and salve, and do not go down tired.*

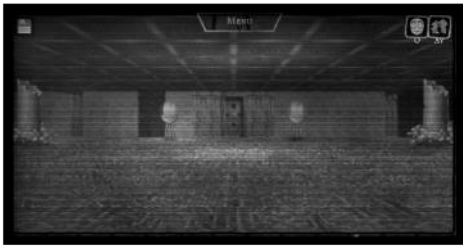
THE TOMB OF SUT

The cliff at the head of the Sand Road hides a cave full of sand, and the cave leads down into the Hall of Eternity. Four wings open off it, and each guards a golden sun disc: the Hall of Embers, the Crypt of Sarcophagi, the Chamber of Switches and the Sand Pit. When all four discs sit in the sockets of the great door, the way opens to the throne room of Sut, Lord of the Red Desert.

The tomb is level 39, a step up from the road. Skeletons, mummies, cobras and the odd scorpion keep the corridors. The walls are carved with hieroglyphs, the ceilings glitter like a night sky, and braziers burn in every hall, which is the only reason you can see the statues of Anubis staring down at you.

When Sut falls, a door appears in the north wall, and it opens on a second desert.

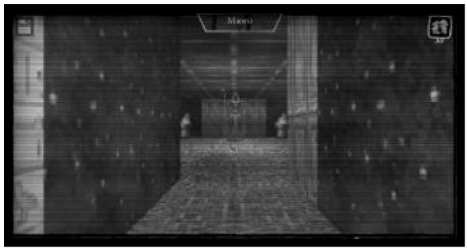
The first corridor of the tomb.



Anubis statues and burning braziers in a great hall.

Sut himself is a great creature, painted in red and gold, and he waits at the far end of the tomb. You will see him down the long hall before you reach him. Go in with full healing and the best gear you have, and see Chapter 8 for the harder questions about the tomb.

HINT: *The tomb air gives a lingering cough called Tomb Dust. It is not deadly, but it wears the party down over a long visit. Do the wings one at a time and come out to rest in between.*



The long hall to the throne room of Sut.

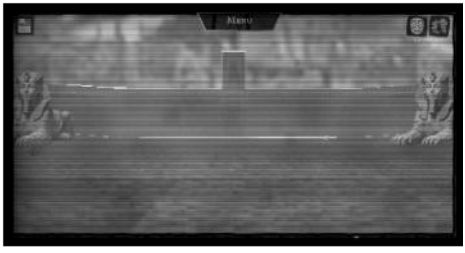
Sut, Lord of the Red Desert.

THE RED DUNES

Through the door behind Sut lies a second desert, with red sand, red rock and old ruins. The last stretch of the road is an old paved way, and far ahead to the north a city rises over the horizon. That city is Khemetra.

The Red Dunes are level 41. The wolves and scorpions of the Sand Road are here too, with more skeletons, mummies, and two kinds of nomad. Ten little dungeons lie scattered across the sand, among them the Shrine of the Sleeping Sphinx, the Barrow of the Burning Moon and the Reliquary of the Veiled Queen. Obelisks stand in pairs along the old road, and a second pair of sphinxes watches the way to the city.

Obelisks along the old road.



The sphinxes at the head of the road, and beyond them the wall of Khemetra.

Skeleton
tomb and dunes

Mummy
tombs and the Red Dunes

Cobra
the Tomb of Sut

THE FAR DESERTS

A low cave in the east wall of the Sand Road leads out to the Blue Dunes, and from there the sand goes on in every direction. Five far deserts lie beyond it, each linked to the next by a low cave. All five stand at level 45, and every one is wide, quiet and sparsely populated: the creatures live a long way apart, so you may walk for minutes before anything notices you. That is not always a comfort.

Each desert has oases, rings of old ruins, bones, and a number of little dungeons whose entrances are hatches, spires, crypts and stairs. The royal cartographer in Khemetra will send you into one dungeon in each of seven deserts, from the Sand Road to the Flatlands. Ask Neferet at the palace.

DESERT	SIZE	WATER	DUNGEONS	GREAT CREATURE
The Blue Dunes	220 by 220	One oasis, with food and water	10	none
The Golden Erg	300 by 300	Three oases	7	none, but the Golden Pyramid stands here
The Violet Erg	300 by 300	Three oases	7	Cinderback, the Fire Lizard
The White Dunes	250 by 250	Three oases	5	The Wandering Cyclops
The Flatlands	250 by 250	Two oases	8	none

The oasis of the Blue Dunes: palms, reeds and a pool.

An oasis in the Golden Erg.

The Golden Pyramid

In the Golden Erg stands a real pyramid, raised out of the sand, with a doorway in its south face. Inside is a labyrinth of golden walls. At the heart of it, behind every turning, lies a chest holding a thousand gold. The Undying Pharaoh walks the maze, ten levels above your party. He warns you when he is near, hunts you down the passages, and can warp from one part of the labyrinth to another. His servants patrol too, and their grip slows you.

The pyramid has no level of its own on the world map: the Pharaoh sets his own, by

yours. Do not go in below your best.

The Golden Pyramid, and its doorway in the south face.

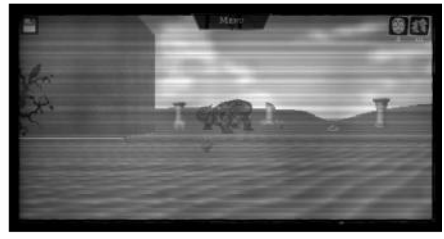
The Undying Pharaoh
the Golden Pyramid

Pharaoh's Servant
patrols the maze

Cinderback, the Fire Lizard
Violet Erg

The great creatures of the sand

Cinderback, the Fire Lizard, lies in the south of the Violet Erg. He stands at level 40, breathes a gout of flame from a distance, carries 400 gold, and drops a piece of magic gear when he falls. **The Wandering Cyclops** patrols the White Dunes at level 44, clubs rather than shoots, carries 500 gold, and drops magic gear of his own. Neither is hard to recognise.



Cinderback, far ahead across the Violet Erg.

Little dungeons of the deserts

There are fifty-two of them, numbered in the game from 100, and the Achievements page keeps count. A few hold a creature; most hold only a coffin. Here are some you are likely to be sent to.

DUNGEON	DESERT	THE WAY IN

Catacomb of Whispering Sands	Sand Road	A mound with a door
Shrine of the Sleeping Sphinx	Red Dunes	A mound with a door
Shrine of the Copper Serpent	Blue Dunes	A ruin with stairs
Undercroft of the Sand Mother	Golden Erg	Stairs going down
Barrow of the Pale Cartographer	Violet Erg	A hole in a great tree
Sepulchre of the Twin Suns	White Dunes	A hatch
Barrow of the Last Oasis	Flatlands	A hatch

KHEMETRA, THE GOLDEN CITY

Khemetra is the largest place in the game. It is a walled city, four hundred cells by four hundred, of white houses trimmed with gold, laid out round a palace whose spire seems to stand in the sky. A great avenue, nine cells wide, runs from the south gate to the palace court. Cross roads run east and west, a ring road circles the palace, and between them every kind of street, lane and dead end has been bitten into the blocks. There are lawns with palms and ponds, squares full of stalls, and a crowd that goes about its business whether you are watching or not.

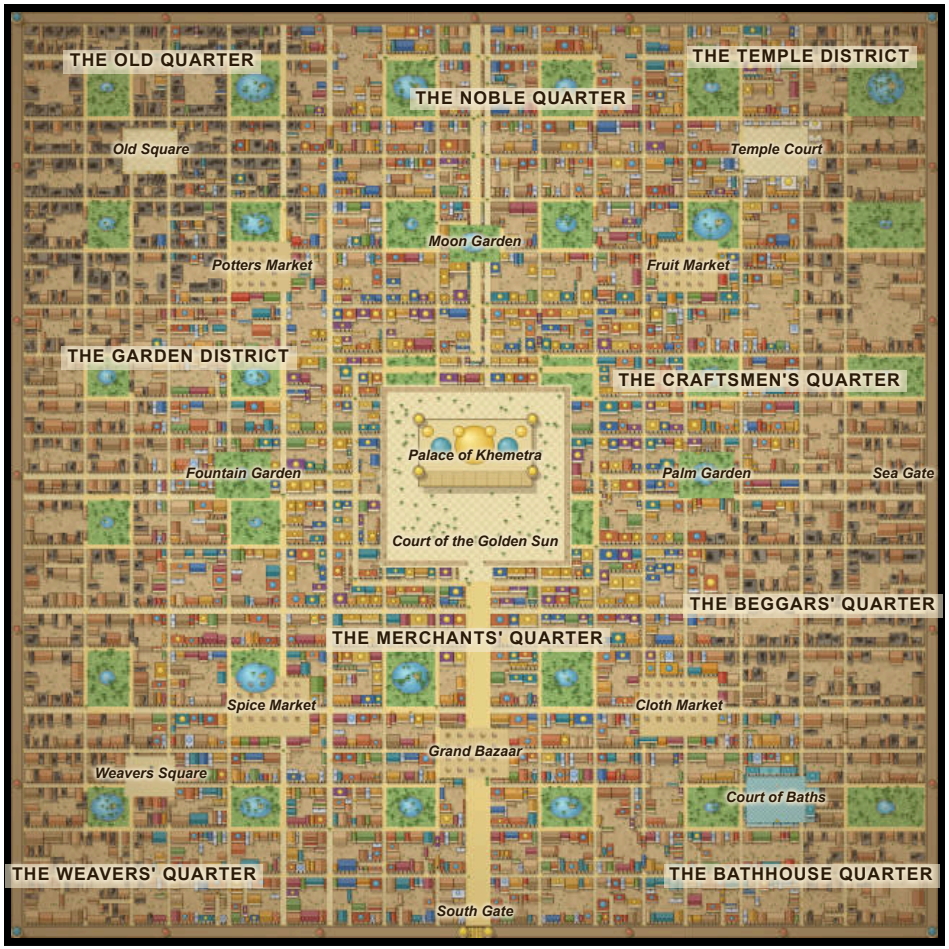
The city stands at level 44, and for most of it you are in no danger at all: the streets belong to guards, porters, children and cats. The danger is in particular corners, named below. When you walk into a quarter for the first time, a line of news tells you where you are.

Inside the south gate. Walk straight on and you reach the palace.

The great avenue, with the palace at the far end.

The Court of the Golden Sun, in front of the palace.

The map of Khemetra



The city as the in-game map draws it. The gold dots on the in-game map mark every shop door; on your own map the names fill in as you zoom in.

THE QUARTERS OF THE CITY

QUARTER	WHAT IT IS LIKE	LOOK FOR
The Noble Quarter	North of the palace.	Nefer's Philtres, Silk and Linen, the Sun Forge, the Moon Garden
The Temple District	North-east.	The Great Mosque, the Temples of the Sun and of Bastet, the House of the Guiding Star, the House of Seven Scrolls, the Sleeping Sphinx
The Craftsmen's Quarter	East of the palace.	Menkaure's Shipwrights, the Golden Crust Bakery, the Palm Garden
The Beggars' Quarter	On the east side. The houses lean together and eyes watch from the shadows. **Thieves and brigands lurk here.**	Trouble
The Bathhouse Quarter	South-east.	The Court Baths, the Blue Hammam, the Bath Cellar, the Gilded Camel, the Court of Baths
The Merchants' Quarter	South of the palace, round the Grand Bazaar.	The Wizard's Emporium, the Gilded Blade, the Iron Aegis, the Alchemist's Cellar, Kal's Menagerie, the Silver Quill
The Weavers' Quarter	South-west.	The Green Flask, Dates and Dreams, the Guard's Armoury, the Wanderer's Pack
The Garden District	West.	The Spice Garden, the church, the Fountain Garden
The Pilgrims' Way	A narrow strip in the north-west.	The House of Eternal Life, the Potters Market
The Old Quarter	North-west. **Half the houses have fallen in.** Dogs and the restless dead keep it now.	The Old Granary, ruined and boarded houses, the Hollow Hand, the Moon and Mint

THE PALACE OF KHEMETRA

Four hundred thousand souls and one door that matters. The palace stands in the middle of the city behind its court of white marble and gold leaf, and the guards at the gate do not blink. Walk up the avenue and into the front, and you come to the great hall: statues of kings (some of them real), braziers, guards, a page, a herald, and four nobles waiting about for something to happen. They are Lady Meret, Lord Sobek, Lady Tiye and Lord Anen, and all four will talk.

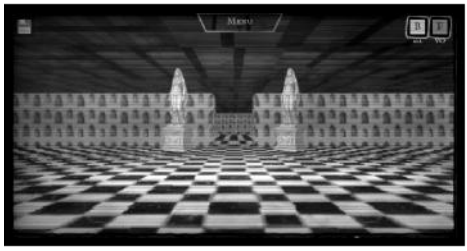
Three rooms open off the hall by their own doorways:

❦ **The throne room.** The throne is empty at first. The guards will tell you the king is away at his summer court, and that the vizier answers for him.

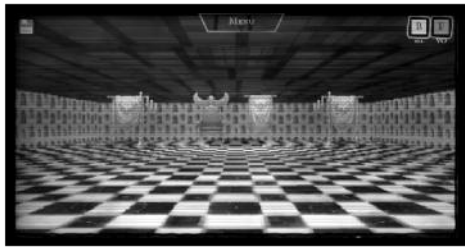
❦ **The map room, to the west.** The royal cartographer, **Neferet**, keeps every map of every desert here. She sends travellers to find the seven pieces of the Instrument of Dawn, one for each of seven little dungeons.

The palace, as painted for the game.

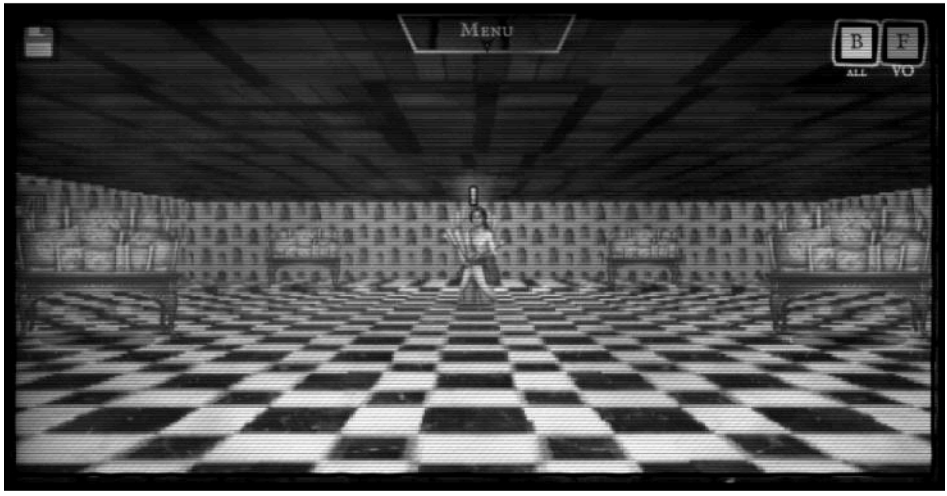
❦ **The vizier's study, to the east. Hotep-Ra, the grand vizier**, will not give a stranger the wizard's hiding place, but he has a task for those who serve the city: the royal seal was stolen by a gang that hides in the ruined houses of the Old Quarter.



The great hall of the palace.



The throne room.



The map room: tables, rolled maps and Neferet.

UNDER THE CITY, AND OUT TO SEA

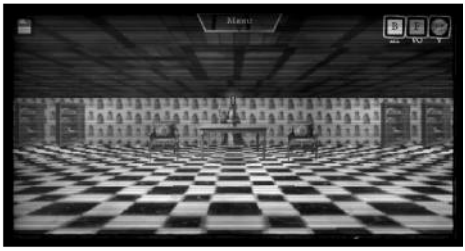
The Cisterns beneath Khemetra (level 43) are a maze of narrow stone passages under the Potters Market, with six chambers cut into the walls. Skeletons, ghosts, scorpions, bats and a single mummy keep them: thirteen creatures in

all, more than enough in the dark. Chests and potions lie in the chambers, and at the far corner of the maze a way leads up to a study.

Ishkander's Study (level 44) is a small room of bookcases, candles and cushions. The wizard Ishkander has lived here for ten years, and visitors are rare. The grand vizier will tell you how to find the hatch once you have earned it.

The Tunnel to the Narrow Sea (level 45) is a short, bright cave that ends at the shore. It is reached from the east of the Violet Erg. A second tunnel, behind the Sea Gate in the east wall of Khemetra, leads to Yarrim, below.

A passage in the cisterns.



Ishkander's study, at the end of the maze.

SHOPS OF THE GOLDEN CITY

Almost every shop in Khemetra is a door in a street front, with a keeper behind a counter. Gold dots on the city map mark them. Here are the ones worth a walk.

SHOP	KEEPER	SELLS	QUARTER
The Wizard's Emporium	Zahir, the court wizard	Spells	Merchants' Quarter
The Gilded Blade	Hakim, the swordsmith	Swords. "I sell nothing magic, and I need nothing magic."	Merchants' Quarter
The Iron Aegis	Nadira, the armourer	Helms, plate and shields, fitted by strength and standing	Merchants' Quarter
The Alchemist's Cellar	Ptah-Em, the alchemist	Draughts to heal and restore, brews of might and speed, cures	Merchants' Quarter
Kal's Menagerie	Kal, the animal trader	Pets: goats, llamas, frogs, ducks, cats, dogs, parrots, snakes, songbirds. Up to three follow you	Merchants' Quarter
The Sun Forge	Khaset, the smith	Daggers, swords, maces, axes, bows, staves	Noble Quarter
The Guard's Armoury	Sergeant Ahmose	Caps, helms, shields, jerkins, leggings, bracers	Weavers' Quarter
Nefer's Philtres	Nefer, the potion seller	Potions, antidotes, salves, holy water, sleeping tea	Noble Quarter
The Green Flask	Tamit	Potions, antidotes, salves, holy water, sleeping tea	Weavers' Quarter

Old Senet's Remedies	Old Senet, the healer	Potions, antidotes, salves, holy water, sleeping tea	Bathhouse Quarter
The Silver Quill	Iry	Scrolls of fire, frost and light; rings	Merchants' Quarter
House of Seven Scrolls	Wenis	Scrolls and rings	Temple District
The Golden Crust Bakery	Merit, the baker	Bread, cheese, dates, nuts, ale, pies, roast, honeycomb and more	Craftsmen's Quarter
Dates and Dreams	Hapu, the date seller	Bread, cheese, dates, nuts, ale, pies, roast, honeycomb and more	Weavers' Quarter
The Spice Garden	Perneb, the spice merchant	Bread, cheese, dates, nuts, ale, pies, roast, honeycomb and more	Garden District
Hapi's Pantry	Hapi	Bread, cheese, dates, nuts, ale, pies, roast, honeycomb and more	Old Quarter
Silk and Linen	Qadir, the cloth trader	Torches, lanterns, food, water, herbs, ore	Noble Quarter
The Wanderer's Pack	Zahra	Torches, lanterns, food, water	Weavers' Quarter

The Grand Bazaar, with the palace in the distance.

The Cloth Market. Stalls, shoppers and the odd rabbit.

The Wizard's Emporium, on the Grand Bazaar.

The Gilded Blade: the sign hangs over the door.

Zahir sells spells, every one of them real, and no one has ever been turned into a frog by accident (he says). Close by the swordsmith will sell you steel for every level of customer, from the first blade to the last. Nadira and her Iron Aegis fit helms and plate by strength and standing, so a heavy piece may need a stronger arm than you have yet.

Prices are fair and the keepers are friendly, but gold does not last. A few of the favours below pay better than the shops charge.

INNS, PRAYER HOUSES, TEMPLES AND BATHS

A tired party has a good many places to rest in Khemetra, and all are for sale. **Inns** rent a bed (the whole party rests). **Prayer houses** and **temples** heal the party for a small offering. **Baths** rest and refresh it for ten gold.

PLACE	KEEPER	GOLD	WHAT YOU GET
The Gilded Camel	Hasan, innkeeper	25	A bed, hot baths, a cook who can make a lamb disappear
The Sleeping Sphinx	Dalila, innkeeper	20	A bed. They never close
The Moon and Mint	Rashid, innkeeper	30	A bed, and the tea is free
House of the Rising Sun	Priestess Nebet	15	The party is healed
House of the Guiding Star	Brother Omari	15	The party is healed
House of Eternal Life	Priestess Hana	15	The party is healed
House of the New Moon	Brother Pasha	15	The party is healed
Temple of the Sun	Acolyte Tuya	20	The party is healed
Temple of Bastet	High Priest Omari	20	The party is healed. The cats are holy
The Great Mosque	Imam Qadir	20	The party is healed. Open to every traveller
The Church of Light	Father Idris	20	The party is healed. The bell rings for every traveller who comes home
The Court Baths	Isis, attendant	10	Rest and refresh. Weapons are left at the door
The Blue Hammam	Dedi, keeper	10	Rest and refresh. The oldest bath in the city

The Great Mosque of Khemetra.

The Church of Light.

The Temple of the Sun, in the Temple District.

The Temple of Bastet: the cat goddess watches the door.

WORK, CONTRACTS AND FAVOURS

Khemetra has more quests than any other place. Sixty-three of them in the game's log are filed under the city, and the best way to meet them is simply to walk the streets and talk to people.

The three **work houses** (the Labourers' Hall, the Day Hire House and the Porters' Guild) hand out errands: fetch eight jars of water for the labourers (40 gold), six loaves for the dawn crew (36), three lanterns for the Porters (150). The goods are for sale in the markets. The **Contract House** and the **Bounty Board** sell contracts for a small fee: ten skeletons (260 gold), ten scorpions or cobras (300) or eight mummies (380). Kill them anywhere in the deserts.

QUEST	WHO ASKS
A Feast for the Bride	Mother Sabah
Lanterns for the Moon Festival	Hapi the Festival Master
The Lost Cats	Old Dalila
The Missing Ledger	Tax Official Usi
A Drum for Yara	Yara the musician
The Singing Well	Hapuseneb, the well keeper
The Cat Who Would Be King	Sacristan Nefertari
The Goat Who Ate the Tax Roll	Clerk Senu
A Hundred Dates for a Camel	Qadir, the camel master

The Puppet Show	Zaza, the puppeteer
The Tax on Sneezes	Tax Collector Ptah
Nuts for the Moon Squirrels	Zeb, the merchant

HOUSES, RUINS AND DANGEROUS CORNERS

You can walk up to almost any house in Khemetra and open its door. Sixteen ordinary ones have a painted picture of their room: a warm house with a fire and a pot of stew, a wizard's house with skulls and star charts, a magical house with glowing hieroglyphs, a cat lover's house with a small shrine to Bastet. Others hold a person with something to ask: a quiet house, a merchant's, a scholar's, a musician's. Some hold something worse.

The ruined parts of the city are marked by their names. In the Old Quarter, the **Ruined House** and the **Collapsed House** hold three skeletons each, and the **Abandoned House** holds two skeletons and two bats. The **Old Granary** is full of rats (eight, and two bats), and its keeper Gebu would like them gone. The **Boarded House** hides three bandits and an archer. They call themselves the Hollow Hand. The **Bath Cellar** holds four ghosts.

"A wizard's house. There are skulls and star charts on every shelf, and a flask is boiling by itself."

"The walls are blue and white tile, and the dome has small holes that let in the light."

The Temple Court, white marble under a heavy sky.

The Palm Garden: lawns, benches and passers-by.

Rules of the city

- The Beggars' Quarter and the Old Quarter are the only parts of the city that will hurt you. Go in prepared.
- The inns, prayer houses and baths are cheap. Use them before a hard room, not after.
- Almost any market sells water. Buy a lot before the deserts.
- Talk to everyone twice. The first time you get the gossip, and the second, sometimes, the favour.

YARRIM, ON THE NARROW SEA

Once the Sea Gate in the east wall of Khemetra has been unsealed, a tunnel runs out through the rock to the shore, and at the end of it lies Yarrim: a fishing town of about twenty tiny cottages, each its own colour, round one-cell cobbled lanes, a harbour square at the root of a long pier, and a lighthouse. Gulls are everywhere. The sea is real ground, with a beach that slopes into it, islands of rock and sand, and boats moored in the water. At anchor off the beach rides the *Dawn Walker*.

Yarrim is level 48, and a peaceful place: the tunnel is full of the drowned dead (ten skeletons, Menkaure would like them cleared) and the Net Loft has rats (eight). Everything else is a conversation.

The pier at Yarrim. The Dawn Walker is at anchor beyond it.

The road into Yarrim, between the cottages.

Inside the Yarrim Light.

PLACE	KEEPER	WHAT THEY OFFER
The Drowned Lantern	Bessa, innkeeper	A bed for 20 gold. A shanty drifts out of the door
The Harbourmaster's Office	Tamsin Kell	Errands: the crab census, washed-up crates, rats in the Net Loft
Selk's Ship Dealing	Selk, the ship dealer	Ships. See Chapter 7
Wen's Trading Post	Wen, the trader	Torches, lanterns, potions, antidotes, salves, bread, water, dates, herring, ale, dagger, bow, cap, jerkin
Brine and Rope	Pell, the ship's chandler	Rope, tar, lamps, oil, torches, a good sharp knife
Corran's Fish Stall	Corran, the fishmonger	Herring, fresh when the boats come in
The Chapel of the Tides	Brother Haldane	A chapel you can enter
Old Maren's House	Old Maren	A cottage you can enter
The Yarrim Light	Orsa, keeper	A dark lamp, and a favour

The people of Yarrim have small and curious troubles, and nine of them are worth a morning each: **The Admiral's Telescope** (Pell), **The Great Crab Census** (Tamsin Kell), **A Message in a Bottle** (Wink, a child), **Wen's Left Boot**, **The Wedding of the Boats** (Selk), **Biscuit Won't Budge** (Hamid and his donkey), **The Net Thief of the Night Tide** (Nell), **The Drowned Lantern** (Bessa) and **The Shanty With No Last Verse** (Rafe, the fiddler).

The larger story continues from the vizier and Menkaure the shipwright, and the road beyond Yarrim goes to sea: turn to Chapter 7.

The Dawn Walker.

Tam Salvor, in his diving suit.

HINT: *The nine small quests in Yarrim pay in gold and experience and do not need a hard fight. They are a pleasant place to rest a party that has just walked the whole length of the desert.*

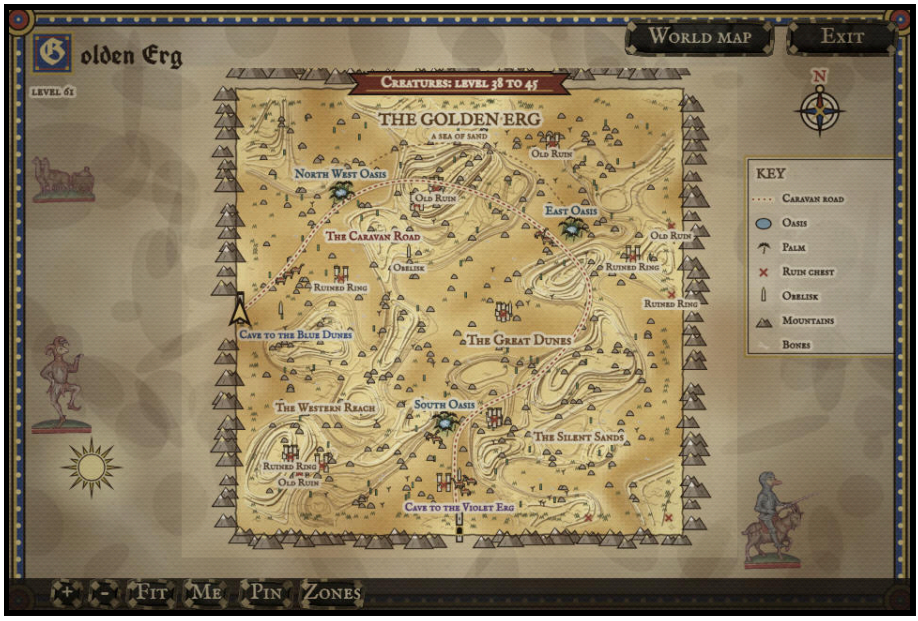
Atlas of the Deserts

The Sand Road.

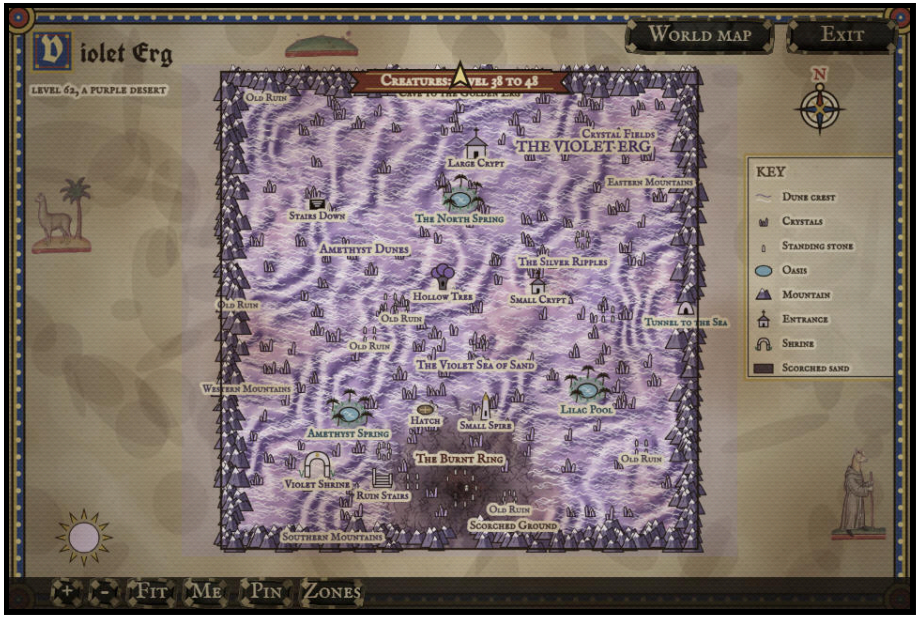
The Tomb of Sut.

The Red Dunes.

The Blue Dunes.



The Golden Erg.

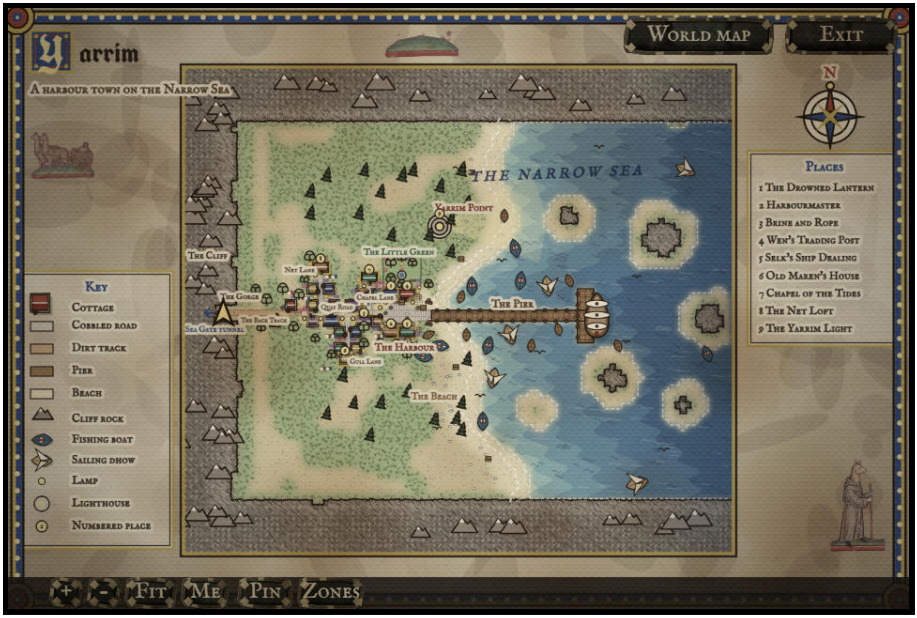


The Violet Erg.

The White Dunes.

The Flatlands.

Khemetra, the Golden City.



Yarrim, on the Narrow Sea.

CHAPTER 7

Guide to the Lands: The Seas and the East

A traveller's guide to the Narrow Sea and everything under it, the long road to the far shore, and the grey castle city that waits at the end of the voyage.

The bow of the Dawn Walker off Greenmantle. The red and white buoy marks the way in, and the Disembark button has appeared at the lower left.

When the party leaves Yarrim in the Dawn Walker, the map of the game changes. There are no roads. There is a sea of eight hundred by six hundred and forty squares, seventeen islands, four reefs, a monster the old sailors will not name, and a far shore where a king is waiting. This chapter is a guide to all of it, written in the manner of a good travel book: where to go, who you will meet, what they sell, what bites, and how hard the place is.

Every place in the game has a level, shown beside its name on the world map. The ratings in this chapter are those numbers. The Narrow Sea and its islands are fixed at about level 50, and Oldhaven and the lands behind it at 55. If your party is a good deal below those figures, go and gain strength elsewhere and return. Nothing at sea will wait for you to be ready, with one exception: the Kraken, which will let you turn back.

"Walk forward to sail." The ship's own first words to you.

The guide is arranged in the order that a party meets the places. First the sea and how to sail it, then the four islands that matter to the story, the small islands nobody lives on, the reefs beneath, the Kraken, and last the Eastern Lands: the quay and the city of Oldhaven, the Oakwood behind it and the long Pilgrim's Path that runs home.

THE SEAS AND THE EAST AT A GLANCE

PLACE	LEVEL	WHAT IT IS	WHO AND WHAT

The Narrow Sea	50	Open water, 800 by 640 squares	Sea serpents, wrecks, landing buoys, the Kraken line
Saltbarrow	49	Pirate haven of sand and canvas	Sable Maeve; Bandits and Bandit Archers
The Isle of Bells	49	A drowned abbey in the mist	Brother Aldous; ghosts, spectres, skeletons
Cinder Isle	49	A smoking volcano	Ketra the ash-priestess; Cinder Guardian
Last Light	49	A ruined beacon on bare rock	Isolde the scribe; assassins
Thirteen small islands	50	Sand, rock, forest	Chests, wrecks, altars; crabs, skeletons, wolves
Four reefs	50	Underwater dungeons	Sharks, octopus, eels; a great beast in each
The Kraken waters	50	The deep east of the sea	The Kraken; four harpoons
Oldhaven Quay	55	The king's harbour	Fish stalls, inns, chandler, armoury, gate
Oldhaven	55	Castle city, 150 by 150	Shops, inns, chapel, court of King Osric
The Oakwood	55	Old oak forest, six glades	Woodwardens, Oakwrights; wolves
The Pilgrim's Path	55	96 kilometres of road	Inns, chapels, shrines, hidden caves

SAILING THE DAWN WALKER

The Dawn Walker was built by Menkaure the shipwright and lies at the end of the pier in Yarrim. Speak to Menkaure when your stores are aboard and the lamp is lit, and the ship casts off at evening with Lord Corvane's black ship hunting along the reef behind her. Your first landfall is Saltbarrow.

At the pier

Whenever the ship is tied up at a pier, speak to her and the chart is laid out on the table. It lists Saltbarrow always, the Isle of Bells once Maeve's work is done, Cinder Isle once Aldous is satisfied, and Last Light once Ketra is content. Choose a name and the Dawn Walker sails there on her own, and about six hours of the day go by on the water (eight if you sail back to Yarrim). The last choice on the chart is the important one: *Take the helm and sail the open sea.*

On the open sea

Here walking is sailing. You see the water over the bow rail, the rail rocks a little with the swell, and the arrow keys steer the ship exactly as they move the party on land. Every square you sail takes a few minutes of the day, so a long crossing feeds the party and moves the clock. The sea is full of things to look at: as many as sixteen ships under sail on the horizon, seven drifting wrecks, floating crates and barrels, and gulls over every island.

Press [M] for the map. At sea it opens zoomed right out, with every island named. The button at the lower right opens the world map, which shows the level of each place.

The sea map: every island is named, and Oldhaven is the name on the far shore.

The world map, with the level beside each name. The Eastern Lands lie across the water.

Landing buoys, Disembark and Embark

Every island has a landing buoy, a red and white float on a rope, moored on its south side. Walk into the buoy and you are offered a row ashore. Yarrim has a buoy on the west shore and Oldhaven has one on the far east coast.

You do not need a pier at all. Whenever the ship is within **eight squares** of an island's land, a **Disembark** button appears at the lower left of the view with the island's name above it. Press it and the party is put ashore on the beach nearest the ship, and the Dawn Walker rides at anchor just off the sand.

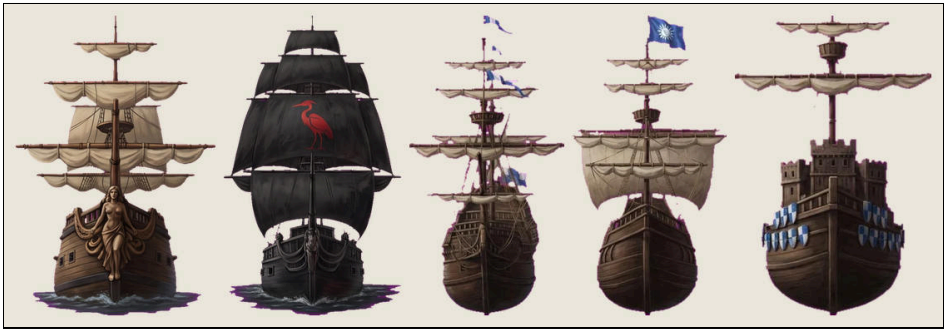
Ashore, whenever you are within **eight squares** of the ship, an **Embark** button appears in the same corner and takes you back aboard, exactly where she lay. If you walk up to the anchored ship and speak to her, you may climb aboard and sail from there as well. The button hides while a hostile creature is close by, so deal with the crabs first.

Approaching the Isle of Bells. Within eight squares of land, Disembark appears.

Back on the sand at Saltbarrow. The Embark button means the Dawn Walker is within reach.

The rules of the sea, in brief

- Walk forward to sail. The sea is open, and land is solid.
- Within eight squares of an island, **Disembark**. Within eight squares of the ship, **Embark**.
- Sea serpents hunt the open water west of the Kraken line. Keep the bow toward them.
- At the pier, speak to the ship to read the chart or take the helm.
- The Kraken does not leave its water. Sail back west and it sinks to wait for you.



The Dawn Walker, Corvane's black Heron, and the three great ships of the Oldhaven harbour, all painted for the game.

THE NARROW SEA

The Narrow Sea is not narrow. The west shore is Yarrim's coast, a long line of sand at the left of the map. The far east shore, across a hundred squares of cold flat water beyond the Kraken line, is the western edge of the Eastern Lands, where Oldhaven stands. Between them lie four named islands that carry the story, thirteen small ones that carry only treasure, and a great deal of water.

Sea serpents

About eighteen sea serpents hunt in the open water, away from the shores and the buoys. A Sea Serpent has 240 health before scaling and stands a level above your party. It hits for 12 to 19. The harbourmaster of Yarrim, Tamsin Kell, will pay a bounty on five of them.

Wrecks and flotsam

Seven wrecks drift on the open water and more lie on the islands. Walk up to one and look. Sable Maeve's lost captains kept logbooks, and some of the logs are still aboard.

THE FOUR ISLANDS

These four stand in a rough chain across the western sea, and the story leads from one to the next. Each has a pier with the Dawn Walker moored at the end, a landing buoy, and a dive line (see Diving).

Saltbarrow *(level 49)*

A pirate haven of sand, wrecks and canvas tents. Palms lean over the beach, crates are stacked beside the tents, a wreck lies on the sand and bones lie by the shore. The black ship Corvane sent after you has left forty marines camped along the north and east shore.

Who lives here. Sable Maeve, the pirate queen, who wants the marines gone and has news of the scribe Isolde to trade. Beside her camp stand a pirate cook and a deckhand, who talk freely.

Monsters. The marines are Bandits and Bandit Archers. The archers hide in the dunes.

Later. Maeve has more work for a party that finishes the first: the logbooks of her scattered fleet, and a flagship sunk on the reef below.

The people of the islands: Sable Maeve, Brother Aldous, Ketra, Isolde and Tam Salvor.

The Isle of Bells *(level 49)*

Mist over a drowned abbey. Three ruined arches hold three great green bronze bells, two to the north and one to the south. An altar stands in the middle, and standing stones watch the shore.

Who lives here. Brother Aldous, who sheltered the scribe three years ago and kept the first page she left. He will not give it to a stranger. Ring all three bells for him, and be ready for what wakes.

Monsters. Ghosts, Spectres and Skeletons. Each bell you ring raises more ghosts nearby, so do not ring them hurt.

Later. Aldous holds two further tasks: the silent bell below the waves, and the singing shell (see the Nautilus Helm, below).

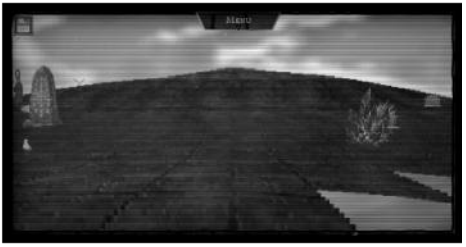
Cinder Isle *(level 49)*

Black rock and red glow. The mountain breathes. The ground is bare black ash, with runestones, a tent or two, and six black crystals with cracks of red lying round the slopes.

Who lives here. Ketra, the ash-priestess, who keeps the second page and does not give things away. She wants three crystals and the Guardian that walks the high path.

Monsters. The Cinder Guardian, a thing the mountain made, with 260 health before scaling; also Skeletons and Giant Scorpions.

The Isle of Bells. The runestone rises from the shore, and the Embark button shows the ship close behind.



The black slope of Cinder Isle, seen from the beach.

Last Light *(level 49)*

A scrap of rock at the end of the chart. A small lamp burns in a hut on the shore. Stones stand in a ring round an old altar at the top of the island, and a wreck lies on the beach.

Who lives here. Isolde, the exiled scribe, who wrote the master ledger in three copies and has lived in fear of the sea since. Be gentle with her.

Monsters. Assassins and Hitmen, the sort of people who are sent for a price.

Later. Isolde wants the great lens of the beacon raised from the wreck below, and it is she who knows where one of the Kraken guns lies.

Last Light, from the sand. Its beacon stone stands in the middle of the island.

The slope of Cinder Isle from the helm, with its buoy.

SPOILER
The chain of three pages ends on the altar of Last Light, and Lord Corvane waits there. Do not climb to it with a wounded party. Chapter 8 has more.

THE THIRTEEN SMALL ISLANDS

Nobody lives on the other islands, and each is built the moment you reach it. All are level 50. On every island you will find chests (salt has eaten the locks): gold, a potion or a draught, and a little experience. Wrecks, altars and stone rings are scattered about, and gulls stand on the shore. A potion lies near the landing point of each.

The islands come in kinds. A *tiny* island is a speck of sand with a camp or a chest. A *rock* is bare black or red stone, with wrecks and arches. A *forest* island is big, green and full of wolves.

ISLAND	KIND	YOU WILL FIND	MONSTERS
Tern Rock	tiny	Bones, a chest, a rotted sign	Reef Crabs
Pebble Cay	tiny	Palms, a chest, an abandoned camp	Reef Crabs
Gannet Spit	tiny	Bones, a wreck, a chest	Reef Crabs
The Sunk Key	tiny	Half a ship's ribs, a chest	Reef Crabs
Lonely Sands	tiny	Palms, bones, a camp	Reef Crabs
Cormorant Ledge	tiny	A stone arch nobody built, a chest, a castaway	Reef Crabs
Kelpgate Rock	rock	A broken ship on the rocks, an arch, standing stones, a chest	Skeletons, Reef Crabs
Redcliff	rock	Red cliffs, an old altar, a camp, a chest	Skeletons, Giant Scorpions
Wrack Point	rock	An arch, a wreck, a chest	Skeletons, Reef Crabs
Greenmantle	forest	Standing stones, two chests, a camp, an arch	Grey Wolves, Bandits, Bandit Archers
The Hollow Isle	forest	A ring of standing stones, an altar, a chest, a castaway	Grey Wolves, Skeletons, Ghosts
Ashwood	forest	Two chests, camps, a high ledge with a nest	Grey Wolves, Bandits, Archers, Spectres
Leviathan's Rest	tiny	Black glass sand, bleached bone, an altar	Skeletons

HINT: *Cormorant Ledge and the Hollow Isle each hold a castaway who is worth speaking to, and Ashwood's nest is worth a visit if you listen to the harbourmaster in Yarrim. The farthest island east, Leviathan's Rest, lies beyond the Kraken line.*

DIVING: THE UNDERWATER DUNGEONS

Below each of the four main islands lies a reef, a great seabed one hundred and ten squares wide: a sunlit sea for a sky, fish and schools of fish drifting overhead, coral and kelp standing where trees would stand, and a bubbling vent here and there that gives air. These are dungeons in all but the name, and the creatures in them bite.

The Diving Helm

Every hero must wear a **Diving Helm** in the helmet slot before the dive line will take you down. Tam Salvor, the helm-maker in Yarrim, sells them (300 gold each, armour 3), in his own brass suit so that he is easy to find. A helm gives four minutes of air at a time.

Air

The air bar sits at the top of the view. You will be warned at one minute, at thirty seconds and at ten. When the air is gone the party starts drowning, losing a few per cent of their health every two seconds, and after fourteen seconds a dive line hauls them up to the surface. A vent is a stream of bubbles in the seabed: stand within one square of it and the party breathes freely until the air is full again. Each reef has four.

A **Potion of the Gill** gives the whole party the dive for good and removes the need for helms. It is priced at 2500 gold. A bottle lies in the great chest under Last Light, and a chapel in Yarrim keeps another for those who bring it pearls.

The Drowned Abbey: a bell sways in a broken arch.

The Saltbarrow Reef.

The wreck beneath Last Light.

Dive from the south beach of an island: a red and white buoy on a rope, the *dive line*, runs down into the water. Underwater, the line is the buoy near where you arrive, and it takes you up again.

The Diving Helm, the Nautilus Helm and the Potion of the Gill.

REEF	UNDER	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	THE GREAT BEAST
The Saltbarrow Reef	Saltbarrow	Staghorn and brain coral, gold shafts of light	The Reef Warden, an octopus
The Drowned Abbey	Isle of Bells	Roofless arches hung with kelp, a silent bell	The Abbey Eel

The Vent Gardens	Cinder Isle	Black rock, warm bubbles, blue tube sponges	The Vent Tyrant, a giant shark
The Last Light Wreck	Last Light	A kelp forest and a ship on her side	Old Gulper, a very old fish

What lives and what you find

Reef Sharks, Barracuda, Reef Crabs, Octopuses, Glow Jellies and Moray Eels live in every reef, and Spiny Puffers in the last two. Some of the fish overhead are only scenery, and do not bite. All four reefs are level 50.

Up to ten giant clams lie on each reef floor. About half hold a white pearl, and the rest hold a few coins. Up to eight shell-clasped chests hold gold and a potion or a draught. The beast of each reef guards a great chest at the end of its arena, and the prize belongs to the dive quest set by the islander on the surface: Maeve's sunk fortune, the bell's clapper, the Heart of the Vent and the lens of the beacon.

HINT: *Once Pell, the chandler in Yarrim, has asked for wreck-oak, cut the planks of black oak you pass in the reefs. He turns three of them into a harpoon.*

The Nautilus Helm

After the Isle of Bells quest is finished, Brother Aldous tells you of a great spiral shell that broke in four in a storm, one piece sinking beneath each island: the Whorl under Saltbarrow, the Lip under the Isle of Bells, the Spire under Cinder Isle and the Pearl-Lining under Last Light.

A piece lies in a far corner of every reef, in a **pearl-white clam that glows**. It is not like the clams that hold pearls, and it stays shut until Aldous has asked you to find it. Bring all four back to him and the shell mends itself into the **Nautilus Helm**: armour 9, it restores the wearer's health every round of a battle, brings mana back faster, and lets them breathe under the sea.

HINT: *Leave the paths. The glowing clam sits in a corner, well away from the rest.*

THE KRAKEN

The Kraken stands between the two coasts of the Narrow Sea. It is **twenty levels above your party**, with a thousand suckers, and nothing your party carries can hurt it. No ship has crossed the deep water in a hundred years.

The Kraken waters

There is a line far to the east, about five hundred and forty-five squares across the map. As you approach it the message comes: *the water ahead is flat and cold. No gulls fly east of here.* Cross it and the sea turns black. Far ahead, seventeen or

more squares, something vast rises out of the water, and it comes for you.

You may run. If you sail back west, and the Kraken is more than fourteen squares behind, it sinks into the dark and waits. Once it is slain the sea to the east is open for good.

The Kraken guns

The old fleet of the Crown killed the Kraken once, with four magical harpoons forged for nothing else. When the fleet burned the guns were scattered over the sea. When the ledger is complete, Menkaure lays it on the chart table and tells you where to look: ask Ketra, Sable Maeve, Brother Aldous and Isolde. Each knows where one lies.

Every hero needs one in hand. Each does between 3000 and 4400 damage to the Kraken, and next to nothing to anything else. When the Kraken is dead the four flare white and fall to ash, because they were never meant to outlast it.

The Kraken rises ahead of the Dawn Walker.

A Sea Serpent lifts its head. The plate shows its level against your party.

The four Kraken guns: the Ember, Verdigris, Silver and Beacon Harpoons.

The Kraken and a Sea Serpent.

SPOILER

The four guns lie on the Redcliff altar (the Ember Harpoon, from Ketra), in the flagship wrecked on Kelpgate Rock (the Verdigris Harpoon, from Maeve), among the standing stones of the Hollow Isle (the Silver Harpoon, from Aldous) and in the wreck beneath Last Light (the Beacon Harpoon, from Isolde, which needs a dive). Menkaure sets the task once you hold the third page of the ledger.

HINT: *Equip a harpoon in every hero before you cross the line. A hero with a sword in hand will do nothing at all to the Kraken.*

THE EASTERN LANDS

With the Kraken dead the harbour boom of Oldhaven is down, and a long grey sea wall runs along the shore, with the towers of the king's city rising over it. The Eastern Lands are the country of King Osric: a quay, a castle city, an oak wood behind it and a pilgrim's road that leads home.

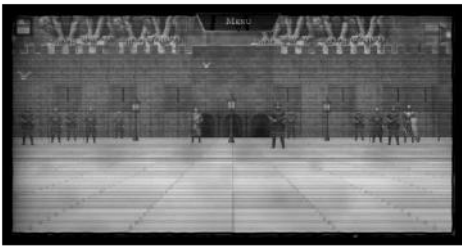
Oldhaven Quay (level 55)

The king's harbour. The Dawn Walker ties up at the end of a long pier. Five piers run out into the water with big ships moored between them, small boats rock in the swell, and flags in the blue and white of Oldhaven fly from every pole. Under

the grey wall, a paved plaza fills with fishwives, sailors, stevedores and soldiers in squads of two or three. Dogs trot about the stalls.

The **great gate** stands at the north end of the plaza in the line of the wall: three squares of portcullis between two wings of dressed stone with arrow slits, and a round tower at each end. The keep and spires of the castle loom above it. Gargoyles crouch along the top of the gatehouse, and four more on plinths stand sentinel at the foot. On your first visit the gate is barred until noon, and the harbour herald will tell you so.

From the end of the pier. The Embark button shows the Dawn Walker close behind, and the castle fills the sky ahead.



The great gate. Gargoyles crouch on the wall above.

The four gargoyles of the quay gate.

The fish market

On the west of the plaza is the fish market, four stalls each with its own catch. Marta, the fishwife, sells herring, mackerel, sardines, crab and oysters, and bread. Big Hobb, the fishmonger, has haddock, salt cod and jellied eel, with oysters and ale. Pol, the quay cook, serves fried fish in a cone and bowls of chowder. Warrick, in the Fishmonger's Hall, has the lot.

The fish are the cheapest food in the east, and heal as well as feed. A bowl of chowder heals 36 and feeds 100.

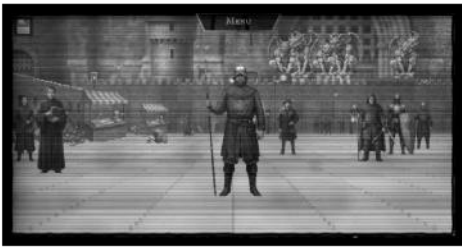
FISH	HEALS	FEEDS	PRICE
Smoked Mackerel	22	80	9
Pickled Sardines	14	60	5
Boiled Crab	28	85	12

Smoked Haddock	24	85	10
Salt Cod	18	90	7
Jellied Eel	20	70	8
Plate of Oysters	26	60	14
Fried Fish in a Cone	30	90	11
Bowl of Fish Chowder	36	100	13

Along the quay

DOOR	KEEPER	WHAT IT OFFERS
The Fishmonger's Hall	Warrick	Every fish on the quay, and chowder
The Anchor and Rope	Tilda, ship chandler	Rope, tar, torches, lanterns, general goods
The Ship's Armoury	Ser Aldred	Cutlasses, boarding axes, round shields
The Mariners' Rest	Hester	A room for 20 gold
The Captain's Table	Barnaby	A room for 30 gold, the best chowder; mind the parrot
The Customs House	Ostler Wend, customs officer	Conversation only

A fish stall in the market, with crates, barrels and a drying rack.



The plaza before the gate, with soldiers in squads.

The people of the quay talk, and it is worth walking among them. A harbourmaster counts every ship that comes in, an old fisherman warns you not to fish off the end of the east pier ("something big takes the bait"), a ship's captain asks about the gull on your prow, and two guards at the gate swear they have not seen four people who look like you.

Oldhaven, the castle city *(level 55)*

Beyond the portcullis lies a grey stone castle city, **one hundred and fifty squares by one hundred and fifty**, ringed by a curtain wall with a tower at every corner. The king's road runs straight north from the gate to a great square before the castle, lined with soldiers, and the streets run east and west of it about three houses apart, with lanterns, flowers and a door on every

house. There are no monsters in the streets. Nothing is hostile here, and it is a good place to rest, shop and heal.

The districts

The city map names its quarters. At the south, the **Portcullis Gate** and the **King's Road** run north to the **Great Square** and the **Castle Ward**, with the **Castle of King Osric** beyond. In the west lie **Old Town** and **Chapel Close**, with **Lantern Street** in the north-west and the **Garrison Quarter** in the south-west. In the east are the **Market Square**, the **Fair Green**, the **East Road** and the **Smiths Quarter**. The **Land Gate** is in the north wall, at the top of the street east of the castle.

There are three other gates. The great Portcullis Gate in the south leads to the quay. The **Land Gate** in the north wall leads to the Pilgrim's Path. The **East Gate** at the end of the East Road is shut at first: it is held by Chancellor Vance's Ash Guard until the city's siege is won, and the gate-captain can tell you more.

Inside the Portcullis Gate, looking up the King's Road toward the castle.

Soldiers line the King's Road.

Shops, inns and halls

Almost every door in the city opens, and the people behind them have something to say.

DOOR	KEEPER	WHAT IT OFFERS
Oldhaven Arms	Bram, the smith	Swords, axes and plate
The Armourer's Yard	Ser Gawen	Helms, shields and mail
The Glover and Tailor	Fenwick	Gloves, jerkins and mail shirts
The Apothecary	Maud	Draughts for the body and tinctures for the mind
The Herbwife's Cottage	Old Ysolt	Herbs, salves and tinctures
The Scroll House	Osbern, the scribe	Scrolls of fire, frost and light
Pack and Lantern	Tilda	Torches, lanterns, rope, travelling food
The King's Bakery	Hild, the baker	Rolls, pies and cheese
The Cookshop	Pol, the cook	Stew, roast and pie, hot
The King's Rest	Wynn, innkeeper	A room for 30 gold; the soup is free
The Gilded Lance	Dame Hester	A room for 35 gold, breakfast on the house

The Chapel of Saint Brannoch	Sister Margery	A blessing before the court
The Garrison Hall	Sergeant Cade	Two hundred men and one stove
The Oldhaven Baths	the bath keeper	A grand bath house

The Great Square, with the castle gate, a fountain and a crowd.

The Market Square, with its well and stalls.

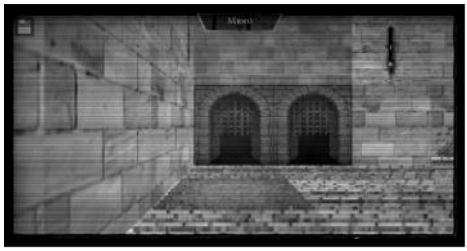
Some of the people of Oldhaven: King Osric, Captain Aldwyn of the Gate, a fishwife, a smith, a knight and a ship's captain.

The court of King Osric

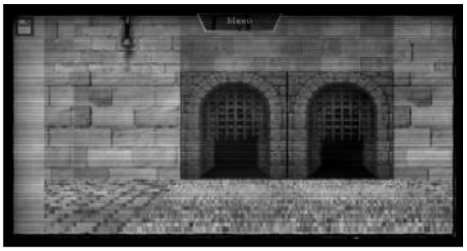
The castle holds the court, a long hall of grey stone with two thrones at the far end, banners in the royal blue and white, statues, braziers and a household of courtiers, soldiers and clerks. King Osric is an old man who once knew the names of his captains. Captain Aldwyn of the Gate will receive petitioners. At noon on the day you arrive, you are brought before the king, and what you carry will decide how the day goes.

The Fair Green, with a minstrel and an old traveller.

The court, with its thrones, banners and household.



The Land Gate, in the north wall.



The East Gate, shut while the Ash Guard hold it.

SPOILER

The court is where the master ledger is read and the warrant against your party is torn up. The names in the margin of the ledger lead to the Fair of Saint Brannoch, the siege and the Oakwood. Chapter 8 follows these.

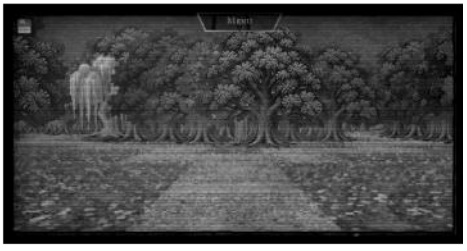
The Oakwood *(level 55)*

When the East Gate is open it leads into the **Oakwood**, an old oak forest with six glades joined by paths: the Gate Glade, the Woodwarden Camp, the Oakwrights' Yard, Bramwick's Glade, the Ashen Glade and the Great Oak.

Who lives here. Hale, captain of the woodwardens, with his woodwardens and the young Wren; Master Joss and his Oakwrights, who plant acorns and wait a hundred years; Bramwick, the hedge-wizard; and Ysolt, keeper of the Great Oak.

Monsters. Grey Wolves, and the Ash Guard, who keep a camp in the Ashen Glade.

The Gate Glade, the first clearing east of the city.



Under the old oaks of Bramwick's Glade.

The Pilgrim's Path *(level 55)*

For the overland journey home, take the **Land Gate** in the north wall of Oldhaven. A path begins there and runs north up the peninsula, with the sea on the left hand and an old forest on the right, then west over the mountains and south again, until it ends at a high cliff above Yarrim. It is **ninety-six kilometres** long, with a signpost at every kilometre, and it goes one way only. The cliff at the end can only be climbed down.

There is no wagon on this road, and no stage. The only way along it is on foot, and it is built to be walked slowly: flowers,

lamps, a few houses, inns and chapels, and a painted pilgrims' shrine on the left every two kilometres with food to take.

On the way

Thirteen buildings stand along the path, including three inns (the Last Lamp, the Cold Spring Inn and the Wayfarer's Rest) and three chapels (the Church of the Long Road, the Chapel of the Quiet and Saint Aldric's by the Sea). Thick woods run along the sea, with deer, rabbits, squirrels, bees, bears, slimes and wolves. A moss-covered stone cross beside the road marks every hidden cave and wild dungeon, and a bard, Tamsin Larkwhistle, sings in the woods each evening.

The twenty stones

A stone teleporter stands beside every fifth signpost, and another by the cliff above Yarrim: twenty in all. Wake them every one and an achievement comes up, with 1000 gold and the four pieces of the Abbot's armour, a mitre, a plate chasuble, cuffs and greaves with a set bonus that any class can wear.

The Pilgrim's Path at the Land Gate: sea on the left, oaks on the right.

A bank of flowers beside the road.

Saint Elen's Monastery

Halfway along the Path, a gate cut into the rock of the pass leads into green grounds: a church, a cloister with a fountain, a refectory, a scriptorium, a kitchen, a guest house, an infirmary, gardens, an orchard, hives and a bell. The monks are friendly. East of the grounds lies a quiet cemetery with a mausoleum, and below them a cellar and old crypts that have a ghost problem. A lane from the Path to the gate begins at the foot of a great mossy statue of Saint Elen.

HINT: *Carry a lantern for the mountain nights, and do not turn back at the cliff. Sister Margery in Oldhaven will bless you before you set out.*

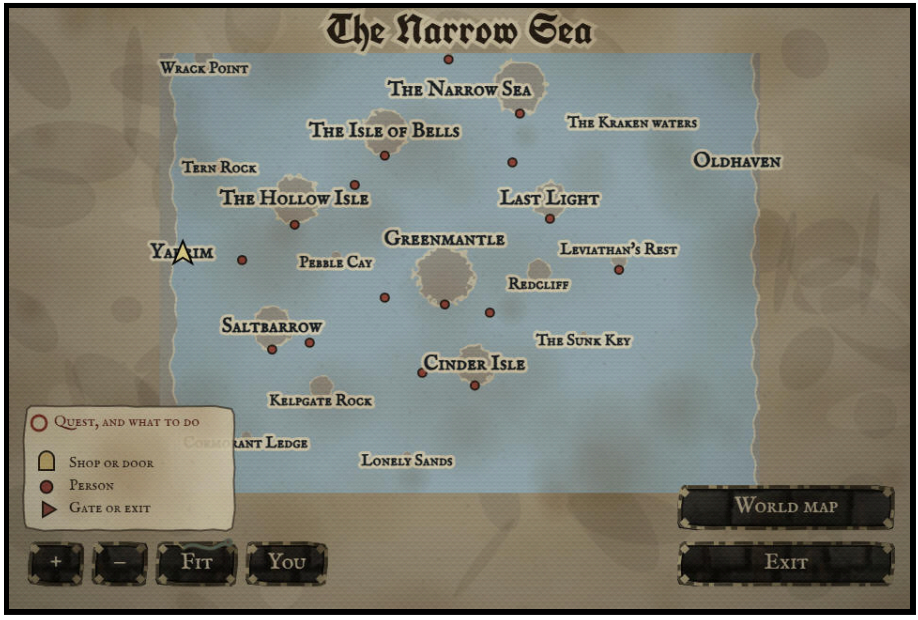
The castle of King Osric, as painted for the game.

A traveller's checklist

- A Diving Helm for every hero, or the Potion of the Gill.
- A weapon in hand for every hero, and a full pack of food and potions before the Kraken line.
- A lantern for the mountain nights on the Pilgrim's Path.
- Gold for the fish stalls, the inns and the armourers of Oldhaven.
- Patience: the sea is large, and a day goes by quickly on the water.

Atlas of the Seas and the East

The world map, the Narrow Sea.

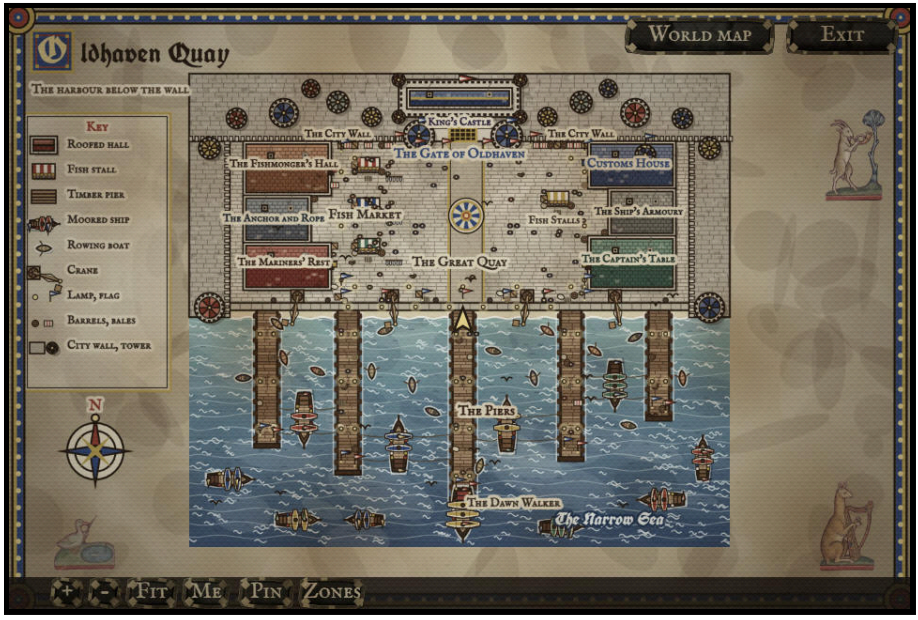


The Narrow Sea.

The Isle of Bells.

Cinder Isle.

Last Light.



Oldhaven Quay.

Oldhaven, the king's city.

CHAPTER 8

Hints, Secrets and Beasts

Everything that lives below the Abbey, and a good deal of what will help you live through it.

PART ONE: THE BESTIARY

Every creature in the game has a picture, a temper and a few habits. This part of the book sets them down in the order you are likely to meet them: the rats of the crypt, the wolves of the wood, the dead of the desert, the horrors of the Hollow Land and the things that live in the sea. Each entry gives its place, its health and the size of its blows, and anything the game lets a careful party use against it.

Treat the numbers as a guide, not a promise. They are the **base** values, as the creature would be at level 1. A creature standing in a place of a higher level is stronger, as the box on the next page explains. Most of the creatures that look like people (bandits, guards, nomads, skeletons in armour and the like) always carry gold, so a fallen foe is worth a look.

Names printed in bold in the entries are the named foes and the great creatures. They are never made weaker than their place, and the greatest of them stand several levels above it.

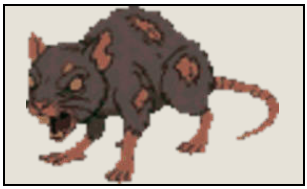
How strong is a creature?

Take the base health and multiply it by **1 + 0.45 × (level − 1)**. Take the base blow and multiply it by **1 + 0.3 × (level − 1)**. A level 20 Black Rat therefore has 50 × 9.55 = 478 health. A level 1 rat has 50.

In the fixed world (the default) a creature stands at the level of the place it lives in, but not all of them do. About two in five are at the place's level, about a third are one to three levels lower, and about a quarter are four to seven lower, so every fight is a mix of tough ones and easy ones. Named foes and great creatures are never lowered. The great creatures stand above the place: the entry says by how many. The crypts below the Abbey are the exception, climbing from level 1 at the stair to level 3 by the Rat King.

The Gameplay page of the menu can change all this: see **the Level Ladder** at the back of this chapter.

THE CRYPTS, THE WOODS AND THE ROAD



Black Rat

Crypts under the Abbey; the Ironhill mines

Health 50 **Blow** 2 to 4

Small and quick to bite. A bite brings fever about one time in eight.

Cave Bat

Crypts and mines

Health 40 **Blow** 1 to 3

Flies, and moves faster than most. A bite now and then brings fever.

Skeleton

Crypts, mines, old ruined houses

Health 80 **Blow** 3 to 6

Rattles when it wakes. Its blows can bring grave rot. A Paladin's Smite does double damage to it.

Grey Wolf

Woods and moors

Health 36 **Blow** 2 to 3

Fast. About one hit in five leaves a hero bleeding. Hild and Captain Rowan pay a bounty on wolves.

Bandit

Woods and roads

Health 44 **Blow** 2 to 4

Carries gold. Its blade leaves a bleeding wound about one time in ten. Bandit Archers shoot from two squares away.

Brown Bear

Bear dens in Gandrick's Wood and the Oakwood

Health 64 **Blow** 4 to 7

Hits harder than any wolf. Two live in each bear den.

Green Slime

Overgrown ruins in the woods

Health 30 **Blow** 1 to 3

About one ruin in ten has been taken over by four of them. Weak, but they come in a crowd.

Spectre

The Golden Crypt, the Burial Ground, below the Abbey

Health 62 **Blow** 3 to 5

A hit may haunt a hero (three times in ten) or leave one shaken.

The named foes of the north

The Rat King

Deepest crypt below the Abbey, level 3

Health 224 **Blow** 5 to 8

Never made weaker than its place. Its bite can bring fever (one hit in eight) and leave a hero shaken.

Gandrick

Gandrick's Cave, level 13

Health 160 **Blow** 5 to 8

A hit can curse the whole party (one in five) or leave a hero shaken. A church lifts a curse.

Mayor Halbrecht

Castle Dungeons, Ironhill, level 28

Health 185 **Blow** 5 to 7

The jailer's master. Has guards with him, so deal with them first.

The Wraith

The Golden Crypt

Health 90 **Blow** 6 to 9

Haunts and shakes. When it falls to mist, the seal on the tomb chest breaks.

The Mine Overseer

Deepest room of the Ironhill mines, level 25

Health 210 **Blow** 5 to 8

Dead, and still working. He hits hard: rest first and open the last door with a full party.

THE DESERT AND THE DEAD

The deserts are rated level 36 on the Sand Road, 39 at the Tomb of Sut, 41 in the Red Dunes and 45 in the other dune seas. The air in a tomb is heavy with dust and can give the party tomb lung. The stings of scorpions and cobras leave a hero venom-stung, which an antidote from a potion seller or a healer will cure.

Giant Scorpion

Everywhere in the dunes

Health 40 **Blow** 3 to 6

A sting leaves a hero venom-stung about one time in three.

Cobra

Tombs and dunes

Health 30 **Blow** 3 to 5

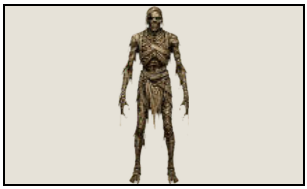
Stings leave a hero venom-stung about two times in five.

Carrion Vulture

Dunes and the Sand Road

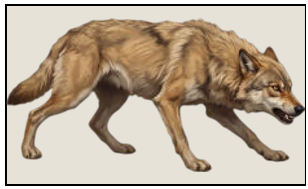
Health 34 **Blow** 3 to 5

Flies and is fast. Its claws can leave a hero bleeding.



Mummy
Tombs and under the mounds
Health 45 **Blow** 3 to 5
One hit in ten can curse the whole party. A church lifts a curse.

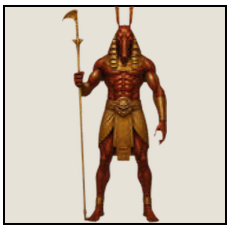
Desert Skeleton
Tombs and mounds
Health 48 **Blow** 3 to 5
The dune cousin of the crypt skeleton: 48 health against 80.



Desert Wolf
The dunes
Health 36 **Blow** 2 to 4
Quick. Like all wolves it may leave a hero bleeding, and now and then with fleas.

The great creatures are never lowered to the party. A party that is too weak should go and grow, and come back.

THE GREAT CREATURES OF THE DESERT



Sut, Lord of the Red Desert
Throne room of the Tomb of Sut
Health 110 **Blow** 4 to 7
Shoots bolts of red fire from three squares. When he falls, a door appears in the north wall.

Cinderback, the Fire Lizard
South of the Violet Erg
Health 70 **Blow** 3 to 5
Three levels above the place. Breathes fire from three squares. Always drops 400 gold, and something magic.

The Wandering Cyclops
Patrols the White Dunes
Health 90 **Blow** 3 to 5
Walks a beat, so it can be watched and avoided. Up to eight levels above the place in the fixed world. Drops 500 gold.

The Undying Pharaoh
Golden Pyramid, in the Golden Erg
Health 100 **Blow** 4 to 6
Walks the maze many levels above the party. Warns you when he is near, hunts you, and can warp across it. His servants slow you.

BELOW THE ABBEY: THE HOLLOW LAND

Beyond the sealed door lie four floors of the Hollow Abbey and the Hollow Abbot, who keeps the stair down. Past him is the Hollow Land and the great Orange Spire, twenty floors of it, rated from level 58 to level 65. Every floor has a mystery room (a riddle, a bridge, a pit, a chasm and other tests), and some walls are hidden doors that open when you walk into them. On a riddle floor the wizard's right answer heals the party and pays XP and gold.

The Spire's own people are the Armoured Goblin, the Cave Slime and the Orc Brute, and from the third floor one or two new horrors join them every second floor, until the Flesh Abomination on the nineteenth. A Hollow Land creature stands one level

above its place unless the entry says otherwise.

Armoured Goblin
The Orange Spire, from floor 1
Health 120 **Blow** 5 to 9
The common soldier of the Spire. One level above its place.

Cave Slime
The Orange Spire
Health 180 **Blow** 4 to 7
No level above its place, but it fills the passages. 180 health.

Orc Brute
The Orange Spire
Health 320 **Blow** 9 to 14
Two levels above its place and by far the hardest of the early three.

The sixteen horrors, and the floor each first appears on

Mad Jester
floor 3
150 health, blow 5 to 8

Chest Mimic
floor 5
280 health, blow 7 to 13

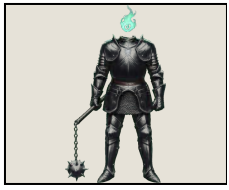
Raving Madman
floor 5
120 health, blow 4 to 11

Wight
floor 7
240 health, blow 7 to 12

Murdered Peasant
floor 7
90 health, blow 3 to 6

The Butcher
floor 9
520 health, blow 10 to 17

Phantom
floor 9
200 health, blow 6 to 10



Headless Knight
floor 11
460 health, blow 11 to 17

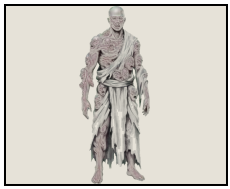
Banshee
floor 11
210 health, blow 5 to 9

Vampire
floor 13
400 health, blow 8 to 14

Demented Duke
floor 13
340 health, blow 7 to 13

Werewolf
floor 15
440 health, blow 9 to 15

Skeleton Warlord
floor 15
620 health, blow 12 to 19



Shape Shifter
floor 17
380 health, blow 8 to 14

Writhing Choir
floor 17
520 health, blow 7 to 12

Flesh Abomination
floor 19
950 health, blow 12 to 20

❦ **Mimic.** Looks like an old chest and keeps still until someone stands beside it.

❦ **Shape Shifter.** Passes for a pale stranger until the party is within two squares.

❦ **Vampire.** Each bite heals it a little (a twentieth of its health). Burst it down.

❦ **Flesh Abomination.** Knits itself back together as you fight. Do not let the fight drag.

❦ **Banshee.** Wails from three squares away, and can leave a hero shaken.

❦ **Werewolf, Vampire, Butcher.** Their blows often leave bleeding wounds.

The four rulers, the trap horrors and the others

Four twisted dead rulers wait in the last hall of floors 4, 9, 14 and 19, each three levels above their place. Each drops a relic far stronger than anything in a shop (a weapon rated for level 28), and only once: Crownbreaker, Veilpiercer, The Duke's Gavel and the Hollow Scepter.

The Gaunt King
floor 4. 700 health, blow 15 to 24.
Crownbreaker, a sword (triple damage on a foe under 35 per cent health; bosses take 50 per cent more).

The Smiling Queen
floor 9. 620 health, blow 13 to 22.
Veilpiercer, a bow (shoots six squares; arrows pass through to the foe behind).

The Poison Duke
floor 14. 820 health, blow 14 to 23.
The Duke's Gavel, a mace (stuns three hits in ten).

The Hollow Child-King
floor 19. 660 health, blow 13 to 23.
The Hollow Scepter, a staff (+35 to spells; bosses take 30 per cent more).

The trap rooms. On floors 3, 6, 9, 12, 15 and 18 one room shuts behind the party. The doors turn to wall, the lights flicker and die, a laugh starts, and a horror rises: the Hideous Phantom, the Laughing Fool, the Red Butcher, the Weeping Matron, the Pale Lord and the Singing Horror. Each is three levels above its place. Kill it and the walls and doors return. The Pale Lord heals as he bites.

The Screaming Witch. Stands in a room of her own on some floors, blasts from four squares and strobes the lights, which stop when she dies. **The Bogeyman** waits behind the party whenever it looks into a mirror, is always exactly the party's own level, and drops the Bogeyman Mask, a helm. **The Hollow Abbot** keeps the stair down from the Hollow Abbey: 2600 base health, blows of 13 to 21, and four levels

above the party. **Clawing Hands** tear from the walls and rake anyone beside them.

THE NARROW SEA, ABOVE AND BELOW

The Kraken. *1500 base health, blows of 9 to 14, and the code places it twenty levels above the party. It stands between the two coasts, and the harbour boom at Oldhaven will not lift until it is dead.*

Nothing a party carries can hurt the Kraken. Only the four **Kraken guns**, the Ember, Verdigris, Silver and Beacon Harpoons, can, and every hero needs one in hand. Each does between 3000 and 4400 damage to the Kraken and 1 to 3 to anything else. When the Kraken is dead the four harpoons crumble away. The hint pages that follow tell you where each one lies.

Lord Corvane (340 base health) is fought at sea with his bandits beside him, and Chancellor Vance (300) in the court at Oldhaven with four Royal Guards. The Cinder Guardian (260) walks the slopes of Cinder Isle among the crystals, two levels above its place. Sea Serpents (240) take a boat a month, and Tamsin Kell pays for five of them.

Lord Corvane

The Narrow Sea; three levels above

Health 340 **Blow** 6 to 10

The pirate lord of the sea, met with his bandits beside him.

Chancellor Vance

The court at Oldhaven; three levels above

Health 300 **Blow** 6 to 9

The chancellor, fought in the court with Royal Guards at his side.

The Cinder Guardian

Cinder Isle; two levels above

Health 260 **Blow** 6 to 9

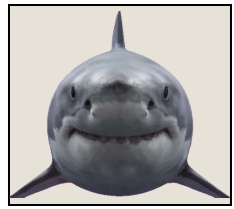
Destroy it and bring Ketra three cinder crystals.

Under the water

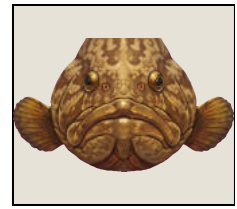
Each of the four islands has an underwater dungeon, and every hero needs a Diving Helm to enter it. The ordinary creatures there are the Reef Shark (90 health), Barracuda (60), Reef Crab (70), Octopus (110), Glow Jelly (50), Moray Eel (100) and Spiny Puffer (55). Each dungeon ends with a great creature guarding a great chest.

The Reef Warden
Under Saltbarrow; Maeve's chest
420 health, blow 7 to 10

The Abbey Eel
Isle of Bells; the lost clapper
460 health, blow 7 to 11



The Vent Tyrant
Cinder Isle; the Heart of the Vent
520 health, blow 8 to 12



Old Gulper
Last Light; the great lens
600 health, blow 8 to 13

THE WANDERING MONSTERS

Fifteen strange creatures turn up on a level without warning, about one visit in six to a suitable place. They have no nests and no graves. Each one is written into the **Wandering Monsters** page (Menu, More) the first time you meet it, with its picture, its legend and its health, and the page has an **About them** button with the old people's account of where they come from.

Nine of them have a favour to ask and so start a quest: bring them what they want and they pay in gold, experience and a keepsake. Five fight, and each of those carries magic gear and stands one level above the party. And one, the Messenger of Death, is the rarest and the worst.

The Wandering Monsters page, with Sir Wick the Candle Knight selected. Names show as question marks until you have met them.

Those who ask a favour

The Ferryman of Dust
A wanderer who asks a favour
Health 60
Wants **two torches** to mark the banks of a river that is gone. Gives a ring.

Mother Mossback
A wanderer who asks a favour
Health 140
Wants **four apples** for the tree on her back. Gives two potions.

Aunt Marrow
A wanderer who asks a favour
Health 70
Wants **one honeycomb** for the baby, and asks you not to look in the pram. Gives a ring.

Grubb the Toll Troll
A wanderer who asks a favour
Health 120
Wants **sixty gold** to let you pass, and pays you a helm for it.

The Hollow Bride
A wanderer who asks a favour
Health 65
Wants **three wildflowers** so that she is not unprepared. Gives a ring.

Brother Rattlebones
A wanderer who asks a favour
Health 70
Is not allowed to strike a blow, so asks you to **lay six creatures to rest**. Gives a scroll of Light.

The Salt Wife
A wanderer who asks a favour
Health 60
Wants **three cups of cool water**. Gives two flasks of holy water.

Thistlewick the Alchemist
A wanderer who asks a favour
Health 50
Wants **three moor herbs** for his twelfth potion. Gives two potions and a sleep tea.

The Unfinished Man
A wanderer who asks a favour
Health 60
Wants **three dates** to paint his missing half. Gives a ring.

HINT: *These favours pay the most experience for the least work in the game, 2400 to 3200 each. If you walk away, the creature stays where you met it, and the quest log says so. Health is shown at level 1.*

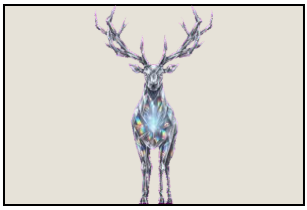
Those who fight

Sir Wick, the Candle Knight

One level above the party; drops magic gear

Health 75 **Blow** 4 to 7

Lost his head in a duel he won. Still cannot understand why nobody will duel him.



The Glass Stag

One level above the party; fast

Health 55 **Blow** 4 to 7

A stag of living crystal. Shy, fast and sharp. Leaves glittering shards where it dies.

The Weather Hound

One level above the party; fast, ranged

Health 60 **Blow** 5 to 7

Brings the storm with it and shoots lightning from three squares away.

The Many-Eyed Ox

One level above the party

Health 150 **Blow** 5 to 8

The herd-keeper of a vanished god. It never blinks and never forgets a face.

The Crown Crab

One level above the party; 60 to 160 gold

Health 110 **Blow** 5 to 7

Claims the whole shore and every wreck on it, and thinks it is the king.

The Messenger of Death

Five levels above the party. Rare: one level in twenty-five

Health 70 **Blow** 5 to 8

Hides the five letters of his name on the walls. See the hard fights, later in this chapter.

PART TWO: THE HINT GUIDE

The old hint books of the cartridge days were written in three kinds of ink. This one follows the habit. Every entry begins with a **nudge**, a line of plain advice that spoils nothing. If the nudge is not enough, the **stronger hint** in the first dashed box points at the place or the person. The **answer** in the second box tells you straight out.

Read only as far as you need. Every hint in this book was checked against the game as it is played, and none of them is a guess. Those boxes marked SPOILER give away the story as well as the solution, so a first-time player may choose to read the nudges only.

The game has a hint of its own too. In the quest log (J) every quest that is more than a plain fetch or a kill count has a **Hint** button, and tapping a quest circles its place on the map. A quest ready to hand in always says who to hand it to. Hints you press are counted on the Stats page.

GENERAL ADVICE FOR NEW PLAYERS

Rest and food

Rest with R. It takes eight hours, heals every hero to full and refills mana or stamina, and a fallen hero rises with half health. You cannot rest while enemies are close. Camp is also where the party cooks, sharpens, tends the sick and tells stories, one choice for each hero each day.

Eat. Each hero's hunger bar falls by about a quarter in six hours, and the game tells you when a hero drops below 25. A hero at zero loses a point of health every twenty minutes, and a starving hero only heals to half when the party rests. Resting at an **inn** heals the whole party fully even if they are hungry, and lifts hunger to at least 70. Two food items cooked at camp make a stew: Well Fed, +2 strength for a day.

Trading

A shop pays **40 per cent** of an item's price. Each town keeps its own opinion of the party, from minus 100 to plus 100: honest quests raise it, warnings from the watch and the shady jobs of each town's fixer lower it. A liked party pays up to 22 per cent less, a hated one pays more, and a despised one is refused. Persuasion takes 1 per cent off per level, and Appraisal adds 1.5 per cent to what you sell for.

Saving

The game saves itself (Autosave) and keeps the previous two runs. You also have a quick save on F5 and three slots of your own in the Save and Load page of the menu. Save before a door you have a feeling about.

Potions, powers and weight

H or P drinks the frequent-use potion. In the bag you can drag two more potions on to the backup slots, and when the first runs out the next steps up in its place. X uses the chosen hero's special attack or spell. Powers cost stamina or mana, and a rest refills both.

Every item has a **weight**. The party can carry 20 kilograms plus 1.6 for every point of the heroes' combined strength, and has 36 pack slots plus one for every two points of strength. Over the limit it **moves at half speed and fights worse**, and cannot lift anything more from the floor, a chest or a shop. A Ring of the Pack Mule (eight slots, 15 kg), a Ring of the Porter (20 kg), a Ring of the Great Haul (16 slots, 30 kg), a donkey (12 slots, 30 kg) or a llama (10 slots, 20 kg) all help.

Which hero does what

Every hero chooses one of twelve classes when the party is made. How much the party can carry depends on the heroes' strength added together, so the strong classes (Warrior, Barbarian, Paladin, Priest, Monk and Goat) help everyone. Each class has one special attack, used with X.

CLASS	SPECIAL	WHAT IT DOES
Warrior	Power Strike, 4	Double weapon damage plus 2.
Barbarian	Rage Blow, 5	Two and a half times weapon damage. Most health in the game.
Paladin	Smite, 4	Weapon damage plus 4, doubled against skeletons.
Ranger	Aimed Shot, 3	Never misses, double damage, from three squares. Spots hidden caves and ruins from much further away.
Archer	Volley, 4	Two arrows that never miss, up to four squares.
Thief	Twin Stab, 3	Two attacks that never miss. A natural at lockpicking.
Assassin	Backstab, 3	Triple damage on a foe that has not noticed you.
Mage, Sorcerer	Spell	Casts the chosen spell; the Sorcerer adds 2 and has more mana.
Priest	Heal, 4	Heals the most wounded ally for 8 to 12, and more with each level.
Monk	Palm Strike, 3	Double damage, even unarmed.
Goat	Headbutt, 3	5 to 10 damage and the foe is dazed for a turn.

HINT: *Shopkeepers in Khemetra's Merchants' Quarter and in Ironhill sell five spells to every class, at levels 10, 20, 30, 40 and 50 for 500, 1000, 1500, 2000 and 2500 gold. A Warrior's first is Intimidating Shout (every foe within three squares runs for four rounds). The second is Shield Wall (+5 armour for eight rounds for the whole party). Learn them before the hard fights.*

Keys worth knowing

W A S D move, Q E turn, Space attack, 1 to 4 choose a hero, I bag, J quests, M map, F afflictions, L journal, T teleport stones, U collection, Z wait a turn, G dig with a shovel, N catch a butterfly, ? every shortcut.

HINT: *Press F when a hero looks unwell. Every affliction has a page in the menu (Menu, Afflictions) that says how it is caught and how it is cured. Herbal remedies cure most of them for much less than a church asks.*

AFFLICTION	CAUGHT FROM	CURE
Fever	Rats, bats, foul water	Rest three times, or a salve
Grave Rot	Skeletons, damp crypts	A cleansing salve or a healer. Rest does not help.
Venom-stung	Scorpions and cobras	An antidote, or a healer
Haunted	Ghosts and spectres	A church, or holy water
Cursed	Tombs, mummies, Gandrick	A church or temple
Shaken	Ghosts, dark houses, great foes	Rest twice, or a church
Tomb Dust	The air of sealed tombs	A long soak in a bathhouse

A gold ! over a head means a quest to give: Brannoch the smith, who wants iron ore.

Wynn the herbalist in Ironhill. A green ? means someone you can hand a finished quest to.

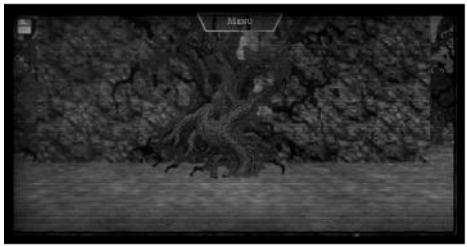
HIDDEN CAVES, WILD DUNGEONS AND THE GREEN CROSSES

Behind the trees of the outdoor lands are caves and old overgrown ruins that no road leads to. Their doors are choked with dead, twisted trees, and a small **?** appears on the map when the party has looked towards one. The mark goes when you have been inside. Walk slowly and keep your eyes open: a Ranger in the party sees them from much further off, and so do a Scout and the herb trades (Healer, Alchemist).

> ***Watch your minimap for a ?***
>
> Hidden caves and wild dungeons lie off the roads, behind the trees. When your party looks towards one, a **?** appears at the edge of the minimap and on the area maps. Follow the mark. It goes away once you have been inside.

Dead trees are the game's burnable ones. Tap one with a **torch** in the bag and it burns for five seconds, then it is ash you can walk through. A torch is used up. A **lantern** does the same and is kept. Two people in the towns will tell you more: a

woodsman in Thornwick and a scout in Ironhill talk about the hidden places at length.



A rock face and the dead trees that choke its door, in the Thornwood.

Tap the tree with a torch or a lantern: it burns, and the way opens.

Finding the hidden places

NUDGE: *Walk straight into the woods from the roadside now and then, and look for a few dead, twisted trees standing in the open in front of bare rock.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Bring a torch or a lantern. On the Pilgrim's Path, look beside the road for old stone crosses green with moss, and turn east at one.

The answer. A mossy cross stands beside the road on the same row as the entrance to a cave or a wild dungeon. Turn east at the cross and walk straight on, and you will arrive. (An old soldier in Oldhaven will tell you as much.) Elsewhere on the Path only about three entrances in ten are hidden behind thickets; the rest stand in plain sight.

The old stone cross of the roadside. In the game it is green with moss.

The Witch's Hollow, a cave in the Thornwood. The cave witch has a quest.

The caves of the old forests

There are seven caves in the older lands, each with its own name: **The Witch's Hollow** in the Thornwood, **The Bear Den** in Gandrick's Wood, **The Hunted Man's Hole** on the Ironhill Road, **The Moor Wolves' Cave** on Ironhill Moor, **The Exile's Cave** in the Greyfang Pass, **The Greendale Hoard** and **The Oakwood Bear Cave**. Three have quests, and they are in the quest tables below.

The caves of the Pilgrim's Path

Twenty small, dark caves are hidden along the Path, one in nearly every stretch. They are named: The Wolf Hollow, The Root Cellar, The Outcast's Den, The Glittering Crack, The Fugitive's Cave, The Old Smuggler's Hole, The Grey Den, The Gem Crack, The Hermit's Burrow, The Runaway's Cave, The Buried Hoard, The Howling Cave, The Crystal Hollow, The Ragged Man's Cave, The Moss Chest Cave, The Hunted Man's Cave, The Glimmer Pocket, The Wolf Mother's Den, The Beggar's Cave and The Forgotten Strongbox. Some hold wolves, some treasure or gems, some an outcast. Three hold a runaway who has a quest.

The overgrown ruins

Every outdoor map has from one to four old ruins, and the Pilgrim's Path has one or two in each stretch: vine-grown stone in different colours, with trees and flowers growing inside, such as The Ivy Chapel, The Mossy Vault and The Tangled Crypt. About seven in ten are empty and dark. About one in six holds a little treasure, and about one in ten has been taken by slimes. All are rich in herbs.

Inside, the way out is a bright arch of daylight behind you, and the exit is always marked on the map. Caves and ruins also have wild food on the floor, such as chanterelles, wild figs and even truffles, and now and then a gem. About four chests in ten hold one piece of armour, and now and then a powerful one.

QUEST HINTS, PLACE BY PLACE

The big quests of each place come first, each in three levels. The long lists of small errands follow in tables.

Thornwick and the Thornwood

Kill Gandrick (Mayor Corbin)

NUDGE: *Leave Thornwick by the east gate. The danger comes from the woods beyond.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Follow the trail through Gandrick's Wood, fighting the wolves and bandits on the way. His cave is at the far end of the wood.

The answer. His cave is at the far east end of Gandrick's Wood. Kill him: he can curse a hero and shake the party, so a church can lift what he leaves. Tap the quest in the log to see it on the map.

The Lost Goats (Old Maud)

NUDGE: *Goats do not hide in the wild. Look close to home.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. They are in the lanes and yards of Thornwick itself.

The answer. Five goats are loose in the town. Walk right up to one, or tap it, to find it. Then tell Maud.

The Empty House (Nim)

NUDGE: *Haunted houses are dark. Prepare for that.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. The house is on the north side of the main street in Thornwick.

The answer. Go in with a torch and kill the three ghosts inside. The house is too quiet and can leave the party shaken.

Ironhill and the Moor

Farmer Eadric on Ironhill Moor, with a wolf nearby. The parcel for Eadric goes first, then back to Dorn.

Hesta of Ironhill. Her husband died in the mines. His pick lies somewhere in the tunnels.

Hesta's Pick

NUDGE: *Look in the mines. The tunnels are wide and a pick is small.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. It lies on the floor in the south-west part of the mines, in the lower left quarter of the map.

The answer. The mines are east of Ironhill castle. The pick lies on the floor in the lower left quarter of the mines. Twelve pieces of iron ore lie about the mines too, and Brannoch only needs six: take them for him on the same trip.

The Overseer (Foreman Bryn)

NUDGE: *The Overseer waits at the very end of the mines. Do not go in hungry.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. He is in the deepest room, far to the south-east, behind a last door.

The answer. Mine Overseer: 210 base health, level 25, hits hard. Rest and heal before you open the last door. He is a named foe and is never made weaker than his place.

Out of the Dungeons

NUDGE: *You cannot walk out. But you may not have to fight everything.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. The jailer will take a bribe. The guards beyond will not.

The answer. Bribe the jailer, fight your way out past the guards and deal with Halbrecht in the castle dungeons (his base health is 185).

Wynn's herbs and Eadric's parcel

NUDGE: *One errand is out on the moor, the other too.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Moor herbs grow on the moor, east of town; Eadric lives on the moor. Pip, the lost boy, is on the moor too.

The answer. Pick six moor herbs from the ground for Wynn. Take Dorn's parcel to Farmer Eadric first, then tell Dorn. Find Pip near the wolves and tell him to go home.

The fixers, and a word about honour

Each of the four old towns has a fixer who offers two shady jobs for good gold: **Sly Dunstan** in Thornwick, **One-Eyed Karl** in Ironhill, **Whisper Mirelle** in Anaea and **Khafre the Fixer** in Khemetra. One asks you to lean on a merchant ("A Quiet Word"), the other to sell stolen goods to a shopkeeper who asks no questions ("No Questions Asked"). Each pays 100 to 155 gold, and each lowers the town's opinion of the party. The prices of every shop in that town follow.

Greendale, Anaea and the Road to Khemetra

The Colours of Anaea (Hale)

NUDGE: *Old records mention a cellar. The town is a clean, white one: the door you want is the shabby one.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Look for a dilapidated door on the south side of the main street.

The answer. It is near the middle of the town, on the south side of the main street, and leads to the sealed cellar.

Counsel in Scoria (Mayor Marigold)

NUDGE: *Only a wizard can speak for you to the king. He lives far off.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Take the east gate of Anaea and follow the road.

The answer. Follow the road north into the desert to Khemetra. Ishkander the wizard is the one to find there.

Khemetra and the Deserts

The Stolen Seal (Hotep-Ra, grand vizier)

NUDGE: *The thieves keep to the old, ruined part of the city.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. The Old Quarter is in the north-west of Khemetra. Look for a boarded house.

The answer. The seal is in a chest in the Boarded House in the Old Quarter. The door is circled on the map.

Neferet's seven relics

NUDGE: *Neferet the cartographer sends you to little dungeons under the mounds of the dunes, one at a time.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Each is in a named dungeon in a different desert. Tap the quest to see where.

The answer. The Compass of Dawn: Catacomb of Whispering Sands (Sand Road, north-east of Anaea). Sphinx Scroll Case: Shrine of the Sleeping Sphinx (Red Dunes). Copper Serpent Amulet: Shrine of the Copper Serpent (Blue Dunes). Astrolabe: Undercroft of the Sand Mother (Golden Erg). Jade Scarab: Barrow of the Pale Cartographer (Violet Erg). Lens of the Twin Suns: Sepulchre of the Twin Suns (White Dunes). Ankh Key: Barrow of the Last Oasis (Flatlands).

The Road to the Narrow Sea (Captain Menkaure)

NUDGE: *A tunnel runs to the sea. It does not start in the city.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. The tunnel begins in the east of the Violet Erg.

The answer. Find the tunnel in the east of the Violet Erg, follow it to the Narrow Sea and see the sea. Once the Sea Gate in Khemetra's east wall is open (the vizier's key, in the next hint), you can walk straight through it to Yarrim.

Yarrim and the Narrow Sea

The Warden's Key (Hotep-Ra)

NUDGE: *The old gate warden's key lies in a chest, in a wet and dark place under the city.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. The cisterns beneath the Potters Market, in north-west Khemetra. Take a lantern.

The answer. The key is in an old bronze chest in the cisterns under the Potters Market. The hatch opens once the vizier has named it. Take the key back to Hotep-Ra. Then kill eight skeletons in the tunnel beyond the Sea Gate for Menkaure.

Washed Ashore (Tamsin Kell)

NUDGE: *The sea gives things back to the beach.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Walk the beach of Yarrim, north and south of the pier.

The answer. Four crates lie in the sand along the beach. Tell Tamsin Kell when you have all four. For her second job, kill six rats in the Net Loft, east of the harbourmaster's office.

The Lamp of Yarrim (Orsa)

NUDGE: *The lighthouse has no fuel for its great lamp. Think what lights things.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Three torches. Wen's Trading Post in Yarrim sells them, and so do Khemetra's general stores.

The answer. Bring Orsa three torches at the Yarrim Light. Orsa pays 245 gold and a potion, and you will want that lamp when you run the reef at night with a black ship on your tail.

Four islands, three pages (aboard the Dawn Walker)

NUDGE: *Three people hold a page of the ledger, and each wants something done first. A fourth, Sable Maeve, wants her island cleared.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Saltbarrow (Sable Maeve), the Isle of Bells (Brother Aldous), Cinder Isle (Ketra) and Last Light (Isolde).

The answer. Saltbarrow: kill ten of Corvane's marines, camped along the north and east shore, and tell Sable Maeve. Isle of Bells: ring each of the three bells in the drowned abbey, then fight what wakes; Brother Aldous waits at the altar. Cinder Isle: take three cinder crystals from the slopes and destroy the Cinder Guardian that walks them. Last Light: fetch the third page from Isolde's altar at the top, and be ready for Corvane's ship.

The Kraken Guns

The Kraken Guns (Menkaure)

NUDGE: *The Kraken cannot be hurt by anything you now carry. Four people each know of a gun.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Ketra, Sable Maeve, Brother Aldous and Isolde each know where one lies. Every hero needs one in hand.

The answer. The **Ember Harpoon** lies on an altar in the red cliffs of Redcliff, a rock island in the east of the Narrow Sea. The **Verdigris Harpoon** is in the bow of the grounded flagship on Kelpgate Rock, south-west. The **Silver Harpoon** is buried inside the ring of standing stones on the Hollow Isle, in the west. The **Beacon Harpoon** is in the lamp-ship wreck under Last Light: dive from Last Light, a Diving Helm on every hero. The Kraken then lies in the deep water between the two coasts. When it dies the harpoons crumble.

Under the islands

NUDGE: *The islands hide dungeons below the waves.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Tam Salvor on the pier at Yarrim sells a Diving Helm. Every hero needs one.

The answer. Dive from the red-and-white buoy at each island: Saltbarrow (the Reef Warden and Maeve's chest), the Isle of Bells (the Abbey Eel and the bell's clapper), Cinder Isle (the Vent Tyrant and the Heart of the Vent; stand in a vent to breathe freely) and Last Light (Old Gulper and the great lens).

The Singing Shell (Brother Aldous)

NUDGE: *The shell is in four pieces, each under a different island.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Dive each of the four underwater dungeons. The piece is in a pearl-white clam in a far corner of the reef.

The answer. Bring all four pieces to Brother Aldous and he makes the shell whole. You need a Diving Helm each. The reward includes a nautilus helm.

Oldhaven, the Oakwood and the Pilgrim's Path

The Six Names (Captain Aldwyn)

NUDGE: *The ledger names six small people who took favours. They keep stalls on the fair green.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Take the east road from the middle of Oldhaven to the fair green. Talk to each: the weigher, the bellringer, the baker, the fool, the tutor and the quiet sister.

The answer. Hob Tally wants bread, cheese and a herring. Ewan Marsh wants two torches and a lantern. Perrin wants a salve and an antidote. Pip Jangle wants three apples. Master Quill wants a Frost scroll and a Light scroll. Sister Ilse wants two flasks of holy water. Each pays one of the six small device pieces that Captain Aldwyn's clockmaker will later fit together as the Orrery of Hours.

Oak Crown (Ysolt)

NUDGE: *Honest answers matter more than clever ones at the Great Oak.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Ysolt keeps the Great Oak in the south-east glade of the Oakwood. She asks three questions. Answer them honestly.

The answer. Answer all three of Ysolt's questions honestly, then bring Wren to the Great Oak and ask Ysolt to crown her. Then tell Captain Aldwyn.

Meet the Brothers, and the Abbot's ring

NUDGE: *Saint Elen's Monastery sits in a cliff gate on the Pilgrim's Path, halfway up.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Walk the Path to its halfway point in the mountains. A gate cut into the cliff on the east side leads to the monastery. Abbot Anselm is in front of the church.

The answer. The ring is in a chest in the old crypts, one floor below the cellars. The hatch to the cellars is in the herb garden. Kill six ghosts there for Brother Cellarer, then take the ring to the Abbot.

Below the Abbey

The Sealed Door and the Hollow Abbot

NUDGE: *The door is where your journey began.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Go down into the crypts below the Abbey, to the old stair where the game began. A royal cutter takes the party home to the Thornwood first. Four floors lead down.

The answer. Six pieces (cog, pin, spring, bell, lens and dial) make the Orrery of Hours, which opens the sealed door. Beyond it four floors lead to the Hollow Abbey and Brother Sevrin. The Hollow Abbot is in the great room at the bottom, and the stair onward is under his seat. Kill him: he has 2600 base health and stands four levels above the party.

Vance's Letters and the Question at the Top

NUDGE: *Three letters are hidden in the Orange Spire, and the wizard at the top will ask you three questions.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. Look on levels 5, 10 and 15 for a wall of the wrong colour with a wooden lever, and a bookshelf with a red book. Answer the wizard with good will.

The answer. Read all three letters. Then climb the twenty floors to the wizard in the spire and answer his three questions with good will. Greed drops the party down two levels. (On floors with a riddle, the wizard's right answer heals the party and pays experience and gold.)

THE SMALL ERRANDS

Quests that are only a fetch, a kill count or a short walk. All of them were read from the game.

WHERE	WHO	WHAT THEY WANT
Thornwick	Bram	8 pieces of firewood, from the ground in the Thornwood.
Thornwick	Hild, Rolf, Edda	6 wolves; 5 bandits or archers; 8 rats or bats.
Thornwick	Tam, Mabel, Hob, Will, Wat	3 apples; 2 cheese; 2 ale; 3 salt herring; 1 bread.
Ironhill	Brannoch	6 iron ore, from the floor of the mines. Pays a blade that never rusts.
Ironhill	Captain Rowan, Mara, Odo	8 wolves, 6 bandits or archers on the moor; 6 rats or bats; 6 ghosts in the Burial Ground.
Greendale	Marl, Wren, Old Tobin	3 honeycombs from the wild hives; 6 wildflowers; 4 apples from the orchard glade.
Khemetra	The Labourers' Hall, Day Hire House, Porters Guild	Water, bread, torches, dates, ale, nuts, lanterns, herbs and cheese, from the markets.
Khemetra	Contract House, Bounty Board	10 skeletons; 10 scorpions or cobras; 8 mummies.
Khemetra	Old Dalila, Eman, Yara, Cheops	4 cats in the alleys; an urn, a drum and a purse hidden in the Old Quarter.

Khemetra	Hapuseneb, Menes	Stand by the singing well between nine at night and five in the morning. Ask the marble bathing statue for its riddle.
Khemetra	Zeko, Ptah	20 gold on camel three. Collect 5 gold each from three shopkeepers.
Yarrim	Nell, Pell, Hamid, Wen	Watch the net racks at night; ask Gwen about the Admiral; 3 apples for Biscuit the donkey; a sea boot on the beach.
Oldhaven	Sergeant Cade, Dunstan, Gammer Wick, Perrin	8 loaves; 5 pieces of wood; 3 herrings; 3 torches for the bakery tunnel.
Oldhaven	Captain Aldwyn	Kill 6 Ash Guard at the east gate and later 10 more; speak to three pigeon keepers.
The Oakwood	Hale, Master Joss, Bramwick	6 wolves and 8 Ash Guard; 6 acorns and 4 wood; 5 herbs.
Saint Elen's	Brother Herbert, Cook, Bee-keeper	6 herbs; 8 apples; 3 honeycombs. Also flowers, a letter, a bell to ring.
The Narrow Sea	Tamsin Kell, Pell, Haldane, Orsa	5 sea serpents; 3 planks of wreck-oak; 5 pearls; Orsa's two sons, Tobin and Wren.

The people of the caves

WHO	WANTS	PAYS
The Cave Witch (Witch's Hollow)	Four herbs from the woods	400 gold
An exiled noble (Exile's Cave, Greyfang Pass)	One pie	500 gold
A hunted man (Ironhill Road)	One healing potion	450 gold
Wulf, Mara, Old Brannic (three caves on the Path)	3 bread; 2 healing potions; 2 lock picks	450, 500 and 550 gold

ACHIEVEMENTS

Menu, More, Achievements: every dungeon and every building visited, shown by name.

The quest log: tap a quest to see its place, and press Hint when you are stuck.

❦ **Dungeons and buildings visited.** The Achievements page lists every dungeon, tomb, cave, shrine and building and ticks those the party has entered.

❦ **Keeper of the Old Shrines.** Visit all sixteen old shrines and tell Abbot Anselm. Every hero gains 3 intelligence, and the quest pays 1500 gold.

❦ **The Pilgrim's Path completed.** Light all twenty stone teleporters, one at every fifth signpost. The prize is 1000 gold and the armour of an abbot: mitre, chasuble plate, cuffs and greaves, with a set bonus, wearable by any class.

❦ **The collections.** Menu, More, Collection logs gems, butterflies, herbs, treasure and shrines. The Wandering Monsters page shows how many of the fifteen you have met.

The sixteen Old Shrines

NUDGE: *Sixteen, in quiet corners of the land from the first woods to the far deserts. Abbot Anselm gives the quest.*

SPOILER

Stronger hint. They are in the older outdoor lands and in every desert, and on the Pilgrim's Path. Standing before one logs it (Menu, More, Collection).

The answer. Thornwood (The Shrine of the First Light), Gandrick's Wood (Woodcutters' Shrine), Ironhill Road (Wayfarers' Stone), Ironhill Moor (Moor Saint), Burial Ground (Gravekeeper's Niche), Greyfang Pass, Greendale (The Green Sun), the Sand Road, the Red Dunes (Shrine of the Red Road), the Blue Dunes, the White Dunes, the Golden Erg, the Violet Erg, the Flatlands, the Oakwood (Altar) and the Pilgrim's Rest on the Pilgrim's Path.

MAKING MONEY

❦ **Gems.** Forty kinds lie about on empty squares of the dungeons, the better ones deeper down. A gem sells for 40 to 300 gold.

❦ **A shovel.** Press G on an empty square. A Peasant's Shovel (30 gold) finds something about one dig in a hundred; the King's Golden Shovel (7000) one in ten. Finds are coins, gems, boots, weapons and oddities.

❦ **Butterflies.** A cage costs 20 gold. A rare one is worth much more than a common one.

❦ **Houses.** About one door in three is locked: buy lock picks from any trader (25 gold). Some houses have coins in a corner. Khemetra's watch warns anyone seen walking into a house and jails them on the third warning.

❦ **Rumours.** Three hoards are rumoured in Khemetra: a curse-heavy chest of 5000 in the far north-west of the Old Quarter, 2000 in the north-east behind a curtain in the Temple District, and 1000 in the far south-east near the baths under a table.

❦ **The Golden Pyramid.** In the Golden Erg. At the heart of its maze lies a chest with a thousand gold, and the Undying Pharaoh walks the maze.

❦ **The big quests.** The Court of King Osric pays 1265 gold, Vance's Letters 1265, the Hollow Abbot 1665 and the Question at the Top 2465.

HARD FIGHTS AND HOW TO SURVIVE THEM

Rest first. Heal and refill every hero before a boss door. A last door is a door you cannot go back through as a stronger party, so use the stair, rest at the inn and come back. If a place is too hard for the party, go elsewhere and come back stronger: the fixed world was made for exactly this.

Know what a great creature is. They stand above their place by a fixed amount: Cinderback three, the Cinder Guardian two, the Hollow rulers three, the Hollow Abbot four, the Messenger of Death five, and the Kraken twenty. You cannot win these fights by brute force before the level is right.

Use the undead rules. A Paladin's Smite doubles against skeletons. Spectres, ghosts and wraiths haunt and shake the party, and the church lifts a curse.

In the Orange Spire, kill the vampires, abominations and Pale Lord quickly, because they heal. Beware chests that look old, and strangers who look pale.

The Messenger of Death

One level in twenty-five has him. He touches the party once, and every hero is left shaken and one is haunted, and then he runs and hides. He has hidden the five letters of his name, D, E, A, T and H, on the walls of the level. Every letter the party reads is written in a book. When all five are read, the party is dead.

What the code lets you do: he can be killed, and he is only 70 base health, five levels above the party. After about twenty-two rounds of lurking he rushes at the party. Once he is hurt he fights back. He drops **The Last Word**, a long black sword that does 20 to 29 damage and has never missed. The letters read so far show at the top of the view, and a letter once read stays read. Each letter is scrawled flat on a wall, at least seven squares from the next, and counts as read when it comes into view within about six squares. Find him first.

CHEAT SHEET: THE LEVEL LADDER AND AUTOSCALING

Menu, Settings, Gameplay with autoscaling off. The page also tells you the level of the place you stand in.

The same page with autoscaling on.

Autoscaling off (the default). The world is fixed. Every place has its own level, rising by about three for each place the story leads to, and the world map shows the level next to every place. Creatures stand at the level of the place (some a little lower), and the great creatures a few above it, by at most eight. If a place is too hard, go elsewhere and come back stronger.

Autoscaling on. Creatures scale to the party. A party that has outgrown a place meets creatures raised to within a few levels of itself, and the great creatures always stand above the party. A place no longer gets easy as the party grows. Turn it off again whenever you like: the world goes back to its fixed levels.

HINT: *To change it, open the menu, then Settings, then Gameplay, and press the Autoscaling button. The page tells you the level of the place you are standing in, or that the place has no fixed level.*

The world map shows the level next to each place name, here the Narrow Sea with its islands and the Eastern Lands.

PLACE	LEVEL	PLACE	LEVEL
The crypts below the Abbey	1 to 3	Greendale and Anaea	37
Thornwood and Thornwick	7	The Tomb of Sut	39

Gandrick's Wood	10	The Red Dunes	41
Gandrick's Cave	13	Khemetra	44
The Ironhill Road	16	The other dune seas	45
The Tunnel	19	Yarrim	48
Ironhill	22 to 28	The four islands, the Open Sea	49 to 50
The Ironhill Mines	25	Oldhaven, the Oakwood, the Pilgrim's Path	55
The Burial Ground	29	Below the Abbey (four floors)	56 to 58
Ironhill Moor	30	The Hollow Land, the Orange Spire	58 to 65
Greyfang Pass	34	Saint Elen's Monastery	none fixed
The Sand Road	36		

COMMON QUESTIONS

I cannot rest. Enemies are close. Move away from them, or kill them. An inn lets you rest in any case.

A hero keeps losing health for no reason. Check hunger (zero hunger costs a point of health every twenty minutes) and then the Afflictions page. Poison, fever and bleeding all wear a hero down.

It says the load is too heavy or the bag is full. There are two limits, slots and weight. Drop or sell something, or add a ring, a donkey or a llama.

A door will not open. It is locked. About one house door in three is. Buy lock picks, and note that a pick can bend or snap, so buy a few.

How do I cure a curse? In a church or temple. The Church of Light in Khemetra will lift it.

What is the gold ! and the green ? A gold ! over someone means a quest to give. A green ? means someone to whom a finished quest can be handed in.

What is the ? on the map? A hidden cave or ruin that the party has seen but not yet entered.

Where did the Ferryman (or another wanderer) go? They stay where you met them. The quest log names the place.

How do I get a Diving Helm? Buy one for each hero from Tam Salvor on the pier at Yarrim.

Can I save whenever I like? Yes: the quick save on F5, and three slots, and the game saves itself as well.

The place is too hard. Go elsewhere and come back. Or turn autoscaling on.

I am lost. Tap the quest in the log: its place is circled on the map. Press Hint for words.

APPENDIX

Weapons, Armour and Rings

Every piece of gear in the game, sorted by colour: white, green, blue, red, purple and orange. The pages that follow are the full catalog.

Below the Abbey: weapons, armour and rings by tier

186 items. Tier is set by price, with armour pieces scaled for their slot and rings on their own scale. The Kraken harpoons, the Abbot set and the four boss weapons are orange.

White Basic

Weapons

Old Dagger
Dagger `dagger`
Light and quick. Easy to hit with.

Damage	2-4
Needs	DEX 6
Hit	+4%
Price	12 gold

Rusty Sword
Sword `sword`
Old and pitted, but still sharp enough.

Damage	3-5
Needs	STR 8
Price	20 gold

Battered Mace
Mace `mace`
A heavy iron head on a wooden handle.

Damage	3-6
Needs	STR 8
Hit	-3%
Price	24 gold

Gnarled Staff
Staff `staff`
Adds 2 to the power of spells.

Damage	1-3
Needs	INT 6
Spell power	2
Price	28 gold

Short Bow
Bow `bow`
Shoots at targets up to 3 tiles ahead.

Damage	2-5
Needs	DEX 8
Range	3
Hit	+2%
Price	30 gold

Hand Axe
Axe `axe`
Heavy and hard-hitting, but hard to land.

Damage	4-7
Needs	STR 10
Hit	-5%
Price	30 gold

Shields

Wooden Shield
Shield `shield`
Planks bound with a rusty band.

Armour	2
Needs	STR 8
Price	18 gold

Helms

Leather Cap
Helm `cap`
Stiff boiled leather.

Armour	1
Price	8 gold

Iron Helm
Helm `helm`
Dented, but it still turns a blade.

Armour	2
Needs	STR 8
Price	40 gold

Body armour

Leather Jerkin

Chest `jerkin`

Patched leather with a few stains.

Armour 2
Price 22 gold

Arm armour

Leather Bracers

Arms `bracers`

Straps to guard the forearms.

Armour 1
Price 10 gold

Leg armour

Leather Leggings

Legs `leggings`

Worn but sturdy.

Armour 1
Price 10 gold

Rings

Ring of Vigor

Ring `ringV`

Adds 4 to maximum health.

Health 4
Price 90 gold

Ring of Warding

Ring `ringW`

Adds 1 armor.

Armour 1
Price 100 gold

Ring of Might

Ring `ringM`

Adds 1 to melee damage.

Damage bonus 1
Price 110 gold

Ring of Keen Eye

Ring `ringS`

Adds 5% to hit chance.

Hit bonus +5%
Price 120 gold

Lights

Torch

Light `torch`

Hold it in a hand to light the way.

Light 1
Price 3 gold

Brass Lantern

Light `lantern`

Gives a much wider, steadier light than a torch.

Light 2.3
Price 45 gold

Green A bit stronger

Weapons

Drowned Dagger
Dagger `drowndagger`

Pale and wet, with a groove for blood. It is quick and it rarely misses.

Damage	4-6
Needs	DEX 8
Hit	+10%
Price	120 gold

Iron Cudgel
Mace `cudgel`

A club with iron bands. Crude and heavy. Needs level 1.

Damage	5-9
Needs	STR 12
Level	1
Gear tier	5
Hit	-2%
Effect	
Price	140 gold

Legion Gladius
Sword `gladius`

A short, plain army sword. Quick and reliable. Needs level 1.

Damage	6-10
Needs	STR 12
Level	1
Gear tier	5
Hit	+2%
Effect	
Price	150 gold

Sharp Hatchet
Axe `hatchet`

A hand axe with a proper edge. Needs level 1.

Damage	6-10
Needs	STR 12
Level	1
Gear tier	5
Hit	-4%
Effect	
Price	150 gold

Hunting Bow
Bow `huntbow`

A simple bow for small game. Shoots up to 3 squares. Needs level 1.

Damage	4-8
Needs	DEX 12
Level	1
Gear tier	5
Range	3
Hit	+4%
Effect	
Price	150 gold

Brannoch's Blade
Sword `ironblade`

Plain iron, well made. It never rusts.

Damage	6-9
Needs	STR 10
Hit	+4%
Price	200 gold

Gravewarden's Mace
Mace `gravemace`

Carved with funeral prayers. It rings when it hits bone.

Damage	4-8
Needs	STR 9
Double strike	+12%
Price	210 gold

Overseer's Axe
Axe `ironaxe`

A heavy mining axe, still sharp after years in the dark.

Damage	7-11
Needs	STR 11
Hit	-3%
Price	240 gold

Warden's Blade
Sword `wardblade`

A pale blade from the empty house. It is cold to hold and it cuts well.

Damage	6-10
Needs	STR 10
Hit	+5%
Price	260 gold

Shields

Banded Round Shield

Shield `roundshield`

A round shield with an iron boss. Enemies miss 4% more. Needs level 10.

Armour	3
Needs	STR 10
Level	10
Passive	DODGE 0.04
Price	300 gold

Helms

Tusked Boarhide Helm

Helm `ar_boar_h`

Enemies miss 2% more. Set: Boarhide Hunter. All four pieces give: Every blow on you is 2 lighter. Every enemy that strikes you takes 3 damage. Needs level 10.

Armour	5
Level	10
Gear tier	10
Set	boar
Passive	DODGE 0.022
Price	220 gold

Arm armour

Boarhide Vambraces

Arms `ar_boar_a`

+2% double hits. Set: Boarhide Hunter. All four pieces give: Every blow on you is 2 lighter. Every enemy that strikes you takes 3 damage. Needs level 10.

Armour	3
Level	10
Gear tier	10
Set	boar
Passive	CRIT 0.02
Price	140 gold

Leg armour

Boarhide Greaves

Legs `ar_boar_l`

Hunger falls 10% slower. Set: Boarhide Hunter. All four pieces give: Every blow on you is 2 lighter. Every enemy that strikes you takes 3 damage. Needs level 10.

Armour	4
Level	10
Gear tier	10
Set	boar
Passive	HUNGERSLOW 0.1
Price	180 gold

Rings

Ring of the Well
Ring `ringWell`

A blue ring that is always a little cool. Adds 8 to maximum mana.

Mana 8
Price 310 gold

Ring of the Ox
Ring `ringOx`

A heavy brass ring. Adds 2 Strength.

STR 2
Price 320 gold

Ring of the Fox
Ring `ringFox`

A thin copper ring that fits like a second skin. Adds 2 Dexterity.

DEX 2
Price 320 gold

Ring of the Owl
Ring `ringOwl`

A silver ring with two tiny round eyes. Adds 2 Intelligence.

INT 2
Price 320 gold

Ring of the Bear
Ring `ringBear`

A thick ring cut with claw marks. Adds 12 to maximum health.

Health 12
Price 360 gold

Blue Stronger, usually with an effect

Weapons

Serrated Cutlass
Sword `cutlass`

A curved blade with a saw edge. A quarter of its hits leave the foe bleeding. Needs level 1.

Damage 10-16
Needs STR 14
Level 1
Gear tier 10
Hit +5%
Effect BLEED [0.25, 5, 3]
Price 400 gold

Splitting Axe
Axe `splitaxe`

A woodsman's axe with a wicked edge. One hit in seven leaves the foe dazed. Needs level 1.

Damage 12-19
Needs STR 16
Level 1
Gear tier 10
Hit -4%
Effect DAZE 0.15
Price 400 gold

Hunter's Longbow
Bow `hunterbow`

A plain, well-made longbow. Shoots up to 4 squares and rarely misses. Needs level 1.

Damage 9-15
Needs DEX 14
Level 1
Gear tier 10
Range 4
Hit +10%
Effect
Price 400 gold

Nymph's Bow
Bow `sylvanbow`

A living green bow that still sprouts leaves. Its arrows fly far and seldom miss.

Damage 6-10
Needs DEX 9
Range 5
Hit +14%
Price 450 gold

Bastard Sword

Sword `bastard`

Long enough for two hands, light enough for one. One hit in five leaves the foe bleeding. Needs level 5.

Damage	14-22
Needs	STR 16
Level	5
Gear tier	15
Hit	+3%
Effect	BLEED [0.2, 5, 3]
Price	650 gold

Bearded Axe

Axe `beardaxe`

A hooked axe from the hill forts. One hit in seven leaves the foe dazed. Needs level 5.

Damage	14-22
Needs	STR 16
Level	5
Gear tier	15
Hit	-4%
Effect	DAZE 0.15
Price	650 gold

Flanged Mace

Mace `flanged`

A mace with steel flanges that bite through mail. One hit in five dazes the foe. Needs level 5.

Damage	15-23
Needs	STR 16
Level	5
Gear tier	15
Hit	-3%
Effect	DAZE 0.2
Price	650 gold

Yew Longbow

Bow `longbow`

A tall yew bow. Shoots up to 4 squares. Needs level 5.

Damage	11-18
Needs	DEX 16
Level	5
Gear tier	15
Range	4
Hit	+8%
Effect	
Price	650 gold

Staff of Shifting Sands

Staff `sandstaff`

Fine sand runs endlessly down the inside of its glass head. Adds 6 to the power of spells.

Damage	2-5
Needs	INT 12
Spell power	6
Price	860 gold

Bow of the Dunes

Bow `dunebow`

Bone and sun-bleached wood. Its arrows seem to ride the wind, and they seldom miss.

Damage	11-16
Needs	DEX 13
Range	5
Hit	+15%
Price	880 gold

Sunforged Scimitar

Sword `sunblade`

A curved blade that holds the heat of noon. It never dulls, and it cuts like light.

Damage	13-19
Needs	STR 13
Hit	+8%
Price	900 gold

Cleaving Greatsword

Sword `greatsword`

A huge blade swung in a great arc. Every hit also cuts the foe standing behind the first. Needs level 10.

Damage	18-28
Needs	STR 18
Level	10
Gear tier	20
Effect	CLEAVE 1
Price	900 gold

Wolf-Haft Axe

Axe `wolfaxe`

A bearded axe from the north. Hits carry through to the foe behind. Needs level 10.

Damage	22-32
Needs	STR 20
Level	10
Gear tier	20
Hit	-3%
Effect	CLEAVE 1
Price	900 gold

Barbed Bow

Bow `barbedbow`

Bone barbs on the limbs and barbed arrows. A third of its hits leave the foe bleeding. Needs level 10.

Damage	16-24
Needs	DEX 18
Level	10
Gear tier	20
Range	4
Hit	+6%
Effect	BLEED [0.3, 6, 4]
Price	900 gold

Shields

Kite Shield
Shield `kiteshield`

A long shield with a blue stripe. Enemies miss 6% more. Needs level 20.

Armour	4
Needs	STR 14
Level	20
Passive	DODGE 0.06
Price	600 gold

Pharaoh's Aegis
Shield `pharaohshield`

A round shield of gold and lapis with a winged sun on its face.

Armour	6
Needs	STR 11
Price	820 gold

Helms

Iron Cap
Helm `ironcap`

A plain iron cap with a nose guard. Needs level 10.

Armour	3
Needs	STR 10
Level	10
Price	250 gold

Diving Helm
Helm `divehelm`

A riveted brass helm with a round glass visor and a leather hose. Worn in the helmet slot it lets a hero breathe underwater for four minutes at a time, until air is found at the bubble vents. Every hero in the party needs one to dive.

Armour	3
Dive	1
Price	300 gold

Prism Helm
Helm `prismhelm`

A helm of glass-bright metal that throws small rainbows. It turns blows aside, and its wearer feels sure of themselves.

Armour	4
Price	380 gold

Knight's Greathelm
Helm `greathelm`

A closed helm with a narrow slit. Blows glance off it. Needs level 20.

Armour	4
Needs	STR 14
Level	20
Passive	DODGE 0.03
Price	500 gold

Body armour

Wraithplate
Chest `wraithmail`

Black plate that is cold to touch. It hums faintly and turns blows aside like they were mist.

Armour	6
Price	400 gold

Boarhide Cuirass
Chest `ar_boar_c`

Wounds close steadily. Set: Boarhide Hunter. All four pieces give: Every blow on you is 2 lighter. Every enemy that strikes you takes 3 damage. Needs level 10.

Armour	9
Level	10
Gear tier	10
Set	boar
Passive	REGEN 0.16
Price	400 gold

Studded Brigandine
Chest `brigandine`

Leather studded with iron. Recover a little health every few rounds. Needs level 10.

Armour	5
Needs	None
Level	10
Passive	REGEN 0.15
Price	450 gold

Steel Hauberk
Chest `hauberk`

A shirt of steel rings. Enemies miss 3% more. Needs level 20.

Armour	7
Needs	None
Level	20
Passive	DODGE 0.03
Price	900 gold

Arm armour

Ironscale Vambraces
Arms `ar_iron_a`

All damage +3%. Set: Ironscale Warden. All four pieces give: Every blow on you is 4 lighter. Wounds close steadily. Needs level 20.

Armour	5
Level	20
Gear tier	20
Set	iron
Passive	DMGPCT 0.034
Price	455 gold

Rings

Ring of the Porter
Ring `ringPorter`

An iron ring worn smooth by rope. Lets the party carry 20 kg more.

Carry weight	20
Price	400 gold

Ring of the Pack Mule
Ring `ringMule`

A plain leather-wrapped ring. Adds 8 pack slots and lets the party carry 15 kg more.

Bag slots	8
Carry weight	15
Price	470 gold

Ring of the Bulwark
Ring `ringBulwark`

A broad steel ring like a tiny shield. Adds 3 armor.

Armour	3
Price	540 gold

Ring of the Hawk
Ring `ringHawk`

A green ring with a sharp little beak. Adds 10% to hit chance.

Hit bonus	+10%
Price	540 gold

Ring of the Lion
Ring `ringLion`

A golden ring with a mane of fine lines. Adds 3 to melee damage.

Damage bonus	3
Price	610 gold

Ring of the Duellist
Ring `ringDuel`

A red ring that tingles in a fight. Adds 6% to double damage.

Double strike	+6%
Price	680 gold

Ring of the Featherweight
Ring `ringFeather`

A pale ring that seems to weigh nothing. Everything the party carries weighs 15% less.

Price	680 gold

Scarab Ring
Ring `scarabring`

A beetle carved from green stone, set in gold. Adds 14 to maximum health.

Health	14
Price	700 gold

Ring of the Tomb Guard
Ring `wardring`

A heavy ring of old bronze. Adds 3 armor.

Armour	3
Price	720 gold

Ring of the Ankh
Ring `ankhring`

Gold, with a tiny ankh on its face. Adds 3 to melee damage.

Damage bonus	3
Price	760 gold

Ring of the Craftsman
Ring `ringCraft`

A ring of fine gold wire. Adds 1 rank to the wearer's profession.

Profession rank	1
Price	760 gold

Eye of Ra
Ring `eyering`

A ring with a blue eye that follows the foe. Adds 12% to hit chance.

Hit bonus	+12%
Price	780 gold

Red Next level

Weapons

Tempered Longsword
Sword `tempered`

A longsword of fine, folded steel. Against a foe under 20% health it deals double damage. Needs level 15.

Damage	20-35
Needs	STR 20
Level	15
Gear tier	25
Hit	+5%
Effect	EXEC [0.2, 2]
Price	1500 gold

Knight's Battle Axe
Axe `battleaxe`

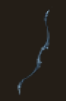
A broad axe made for the melee. Every hit also cuts the foe standing behind the first. Needs level 15.

Damage	20-35
Needs	STR 20
Level	15
Gear tier	25
Hit	-3%
Effect	CLEAVE 1
Price	1500 gold

Steel War Hammer
Mace `warhammer`

A steel hammer with a spike on the back. A quarter of its hits crack the guard of the foe. Needs level 15.

Damage	21-35
Needs	STR 20
Level	15
Gear tier	25
Hit	-3%
Effect	VULN [0.25, 3]
Price	1500 gold



Composite Bow
Bow `compbow`

Horn, sinew and wood glued together. Its arrows pass through the foe and strike the one behind. Needs level 15.

Damage	20-35
Needs	DEX 20
Level	15
Gear tier	25
Range	4
Hit	+8%
Effect	PIERCE 1
Price	1500 gold

Executioner's Blade
Sword `executioner`

A black broad blade. Against a foe under 30% health it deals two and a half times damage. Needs level 20.

Damage	26-38
Needs	STR 22
Level	20
Gear tier	30
Double strike	+10%
Hit	+2%
Effect	EXEC [0.3, 2.5]
Price	1600 gold

Spiked Maul
Mace `maul`

A spiked iron maul. A third of its hits crack the foe's guard: it takes half again as much damage for three rounds. Needs level 20.

Damage	34-50
Needs	STR 24
Level	20
Gear tier	30
Hit	-4%
Effect	VULN [0.3, 3]
Price	1600 gold

Twinstring Bow
Bow `twinbow`

Two strings, two arrows. One shot in four sends a second arrow after the first. Needs level 20.

Damage	24-36
Needs	DEX 22
Level	20
Gear tier	30
Range	4
Hit	+6%
Effect	DOUBLE 0.25
Price	1600 gold

Frostbrand
Sword `frostbrand`

A blade that never loses its frost. One hit in seven freezes the foe for a round. Needs level 25.

Damage	32-46
Needs	STR 24
Level	25
Gear tier	35
Hit	+5%
Effect	STUN 0.15
Price	2100 gold

Reaver Axe

Axe `reaveraxe`

A black, jagged axe. Three hits in ten leave the foe bleeding. Needs level 25.

Damage	33-48
Needs	STR 24
Level	25
Gear tier	35
Hit	-3%
Effect	BLEED [0.3, 8, 4]
Price	2100 gold

The Last Word

Sword `deathsword`

A long black blade that was the Messenger of Death's own. It has never missed, and it has never once been wrong about who was next.

Damage	20-29
Needs	STR 14
Hit	+12%
Price	2200 gold

Great Maul

Mace `greatmaul`

A two-handed maul with a head like a boulder. One hit in five knocks the foe senseless. Needs level 25.

Damage	34-50
Needs	STR 24
Level	25
Gear tier	35
Hit	-3%
Effect	STUN 0.2
Price	2200 gold

Stormstring Bow

Bow `stormbow`

A bow strung with something that crackles. Shoots 5 squares, and three shots in ten send a second arrow after the first. Needs level 20.

Damage	30-44
Needs	DEX 22
Level	20
Gear tier	30
Range	5
Double strike	+10%
Hit	+8%
Effect	DOUBLE 0.3
Price	2400 gold

Elven Bow

Bow `elvenbow`

A slender bow that is quicker than it looks. Shoots 5 squares, and one shot in four sends a second arrow. Needs level 25.

Damage	32-46
Needs	DEX 24
Level	25
Gear tier	35
Range	5
Hit	+10%
Effect	DOUBLE 0.25
Price	2100 gold

Skullcrusher

Mace `skullcrusher`

A blue-steel war hammer with a head like an anvil. One hit in five knocks the foe senseless for a round. Needs level 20.

Damage	32-46
Needs	STR 22
Level	20
Gear tier	30
Hit	-2%
Effect	STUN 0.2
Price	2200 gold

Wyrmfang Sabre

Sword `wyrmfang`

A gold-hilted sabre with a blade ground from a dragon tooth. Two hits in five leave the foe bleeding badly. Needs level 20.

Damage	34-48
Needs	STR 22
Level	20
Gear tier	30
Double strike	+10%
Hit	+5%
Effect	BLEED [0.4, 8, 4]
Price	2400 gold

Shields

Spiked Shield
Shield `spikeshield`

An iron shield bristling with spikes. Every enemy that strikes you takes 4 damage. Needs level 30.

Armour	5
Needs	STR 18
Level	30
Passive	THORNS 4
Price	1100 gold

Lion Tower Shield
Shield `towershield`

A tall dark shield with a golden lion. Enemies miss 8% more. Needs level 40.

Armour	7
Needs	STR 22
Level	40
Passive	DODGE 0.08
Price	1800 gold

Bulwark of Ages
Shield `bulwark`

A slab of black iron older than the kingdom. Enemies miss 6% more and take 6 damage for every blow they land. Needs level 30.

Armour	8
Needs	STR 22
Level	30
Passive	THORNS 6, DODGE 0.06
Price	2200 gold

Helms

Helm of the Jackal
Helm `jackalhelm`

Gold, shaped like the head of a jackal. Its wearer hears the dead before they strike.

Armour	5
Needs	STR 10
Price	700 gold

Ironscale Coif
Helm `ar_iron_h`

Every blow on you is 3 lighter. Set: Ironscale Warden. All four pieces give: Every blow on you is 4 lighter. Wounds close steadily. Needs level 20.

Armour	7
Level	20
Gear tier	20
Set	iron
Passive	WARD 3
Price	715 gold

Horned Helm
Helm `hornhelm`

A horned helm that makes the wearer look twice as angry. All damage +5%. Needs level 30.

Armour	5
Needs	STR 18
Level	30
Passive	DMGPCT 0.05
Price	900 gold

Rimeforged Helm
Helm `ar_rime_h`

Enemies miss 5% more. Set: Rimeforged Sentinel. All four pieces give: Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 30%. Mana comes back faster. Needs level 30.

Armour	9
Level	30
Gear tier	30
Set	rime
Passive	DODGE 0.046
Price	1424 gold

Centurion Helm
Helm `centurion`

A bronze helm with a red crest. +5% double hits. Needs level 40.

Armour	6
Needs	STR 22
Level	40
Passive	CRIT 0.05
Price	1500 gold

Body armour

Gilded Cuirass
Chest `goldmail`

A breastplate of gold over blue linen. It is light as a shirt, and blows glance off it.

Armour	9
Needs	STR 12
Price	1100 gold

Ironscale Hauberk
Chest `ar_iron_c`

Every enemy that strikes you takes 4 damage. Set: Ironscale Warden. All four pieces give: Every blow on you is 4 lighter. Wounds close steadily. Needs level 20.

Armour	13
Level	20
Gear tier	20
Set	iron
Passive	THORNS 4
Price	1300 gold

Plate Cuirass
Chest `cuirass`

A polished steel breastplate. Recover health steadily. Needs level 30.

Armour	9
Needs	None
Level	30
Passive	REGEN 0.2
Price	1600 gold

Rimeforged Breastplate
Chest `ar_rime_c`

Every blow on you is 4 lighter. Set: Rimeforged Sentinel. All four pieces give: Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 30%. Mana comes back faster. Needs level 30.

Armour	16
Level	30
Gear tier	30
Set	rime
Passive	WARD 4
Price	2589 gold

Arm armour

Bracers of the Sun
Arms `sunbracers`

Gold bands set with lapis. They stay warm, even in the dark.

Armour	3
Price	600 gold

Rimeforged Bracers
Arms `ar_rime_a`

Mana comes back faster. Set: Rimeforged Sentinel. All four pieces give: Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 30%. Mana comes back faster. Needs level 30.

Armour	6
Level	30
Gear tier	30
Set	rime
Passive	MPREGEN 0.22
Price	906 gold

Leg armour

Ironscale Greaves
Legs `ar_iron_l`

Enemies miss 3% more. Set: Ironscale Warden. All four pieces give: Every blow on you is 4 lighter. Wounds close steadily. Needs level 20.

Armour	6
Level	20
Gear tier	20
Set	iron
Passive	DODGE 0.034
Price	585 gold

Greaves of the Dunes
Legs `duneboots`

Soft red leather and gold studs. The sand does not slow the one who wears them.

Armour	4
Price	640 gold

Rimeforged Greaves
Legs `ar_rime_l`

Heals 4% of melee damage dealt. Set: Rimeforged Sentinel. All four pieces give: Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 30%. Mana comes back faster. Needs level 30.

Armour	7
Level	30
Gear tier	30
Set	rime
Passive	LIFESTEAL 0.044
Price	1165 gold

Rings

Ring of the Moon
Ring `ringMoon`

A ring of pale silver with a crescent. Adds 18 to maximum mana.

Mana	18
Price	860 gold

Ring of the Titan
Ring `ringTitan`

A massive bronze ring. Adds 4 Strength.

STR	4
Price	1010 gold

Ring of the Wind
Ring `ringWind`

A light ring that hums in a breeze. Adds 4 Dexterity.

DEX	4
Price	1010 gold

Ring of the Sage
Ring `ringSage`

A violet ring with a thousand tiny letters. Adds 4 Intelligence.

INT	4
Price	1010 gold

Ring of the Oak
Ring `ringOak`

A green ring of living wood that never dries. Adds 24 to maximum health.

Health	24
Price	1040 gold

Purple Powerful

Weapons

Vanguard Claymore
Sword `claymore`

A heavy steel-blue claymore. One hit in five knocks the foe senseless for a round. Needs level 30.

Damage	38-54
Needs	STR 26
Level	30
Gear tier	40
Hit	+4%
Effect	STUN 0.2
Price	2600 gold

Headsman's Axe
Axe `headsman`

A long black axe. Against a foe under a quarter health it deals triple damage. Needs level 30.

Damage	46-66
Needs	STR 28
Level	30
Gear tier	40
Hit	-2%
Effect	EXEC [0.25, 3]
Price	2600 gold

Steppe Warbow

Bow `warbow`

A horn and sinew recurve bow. Its arrows pass through the foe and strike the one behind. Needs level 30.

Damage	36-52
Needs	DEX 26
Level	30
Gear tier	40
Range	5
Hit	+8%
Effect	PIERCE 1
Price	2600 gold

Thunder Axe

Axe `thunderaxe`

A broad red axe that rings like a bell. One hit in five shakes the ground and knocks down every foe within two squares. Needs level 20.

Damage	36-50
Needs	STR 24
Level	20
Gear tier	30
Hit	-3%
Effect	SHOCK 0.2
Price	2800 gold

Doomblade

Sword `doomblade`

A cruel, notched sword. Two hits in five leave the foe bleeding badly. Needs level 35.

Damage	46-66
Needs	STR 28
Level	35
Gear tier	45
Hit	+6%
Effect	BLEED [0.4, 10, 4]
Price	3300 gold

Dragonbone Bow

Bow `bonebow`

A bow of dragon rib. Shoots 5 squares, and its arrows leave the foe bleeding. Needs level 35.

Damage	44-64
Needs	DEX 28
Level	35
Gear tier	45
Range	5
Hit	+10%
Effect	BLEED [0.3, 8, 4]
Price	3300 gold

The Admiral's Cutlass

Sword `admiralblade`

A curved blade of blue steel with a pearl in the hilt, kept dry in a sealed case for a hundred years. It cuts as if the sea were helping.

Damage	22-32
Needs	STR 14
Hit	+10%
Price	2800 gold

The Great Harpoon

Sword `greatharpoon`

Wreck-oak shaft, a barbed head as long as a forearm, and a coil of line. Made by Pell the chandler to answer the Kraken.

Damage	26-36
Needs	STR 16
Hit	+6%
Price	3200 gold

Dread Axe

Axe `dreadaxe`

A huge axe with a skull on the haft. Against a foe under a quarter health it deals two and a half times damage. Needs level 35.

Damage	47-68
Needs	STR 28
Level	35
Gear tier	45
Hit	-2%
Effect	EXEC [0.25, 2.5]
Price	3300 gold

Titan Hammer

Mace `titanhammer`

A hammer for a giant. A third of its hits crack the guard of the foe for four rounds. Needs level 35.

Damage	48-70
Needs	STR 28
Level	35
Gear tier	45
Hit	-3%
Effect	VULN [0.3, 4]
Price	3400 gold

Nightfall

Sword `nightfall`

A black greatsword that drinks the light. Against a foe under a quarter health it deals two and a half times damage. Needs level 35.

Damage	50-80
Needs	STR 28
Level	35
Gear tier	45
Double strike	+10%
Hit	+7%
Effect	EXEC [0.25, 2.5]
Price	4000 gold

Hammer of Judgement

Mace `judgement`

A white hammer that falls like a sentence. One hit in five stuns the foe, and one in four cracks its guard. Needs level 35.

Damage	50-80
Needs	STR 28
Level	35
Gear tier	45
Hit	-2%
Effect	STUN 0.2, VULN [0.25, 3]
Price	4000 gold

Kingslayer

Sword `kingslayer`

A king-sized longsword that rarely misses. Bosses and great beasts take half again as much from it. Needs level 40.

Damage	54-78
Needs	STR 30
Level	40
Gear tier	50
Double strike	+12%
Hit	+10%
Effect	BOSSDMG 0.5
Price	4200 gold

Windrunner

Bow `silverbow`

A slim bow of silvered wood, quick and true. Shoots 6 squares; great beasts take a quarter more. Needs level 40.

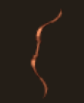
Damage	50-72
Needs	DEX 30
Level	40
Gear tier	50
Range	6
Double strike	+20%
Hit	+15%
Effect	BOSSDMG 0.25
Price	4200 gold

Dragonmaw Axe

Axe `dragonmaw`

An axe with a jaw of dragon teeth. It cuts through to the foe behind, and three hits in ten leave a foe bleeding. Needs level 35.

Damage	50-80
Needs	STR 28
Level	35
Gear tier	45
Hit	-2%
Effect	CLEAVE 1, BLEED [0.3, 8, 4]
Price	4000 gold



Bow of Ruin

Bow `ruinbow`

A black bow that shoots through armour. Shoots 5 squares, its arrows pass through to the foe behind, and one shot in five sends a second arrow. Needs level 35.

Damage	50-80
Needs	DEX 28
Level	35
Gear tier	45
Range	5
Double strike	+10%
Hit	+10%
Effect	PIERCE 1, DOUBLE 0.2
Price	4000 gold

Earthsplitter

Axe `worldaxe`

A gigantic double axe. One hit in four shakes the ground and knocks down every foe within two squares. Needs level 40.

Damage	64-92
Needs	STR 32
Level	40
Gear tier	50
Hit	-3%
Effect	SHOCK 0.25
Price	4200 gold

Sunderer

Sword `sunderer`

A vast grey blade that breaks armour. Bosses and great beasts take 40% more from it. Needs level 45.

Damage	70-100
Needs	STR 32
Level	45
Gear tier	55
Hit	+8%
Effect	BOSSDMG 0.4
Price	5200 gold

Titan Axe

Axe `titanaxe`

An axe the size of a door. One hit in four shakes the ground and knocks down every foe within two squares. Needs level 45.

Damage	70-102
Needs	STR 32
Level	45
Gear tier	55
Hit	-3%
Effect	SHOCK 0.25
Price	5200 gold

Stormcaller Bow

Bow `stormbow2`

A bow that hums before a storm. Shoots 6 squares, and three shots in ten send a second arrow. Needs level 45.

Damage	66-96
Needs	DEX 32
Level	45
Gear tier	55
Range	6
Hit	+12%
Effect	DOUBLE 0.3
Price	5200 gold

Mountain Maul

Mace `mountainmaul`

A maul cut from a mountain. One hit in four knocks the foe senseless. Needs level 45.

Damage	72-104
Needs	STR 32
Level	45
Gear tier	55
Hit	-3%
Effect	STUN 0.25
Price	5300 gold

Shields

Dragon Shield

Shield `dragonshield`

A huge bronze shield with a dragon. Enemies miss 10% more and take 6 damage for every blow they land. Needs level 50.

Armour	9
Needs	STR 26
Level	50
Passive	DODGE 0.1, THORNS 6
Price	2800 gold

Helms

Drakescale Helm

Helm `drakehelm`

A helm of overlapping red scales. All damage +8% and +4% double hits. Needs level 30.

Armour	7
Needs	STR 22
Level	30
Passive	DMGPCT 0.08, CRIT 0.04
Price	2000 gold

Emberplate Helm

Helm `ar_ember_h`

All damage +6%. Set: Emberplate Champion. All four pieces give: Every enemy that strikes you takes 8 damage. All damage +8%. Needs level 40.

Armour	11
Level	40
Gear tier	40
Set	ember
Passive	DMGPCT 0.058
Price	2322 gold

Bogeyman Mask
Helm `bogeymask`

A hollow bone-white mask with two empty eyes, taken from the bogeyman. Armour 8, enemies miss 5% more, damage +4%. Its wearer cannot be shaken or haunted. Needs level 10.

Armour	8
Level	10
Passive	DODGE 0.05, DMGPCT 0.04
Price	3200 gold

Sunsteel Helm
Helm `ar_sun_h`

Wounds close steadily. Set: Sunsteel Paladin. All four pieces give: Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 40%. Wounds close steadily. Needs level 50.

Armour	13
Level	50
Gear tier	50
Set	sun
Passive	REGEN 0.48
Price	3394 gold

Body armour

Phantom Shroud
Chest `phantomshroud`

A shroud of pale, cold cloth that was never woven. Enemies miss 8% more, and wounds close steadily. Needs level 12.

Armour	12
Level	12
Passive	DODGE 0.08, REGEN 0.3
Price	2600 gold

Lionplate
Chest `lionplate`

Plate with lion-head pauldrons. Every enemy that strikes you takes 3 damage. Needs level 40.

Armour	12
Needs	None
Level	40
Passive	THORNS 3
Price	2600 gold

Wyrmscale Plate
Chest `wyrmplate`

Plate hung with the scales of a great wyrm. Enemies miss 5% more and wounds close steadily. Needs level 30.

Armour	12
Needs	STR 24
Level	30
Passive	DODGE 0.05, REGEN 0.25
Price	2800 gold

Gilded Plate
Chest `goldplate`

Gold-trimmed steel plate. Enemies miss 6% more and wounds close fast. Needs level 50.

Armour	15
Needs	None
Level	50
Passive	DODGE 0.06, REGEN 0.3
Price	4000 gold

Emberplate Cuirass
Chest `ar_ember_c`

Every enemy that strikes you takes 8 damage. Set: Emberplate Champion. All four pieces give: Every enemy that strikes you takes 8 damage. All damage +8%. Needs level 40.

Armour	20
Level	40
Gear tier	40
Set	ember
Passive	THORNS 8
Price	4222 gold

Sunsteel Cuirass
Chest `ar_sun_c`

Enemies miss 7% more. Set: Sunsteel Paladin. All four pieces give: Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 40%. Wounds close steadily. Needs level 50.

Armour	24
Level	50
Gear tier	50
Set	sun
Passive	DODGE 0.07
Price	6170 gold

Arm armour

Emberplate Vambraces

Arms `ar_ember_a`

+5% double hits. Set: Emberplate Champion. All four pieces give: Every enemy that strikes you takes 8 damage. All damage +8%. Needs level 40.

Armour	7
Level	40
Gear tier	40
Set	ember
Passive	CRIT 0.05
Price	1478 gold

Sunsteel Vambraces

Arms `ar_sun_a`

Heals 6% of melee damage dealt. Set: Sunsteel Paladin. All four pieces give: Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 40%. Wounds close steadily. Needs level 50.

Armour	8
Level	50
Gear tier	50
Set	sun
Passive	LIFESTEAL 0.06
Price	2160 gold

Voidglass Vambraces

Arms `ar_void_a`

Enemies miss 8% more. Set: Voidglass Reaver. All four pieces give: Heals 8% of melee damage dealt. +6% double hits. Needs level 60.

Armour	10
Level	60
Gear tier	60
Set	void
Passive	DODGE 0.082
Price	2944 gold

Leg armour

Emberplate Greaves

Legs `ar_ember_l`

Wounds close steadily. Set: Emberplate Champion. All four pieces give: Every enemy that strikes you takes 8 damage. All damage +8%. Needs level 40.

Armour	9
Level	40
Gear tier	40
Set	ember
Passive	REGEN 0.4
Price	1900 gold

Sunsteel Greaves

Legs `ar_sun_l`

Mana comes back faster. Set: Sunsteel Paladin. All four pieces give: Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 40%. Wounds close steadily. Needs level 50.

Armour	11
Level	50
Gear tier	50
Set	sun
Passive	MPREGEN 0.34
Price	2777 gold

Rings

Ring of the Champion

Ring `ringChampion`

A gold ring set with three small stones. Adds 1 to Strength, Dexterity and Intelligence.

STR	1
DEX	1
INT	1
Price	1170 gold

Ring of the Great Haul

Ring `ringHaul`

A ring on a golden chain-link band. Adds 16 pack slots and lets the party carry 30 kg more.

Bag slots	16
Carry weight	30
Price	1260 gold

Orange The best

Weapons

The Ember Harpoon
Sword `kharp1`

A black iron harpoon, its barbed head glowing the red of a banked fire. It is made for one thing, and it is not men, and it is not wolves. Only the Kraken feels it.

Damage	1-3
Hit	+20%
Price	not sold

The Verdigris Harpoon
Sword `kharp2`

A long bronze harpoon green with the sea, tiny blue runes crawling along the shaft. It is made for one thing: the Kraken. Against everything else it is a stick.

Damage	1-3
Hit	+20%
Price	not sold

The Silver Harpoon
Sword `kharp3`

A silver harpoon with a spiral barb like the inside of a shell, giving off a soft white light. It is made to kill one creature in the world, and it hurts nothing else.

Damage	1-3
Hit	+20%
Price	not sold

The Beacon Harpoon
Sword `kharp4`

A dark steel harpoon inlaid with gold, warm to the hand. The old fleet forged four of these to kill the Kraken, and nothing else. When the Kraken is dead they will not last.

Damage	1-3
Hit	+20%
Price	not sold

Worldbreaker Blade
Sword `worldblade`

The sword the old kings were buried with. Against a foe under 30% health it deals triple damage. Needs level 50.

Damage	82-118
Needs	STR 34
Level	50
Gear tier	60
Double strike	+12%
Hit	+10%
Effect	EXEC [0.3, 3]
Price	6500 gold

Ragnarok Axe
Axe `ragnarok`

A war axe of the last battle. It cuts through to the foe behind, and shakes the ground one time in seven. Needs level 50.

Damage	84-120
Needs	STR 34
Level	50
Gear tier	60
Hit	-2%
Effect	CLEAVE 1, SHOCK 0.15
Price	6500 gold

Starfall Bow
Bow `starbow`

A silver bow that shoots light. Shoots 6 squares; great beasts take 30% more. Needs level 50.

Damage	80-114
Needs	DEX 34
Level	50
Gear tier	60
Range	6
Double strike	+15%
Hit	+14%
Effect	BOSSDMG 0.3
Price	6500 gold

Doom Hammer
Mace `doomhammer`

A hammer that ends arguments. It stuns one hit in five and shakes the ground one in five. Needs level 50.

Damage	86-122
Needs	STR 34
Level	50
Gear tier	60
Hit	-3%
Effect	STUN 0.2, SHOCK 0.2
Price	6600 gold

Crownbreaker
Sword `crownbreaker`

The sword of the Gaunt King. Against a foe under 35% health it deals triple damage, and bosses take 50% more. Needs level 28.

Damage	112-160
Needs	STR 30
Level	28
Double strike	+15%
Hit	+15%
Effect	EXEC [0.35, 3], BOSSDMG 0.5
Price	12000 gold

Veilpiercer
Bow `veilpiercer`

The bone bow of the Smiling Queen. Shoots 6 squares, its arrows pass through to the foe behind, and three shots in ten send a second arrow. Needs level 28.

Damage	100-146
Needs	DEX 30
Level	28
Range	6
Double strike	+15%
Hit	+16%
Effect	PIERCE 1, DOUBLE 0.3
Price	12000 gold

The Duke's Gavel
Mace `dukesgavel`

The spiked mace of the Poison Duke. Three hits in ten stun the foe, and the same number crack its guard for four rounds. Needs level 28.

Damage	118-168
Needs	STR 24
Level	28
Hit	-2%
Effect	STUN 0.3, VULN [0.3, 4], SHOCK 0.15
Price	12000 gold

Hollow Scepter
Staff `hollowscepter`

The scepter of the Hollow Child-King. Adds 35 to the power of spells, and bosses take 30% more from its blows. Needs level 28.

Damage	50-80
Needs	INT 28
Level	28
Spell power	35
Effect	BOSSDMG 0.3
Price	12000 gold

Helms

Voidglass Crown
Helm `ar_void_h`

+7% double hits. Set: Voidglass Reaver. All four pieces give: Heals 8% of melee damage dealt. +6% double hits. Needs level 60.

Armour	15
Level	60
Gear tier	60
Set	void
Passive	CRIT 0.07
Price	4627 gold

Stormwrought Helm
Helm `ar_storm_h`

Enemies miss 9% more. Set: Stormwrought Tempest. All four pieces give: Enemies miss 8% more. Mana comes back faster. Needs level 70.

Armour	18
Level	70
Gear tier	70
Set	storm
Passive	DODGE 0.094
Price	6013 gold

Wyrmbone Skull Helm
Helm `ar_wyrm_h`

Every blow on you is 10 lighter. Set: Wyrmbone Slayer. All four pieces give: Every blow on you is 8 lighter. Every enemy that strikes you takes 12 damage. Needs level 80.

Armour	19
Level	80
Gear tier	80
Set	wyrm
Passive	WARD 10
Price	7545 gold

Nautilus Helm
Helm `nautilushelm`

A helm grown from one great spiral shell, pearl-white inside and rose at the lip. Its wearer recovers health every round of a battle, mana comes back faster, and they can breathe under the sea. It sings very quietly when blows land.

Armour	9
Dive	1
Passive	REGEN 2, MPREGEN 0.6
Price	9000 gold

Abbot's Mitre of the Pilgrim's Path

Helm `pp_h`

A tall white and gold mitre with a blue gem and a golden cross. Every blow on you is 12 lighter. Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 50%. Set bonus (all four): ward 10, regeneration, second wind, +15% damage, dodging. Any class.

Armour	22
Level	1
Set	abbot
Passive	WARD 12, SECONDWIND 0.5
Price	9000 gold

Godforged Helm

Helm `ar_god_h`

Every blow on you is 13 lighter. Set: Godforged Exemplar. All four pieces give: Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 50%. All damage +10%. Every blow on you is 8 lighter. Needs level 100.

Armour	24
Level	100
Gear tier	100
Set	god
Passive	WARD 13
Price	11026 gold

Starforged Helm

Helm `ar_star_h`

Mana comes back faster. Set: Starforged Seer. All four pieces give: Mana comes back faster. Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 40%. Needs level 90.

Armour	21
Level	90
Gear tier	90
Set	star
Passive	MPREGEN 0.58
Price	9218 gold

Body armour

Voidglass Cuirass

Chest `ar_void_c`

Heals 7% of melee damage dealt. Set: Voidglass Reaver. All four pieces give: Heals 8% of melee damage dealt. +6% double hits. Needs level 60.

Armour	28
Level	60
Gear tier	60
Set	void
Passive	LIFESTEAL 0.068
Price	8412 gold

Abbot's Chasuble Plate

Chest `pp_c`

Plate cut like the vestment of an abbot, with a long red and gold stole. Wounds close steadily. Enemies miss 8% more. Set bonus (all four): ward 10, regeneration, second wind, +15% damage, dodging. Any class.

Armour	40
Level	1
Set	abbot
Passive	REGEN 0.9, DODGE 0.08
Price	9000 gold

Stormwrought Breastplate

Chest `ar_storm_c`

Mana comes back faster. Set: Stormwrought Tempest. All four pieces give: Enemies miss 8% more. Mana comes back faster. Needs level 70.

Armour	32
Level	70
Gear tier	70
Set	storm
Passive	MPREGEN 0.46
Price	10933 gold

Wyrmbone Cuirass

Chest `ar_wyrm_c`

Every enemy that strikes you takes 16 damage. Set: Wyrmbone Slayer. All four pieces give: Every blow on you is 8 lighter. Every enemy that strikes you takes 12 damage. Needs level 80.

Armour	35
Level	80
Gear tier	80
Set	wyrm
Passive	THORNS 16
Price	13719 gold

Starforged Breastplate

Chest `ar_star_c`

Enemies miss 12% more. Set: Starforged Seer. All four pieces give: Mana comes back faster. Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 40%. Needs level 90.

Armour	39
Level	90
Gear tier	90
Set	star
Passive	DODGE 0.118
Price	16760 gold

Godforged Cuirass

Chest `ar_god_c`

Heals 10% of melee damage dealt. Set: Godforged Exemplar. All four pieces give: Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 50%. All damage +10%. Every blow on you is 8 lighter. Needs level 100.

Armour	43
Level	100
Gear tier	100
Set	god
Passive	LIFESTEAL 0.1
Price	20047 gold

Arm armour

Stormwrought Vambraces

Arms `ar_storm_a`

+8% double hits. Set: Stormwrought Tempest. All four pieces give: Enemies miss 8% more. Mana comes back faster. Needs level 70.

Armour	11
Level	70
Gear tier	70
Set	storm
Passive	CRIT 0.08
Price	3827 gold

Wyrmbone Vambraces

Arms `ar_wyrm_a`

Wounds close steadily. Set: Wyrmbone Slayer. All four pieces give: Every blow on you is 8 lighter. Every enemy that strikes you takes 12 damage. Needs level 80.

Armour	12
Level	80
Gear tier	80
Set	wyrm
Passive	REGEN 0.72
Price	4802 gold

Starforged Vambraces

Arms `ar_star_a`

Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 38%. Set: Starforged Seer. All four pieces give: Mana comes back faster. Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 40%. Needs level 90.

Armour	14
Level	90
Gear tier	90
Set	star
Passive	SECONDWIND 0.38
Price	5866 gold

Godforged Vambraces

Arms `ar_god_a`

All damage +13%. Set: Godforged Exemplar. All four pieces give: Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 50%. All damage +10%. Every blow on you is 8 lighter. Needs level 100.

Armour	15
Level	100
Gear tier	100
Set	god
Passive	DMGPCT 0.13
Price	7016 gold

Abbot's Embroidered Cuffs

Arms `pp_a`

Wide cuffs of white and gold plate, sewn with small golden crosses. Heals 10% of melee damage dealt. All damage +12%. Set bonus (all four): ward 10, regeneration, second wind, +15% damage, dodging. Any class.

Armour	14
Level	1
Set	abbot
Passive	LIFESTEAL 0.1, DMGPCT 0.12
Price	9000 gold

Leg armour

Voidglass Greaves

Legs `ar_void_1`

All damage +8%. Set: Voidglass Reaver. All four pieces give: Heals 8% of melee damage dealt. +6% double hits. Needs level 60.

Armour	13
Level	60
Gear tier	60
Set	void
Passive	DMGPCT 0.082
Price	3785 gold

Stormwrought Greaves

Legs `ar_storm_1`

All damage +9%. Set: Stormwrought Tempest. All four pieces give: Enemies miss 8% more. Mana comes back faster. Needs level 70.

Armour	14
Level	70
Gear tier	70
Set	storm
Passive	DMGPCT 0.094
Price	4920 gold

Wyrmbone Greaves

Legs `ar_wyrm_1`

Heals 8% of melee damage dealt. Set: Wyrmbone Slayer. All four pieces give: Every blow on you is 8 lighter. Every enemy that strikes you takes 12 damage. Needs level 80.

Armour	16
Level	80
Gear tier	80
Set	wyrm
Passive	LIFESTEAL 0.084
Price	6174 gold

Starforged Greaves

Legs `ar_star_1`

Wounds close steadily. Set: Starforged Seer. All four pieces give: Mana comes back faster. Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 40%. Needs level 90.

Armour	18
Level	90
Gear tier	90
Set	star
Passive	REGEN 0.8
Price	7542 gold

Abbot's Pilgrim Greaves

Legs `pp_1`

Greaves like the hem of a robe, with golden pilgrim sandals. Mana comes back faster. Hunger falls 50% slower. Set bonus (all four): ward 10, regeneration, second wind, +15% damage, dodging. Any class.

Armour	18
Level	1
Set	abbot
Passive	MPREGEN 0.6, HUNGERSLOW 0.5
Price	9000 gold

Godforged Greaves

Legs `ar_god_1`

Wounds close steadily. Set: Godforged Exemplar. All four pieces give: Once per 30 rounds, below a quarter health, heals 50%. All damage +10%. Every blow on you is 8 lighter. Needs level 100.

Armour	19
Level	100
Gear tier	100
Set	god
Passive	REGEN 0.88
Price	9021 gold

Rings

Ring of the Master Hand

Ring `ringMaster`

A ring that only a master of a trade is given. Adds 2 ranks to the wearer's profession.

Profession rank	2
Price	1620 gold

Below the Abbey

Grid-movement, turn-based RPG

Bickering Goat Studios

deepspace000.github.io/Below-the-Abbey

Manual for game version 3.459